

BROKEN DREAMS

CHELSEA HATES LIBBY

3 of 3

KT MORRISON

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

Visit My Website!

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ANTHOLOGIES

The Taken Anthology

This is a work of fiction. Similarities to real people, places, or events are entirely coincidental.

Models on cover are meant for illustrative purposes only.

All characters are over the age of eighteen.

This book takes place in Canada where recreational use of cannabis is legal.

BROKEN DREAMS

A Chelsea Hates Libby Serial Novel

Chelsea Hates Libby #3 of 3

45,500 words

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Written by KT Morrison

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PART 1
WAITING ROOM

TUESDAY, JULY 16

FIRST THING he saw when he roared into the driveway—screeching to a halt, his bumper nudging the rear wheel of Chelsea’s motorcycle—was his poor Libby. Between two shrubs, Lib sat on a stone step in the middle of the path that led to Chelsea’s front door. She was hunched over, crying, face hidden, arms pulled close to her body. One hand supported the other wrist, other hand hanging.

Ben jumped out of the truck, door swinging open behind him but not closing, the annoying ding-ding-ding announcing the urgency of his arrival. He scrambled to her, skidded on his knees and tore his pants. One hand went around her knees, the other around her back. When she would lift her face, he knew her pretty features would be ruined. She’d be missing a tooth, Chelsea’s nails would’ve pulled her flesh away, her lips would be split, her eyes would be swollen shut...

“Baby, baby,” he said, caressing her knee as her face turned up to look at him. She was surprisingly unharmed. Her right eye looked puffy and was squinted, and ragged red nail marks slashed down the left side of her neck.

She instantly blubbered when she saw him. “My hand, Ben, my hand...”

Soft and soothing: “What happened, baby, what happened?”

“It hurts so bad...”

“Oh, no, baby...”

“I broke my hand, Ben,” she cried, her voice high, a thin squeak of squealing pain. She held aloft for him her limp hanging hand. Between her fingers was a wispy tangle of caramel hair.

He cradled it, kissed the inside of her wrist, and she whispered a mournful ‘ow.’

“Hey, hey, what did you do, Libby,” he said wonderingly, “what on earth did you do?”

“It hurts so bad,” she said, “why does it hurt so bad, Ben...? I broke my hand...” She showed it to him again, watching him now, her face creased with the worry of a child. He stroked her hair, and she looked in his eyes. “Ben...”

“What...?”

“Don’t leave me, Ben, please don’t leave me...”

“Never, Libby...”

“Hold me, please, hold me...”

“I’ll never ever leave you, Libby. I’m with you forever, I love you more than anything,” he said and circled his arms around her thin and shaking shoulders.

Now with Lib sobbing into his neck, Ben’s eyes cast up the pathway to the open front door of the Slades’ home. Chelsea sat in jeans and a tank top, bare feet, knees up, one forearm folded over them. Her feet were in the sun, her butt and body inside the house still. There was a cigarette between her fingers, and she held an ice pack under her mane of tangled honey-hair. Her nose and mouth were bloodied. He shook his head, looking at that demon. Chelsea caught him watching and smiled. The smile shone like a quarter moon in that rat’s nest of blackening blood. She shouted down to them, “Serves you right, bitch.”

Libby stiffened in his arms; she whipped around ready to lunge at Chelsea again and Ben gripped her shirt to hold her in place. Libby shouted: “It was eight years ago!”

“This bitch never forgets,” Chelsea said.

Libby set her hand down, the injured one, putting it out like she was going to support herself while she wrestled from him to stand, and then she shouted in pain and collapsed on the path. He collected her in his arms, circled her, he said, “Come on, baby, I’m taking you to the hospital...”

“I’m so sorry, Ben, I’m so sorry,” she sobbed.

He stood over her now, supporting her in his arms. There was a swirling hank of Chelsea’s hair on the concrete. Not far from that, a bloodied earring. He recognized it as one of his wife’s. He slipped a hand up her neck, touched her ear under the sweep of her silky hair. His fingers came away smeared with blood.

“I’m taking you to the hospital, baby. Come on, come with me...”

Chelsea said, “You’re not leaving me here...”

WITH LIB IN THE FRONT, buckled up safe, curled into the seat's bucket shape with her hand cradled to her bosom, Chelsea climbed in the back bench of his pickup. Lib scowled and cried at the same time, blubbering, "I don't know why *she's* coming..."

Chelsea wiped at her mouth and nose with a damp tea towel, shaking her head and glowering at the back of Libby's head.

"I can't leave her here, Lib," he said, worming a look over his shoulder as he backed out of Chelsea's driveway. Chelsea cleaned her face, turning the towel over and over. He said, "Do *not* get blood on my seats."

"It's fucking leather, Ben, it'll wipe off," Chelsea said, then ran her tongue over her teeth, plumping out her upper lip like a chimp.

Truck in drive now, he drove to the north end of Chelsea's street and made a left onto Queen. "What hospital do I go to?"

"Go to the fire station," Libby said, voice thick with pain.

Chelsea muttered something but he couldn't make it out. He caught her in the rear-view mirror, wiggling her front teeth to check if they were loose.

He asked, "What'd you say?"

"I said go to St. Mike's," she spat, running her tongue around again, crossing her arms and thumping back into the leather bench. She kicked the back of Libby's seat with her boot, making Lib jerk forward. "My face is how I make money, Libby."

"Leave me alone," Libby shouted.

"If my nose is broken, I swear to God I'll sue your ass sideways."

"Leave her alone," he said into the rear-view. Chelsea stared balefully back at him. He asked, "Where'd you put that bloody towel?"

“I stomped it into your carpet.”

“Do you want to walk to the hospital?”

“It’s here,” she complained, tossing it up from where it had lay in her lap.

“How’s your hand, Lib?”

Lib just shook her head no, her pretty mouth pinched to a tight pucker. He turned onto Eastern and it was empty and he let the truck out, the motor roaring until they caught up with the back end of traffic where it bunched outside a McDonald’s. He reached over and caressed the back of Libby’s hot neck. “Is your ear bleeding still?”

“I don’t care,” she muttered.

He stroked his thumb up and down the gentle curve of her cranium. Before leaving Chelsea’s, they’d gathered towels, but Lib let hers stay in her lap unused. Blood had dripped a pattern on the chest and shoulder of her sweatshirt but it seemed to have stopped.

Libby murmured, “I think she ripped my ear.”

Chelsea said, “Serves you right.”

“I didn’t do anything,” Libby whined.

Ben said, “Stop, guys...”

Chelsea laughed. “*Bullshit*. You know—”

“I never did!” Libby’s tiny voice was surprisingly loud in the cab. She thumped her good hand down in a fist against her skinny knee.

“Oh, bull-fucking-shit, Lib!”

He said, “Did what? What was eight years ago?”

“No, don’t,” Libby cried, clutching his forearm with her good hand, spinning to regard Chelsea in the back. “Don’t, please, don’t,” she pleaded to Chelsea in a whimper.

“What goes around comes around, Libby...”

“Please, please, don’t... just don’t...”

He asked again, “What happened eight years ago?”

Libby’s mouth trembled as she stared into the back seat, then she said, “Nothing happened, she’s lying...”

He said, “Lying about what, Lib?”

In the rear-view, Chelsea met his eyes. “You ready for this?—your girlfriend fucked Ronnie.”

Libby crumpled, “I didn’t, I swear I didn’t...” She hid her face in her good hand and cried.

Ben said, “Ronnie Mitchell? In high school?”

“Yeah, your prissy girlfriend fucked my boyfriend.”

Libby said, “It’s not true, it’s just not true...”

Chelsea scooted forward, filling the gap between the two front seats, arms hooked over the seat backs, spitting at the back of Libby’s head, “He said he fucked you at school, fucked you after a stupid yearbook meeting...”

“He was lying to you,” she wailed, “that never happened...”

“He said you mewled like a cat, said he never heard a girl squawk like that.”

Libby clenched her hand in a fist shining with the streaks of her tears and thumped her leg again. “Shut up, Chelsea, shut up!”

“He said you were so tight he couldn’t even get it in you, but you begged for it anyway...”

The road ahead of him narrowed to a dim tunnel despite the bright early morning, and his vision throbbed with his heart, warbled with sudden wet. He yanked the wheel hard to the right, cut across the shoulder lane—someone honked and swerved as he bounced up the front entrance of a full-service car wash. He unplugged his belt, shot around, twisting, getting up on his knees and shouted at Chelsea: “Stop it! She said she didn’t...”

Libby said, “I didn’t, I *swear* I didn’t...”

Chelsea reared away from him, not wanting him looming over her, but still defiant, saying, “Bullshit, Libby, bullshit...”

He said, “Ronnie told you that?”

Chelsea slouched with her arms crossed tight. “Yeah.”

“Why?”

She turned to watch out the side window at a clutch of car wash guys in bright blue polo shirts and work shorts gathering to see what the fuss was. “I don’t know.”

He grunted, seeing a bigger picture. “You were fighting, weren’t you? You were breaking up?”

“Maybe.”

“Yeah, right and I bet you cheated on him.”

Chelsea ignored him, saying to the back of Lib’s head, “He had too many details, Libby. You had bananas on your cheap ass underwear like a fucking grade-schooler, he said...”

“I didn’t ha-have b-bananas on my mm-underweaarr,” Libby bawled.

Arms folded, Chelsea hunched close, very near them. “He said you were such a nerd he pity-fucked you then jerked off on your face.”

“You’re so mean,” Libby cried into her hands.

When Chelsea looked up, she saw his harrowed expression. Her own words hung in the air and he could tell even *she* didn’t like them. The cab was pin-drop quiet except for Lib’s breathy gasps. Chelsea scowled, her lips pursed, brow furrowed, and tossed herself back to sit on the bench, her knees up high. He stared at her, but she wouldn’t look his way.

He said, “You feel better now?”

Chelsea shook her head.

“That sound like Libby to you?”

Chelsea shrugged.

Quieter now, Chelsea said, “She already cheated on you, Ben. You guys were dating, and she fucked my boyfriend.”

He said, “I don’t believe for one second what Ronnie fucking Mitchell said was true. I believe Libby. Ronnie was so full of shit. Look in my eyes and tell me, Chelsea, tell me Ronnie wasn’t always full of shit.”

Chelsea stared out the window, square-jawed, grinding her teeth. Libby breathily sobbed. Ben rubbed her back, turned around and sat, doing up his seatbelt again.

Libby whispered, “Why do you care if I did or didn’t, anyway? You have sex with other people... my *husband*... you wanted Finn to do that to me. You’re so evil.”

“Payback’s a bitch,” Chelsea said, still looking out the window.

Libby looked over her shoulder at Chelsea, complete incomprehension screwed her features. “It doesn’t even make sense, Chelsea... You wanted your husband to sleep with me to get back for having sex with your boyfriend eight years ago?...”

Ben watched Chelsea in the mirror, chewing the inside of her cheek, scowling at who knows what, shaking her head in the negative. She said, “Yeah, I’m fucked up, so what? So what? Not all of us come from happy little homes like Libby Sanders.” Her eyes flicked up, caught him watching her, they glistened wet, and she blinked. A quick, mean expression corrected any weakness he thought he saw there. “Would you just fucking drive, Ben...? Just drive...”

IT TOOK twenty minutes of traffic before he was parking in the concrete underground across from St. Mike's Hospital. Ben walked Libby held against him, and Chelsea paced four strides behind. As they entered the busy waiting area of the emergency room, an ocean of noise washed over them; people in pain, people pretending to be in pain, hassled nurses, beeps, boops, the squeaks of Crocs on linoleum. Chelsea groaned behind them, "Great, here's seven hours of my life wasted, thanks a lot, Libby."

Libby clucked her tongue, pushed her cheek harder against his shoulder. Ben had asked for Chelsea's ice pack and to his surprise she'd surrendered it. Libby held it in the cup of her broken hand. The little finger had swollen.

Ben escorted Libby to the Waiting Room benches and got her settled where there were two seats available between two different couples that didn't look too seedy. Chelsea joined him at the triage counter. He gave the nurse behind the acrylic barrier Libby's health card. The nurse looked past him at Chelsea like she might recognize her.

Chelsea said over his shoulder, "His wife broke her hand, and I have a broken nose, but it's not related." The nurse didn't know what to make, dipped her eyes down and told Ben she had to talk to the patient.

He sighed, "But she's..."

"I'm cutting in," Chelsea said, pushing past him.

He returned to retrieve Libby, told her she had to go in person. She sat upright and lifted her butt off the seat, but when she saw Chelsea at the admin window she sat back down. "I'll wait," she said.

He sighed heavily, sat down next to her, watched the profile of her sad, down-turned faced. He rubbed her thigh just above her knee.

She said, "You really hurt me, Ben."

"Libby, I can't even tell you how sorry I am."

She nodded solemnly, her mouth working around. "We can get through it."

"Can we?" He hadn't been daring to even hope for forgiveness right now, but hearing her unprompted words hit him hard, got his breaths coming fast and on the edge of sobs. He struggled to say, "I mean, I'd do... I'd do *anything*..."

She nodded again, swallowed. "You hurt me so bad, baby..."

"I'm so sorry," he said, gripping her knee.

She whispered, "I'm not perfect, either."

He said, "You didn't fall for it."

She shook her head no.

Chelsea stood, strutted her long legs back toward them but bypassing to sit two aisles of seats behind. She scratched her cheek with her middle finger as she passed, side-eyeing him and chuckling to herself.

Libby rubbed at the wrist of her injured hand. She looked timidly at him, wagged two fingers toward him like she sought him out. He was quick to squeeze and hold the fingers. He said, "You're so crazy, Lib."

It brought the tiniest sideways smile. She said, "Don't ever leave me."

His arm couldn't get around her fast enough, he kissed her forehead and hugged her hard. He whispered, "I'm never leaving you, Libby."

Into his neck, she said, "I still hate you right now, but don't ever leave me."

"Never, Lib, never," he said, then prompting her: "Go, Lib, go talk to the nurse." He kissed the top of her head three times, snuffling and wiping at his eyes. Lib glanced over her shoulder, saw the nurse available and waiting, holding up Lib's Health Card. She stood, hobbled over.

Lib ran hair behind her ears, removed the bag of ice to show the nurse what had happened. He didn't know what tale she would spin but didn't believe Lib would say it was a fistfight. You never knew if that would bring the police to investigate or not. He hoped she didn't, because it was looking like they might get through this.

He admired that beautiful woman he loved, more like herself now, almost smiling as she explained to the nurse how much her hand hurt. A soft smile eased on his face while he watched Lib past a man with a bucket

between his knees sitting at the end of the opposite bank of seats. The man lurched forward and heaved his guts into the pan with a wet slop.

Ben's smile relaxed and his brow lowered as a kernel of old truth began to send forth its shoots through his psyche. The smell of vomited rye wafted his way, and he tried to push back the thought when she was in high school, Libby did have a pair of cotton panties with little bananas printed all over them.

THE WAIT TIME was nowhere near as bad as he'd thought it might be. After two-and-a-half hours they called out for Libby Todd. She'd fallen into a light sleep against him, and he patted her cheek and kissed her hairline to wake her.

"Libby, they're calling you."

She nodded, straightened her top, took a deep breath, winced at the pain in her hand and left to join the nurse without saying anything to him. The repair between them would take a little while, but he was sure she would try.

A male nurse with a clipboard led away Libby, the two of them weaving past a man being trundled on a gurney and two firefighters coming from the other way. Then she was gone.

It wasn't even a minute before somebody heaved themselves into the seat behind him, shaking the bench. He looked over his shoulder, saw a sliver of honey-caramel gryphon's mane, knew it was that mythological creature called Chelsea. She said, "Lib breaks her dumb hand, I break my nose, *she* goes first?"

"I don't think your nose is broken."

"Better not be," she muttered.

"You deserve it. I deserve worse."

"You do," she said. "You *are* a bad boy. Hold still, let me punch you in the nose."

"You're evil."

He could tell she was nodding, but she had no taunt for him. A look chanced over his shoulder showed her watching past him toward where the

nurses' station was.

"You really are," he said.

She melted onto the bench, facing his way, her forearms going over the rail between the seat-backs, her chin resting on her wrists. She said, "Yeah. I'm way more evil than I thought."

"You made me hurt her."

Chelsea nodded, her mouth puckered and twisted to one side. "It was funnier in my head."

"You think it's funny?"

"I did for a while."

"You're twisted."

"I wanted to break you guys up."

"You ought to be in a psych ward."

She sighed and slunk lower. "I know. You know what?—it wasn't you, Ben. It was her. I just wanted to get her."

He chuckled at the lunacy. "Because of Ronnie Mitchell? That guy was a jacked-up loser."

"He was mine."

"What do you care? You're not even faithful."

"I was back then. To him at least. Kind of. My grudge outlived my fidelity and tastes."

"Libby didn't cheat on me with Ronnie."

"I don't even know anymore. I wanted to hurt her. I was so convinced I was right. I wanted to get her back..."

"She didn't do anything."

Chelsea was quiet a moment. "I can't believe she came at me like that."

"Me neither."

"No one's ever dared to check me before."

"She checked you good."

"I don't know about that."

Ben turned over his shoulder, their faces close together. Chelsea wouldn't meet his eye and he could see her struggle not to do it. He said, "Libby is such a kind and caring human being. She's harmless. You know the cruelty it would take to make her do that?"

Chelsea sniffed, still looking past him, still avoiding his eyes. She bit on her lip, perfect row of movie star lower teeth sawing back and forth over her plump upper lip. She said, "Sorry."

It surprised him. “Really?”

“I mean it. I wanted to break you guys up. Now I don’t want you guys to break up.”

“We’re not going to.”

“I shouldn’t have done it.”

“It’s done. And *I* was the one who did it.”

“Yeah, but I’m irresistible.”

He muttered and shook his head. Chelsea leaned behind him, her soft breath touching his neck. He turned. “Can you get out of here now?”

She made a dry, unimpressed expression, backed away, saying, “You’re cold, Benjamin...”

HALF AN HOUR LATER, a nurse summoned Chelsea. Ben sat and texted, did his best to do business from his phone while he waited. An hour after Chelsea had gone in, she came out. She looked the same, but cleaned up. He could see the bridge of her nose looked slightly bigger than normal. She intended putting him on ignore, walking right past, but changed her mind and diverted a detour his way.

She stooped, got near his ear, said, “Isn’t even broken.”

He sighed, rubbed his hands together, raised his chin to look at her. “That’s good,” he said.

“You disappointed? You wish it was?”

“I’m happy your nose isn’t broken.”

“Your wife hits like a featherweight,” she said.

He groaned, sighed, stretched. When he sat back, he said, “I don’t hate you, Chelsea. I’m worried about my Libby because I love her. I’m crushed that I hurt her, and that you did something so awful my wife—you know, your little mouse?—showed up at your door and punched you in the nose...”

Chelsea sniffed a laugh, and her graceful hand drifted to the tight denim stretched on her hips, stroking down between her legs. “She also hoofed me in the pussy. Twice.”

His eyebrows raised. “Anyway, we found out what it takes to turn a little mouse into a lion.”

Chelsea nodded, scanning the sea of waiting patients. She hummed, muttered, “Pretty impressive.”

Ben said, “Pretty scary.”

Chelsea cocked her head side to side, vacillating. “Maybe I’ll see you around, Ben.”

“I doubt it.”

Chelsea smiled, pivoted on a boot heel and her long legs strode along the aisle past the groaning patients, hiked left and her heels clopped away til their sound faded.

LIBBY CAME out a half-hour later with a splint down her little finger to her wrist, the hand bandaged like a mummy's. A yellow half-moon curved under her right eye, and the red slashes on her neck from Chelsea's fingernails glistened like someone had rubbed them with an ointment. In the car, she told him her earlobe had been torn in two. Told him it would be eight to twelve weeks of recovery for the broken metacarpal. The fifth one, a boxer's fracture, she told him. They offered painkillers but Lib wanted none, saying she would just take Tylenol. He stopped at the bistro on the way home without being asked and bought four tubs of her favorite fruit flavors of gelato, some chips, too, ginger ale, and more pickle seasoning for her popcorn.

They arrived home, and he escorted her into the house. From the waiting room, he'd texted Gwendolyn and asked her to nip over to his place and lock up the door—he was sure he'd forgotten because he left in a panicked hurry. When they arrived home, the door was closed and locked. They entered, and Ben escorted Lib with supportive hands on her shoulders into the family room where she collapsed on the couch. He got her laying on her side and put a pillow under her head. He asked her if she wanted to watch Game Of Thrones, and she said maybe later. She wanted to be alone. It sank his heart. He admitted to himself that this would take time.

In the kitchen, he busied himself with chores. Opened up his laptop and caught up with things he'd missed today. It was shit, because there were things to do that would make money but didn't get done. He didn't know if he'd be able to get to it over the rest of the week, either. Of all things, tomorrow he had to visit the *real* sailor. There was no guy out in Niagara—

there *had* been, but that had fallen through. Tomorrow he'd be driving to Peterborough and wouldn't have time to check out those cars. Somebody else would swoop in and snatch them away. Today might cost him quite a lot of money. But then again, maybe he was *earning* at the same time. Social points, value stitching back the torn pieces of his marriage. And that was priceless.

What was coming, though, he couldn't have predicted...

PART 2

TRIAGE

IN THE EVENING, he camped out in the kitchen and watched Netflix by himself on his laptop while Libby napped in the family room. He used all the vegetables in the crisper to make her a vegetable soup. He made a tuna salad the way she liked, put together a tuna melt. He brought that in to her, waking her by rubbing her calf. She thanked him and gave him every indication she still wanted to be alone. When he left her, she was eating soup in the dim as the sun dipped down outside, making the room glow orange. He ate soup and a sandwich and watched the Avengers again, texted with his business partner, and kept his buyer in Saudi Arabia up to date and confirmed his meeting tomorrow with the sailor in Peterborough. He collected the dishes from Libby, going in saying nothing, gathering her dirty things together and leaving. She thanked him as he passed into the kitchen. He told her she was welcome.

When he was scrubbing the dishes, he stopped. There was a buzzing sound: a cup and saucer rattling in the cupboard next to the sink. Now he could hear a rumble, feel it through the floorboards in his feet. It ceased. Hands dried with a tea towel, he walked down the hall knowing what he would find. Finn bounded up the front step, no helmet, coming to the door, skidding almost to a stop before knocking hard with his fist.

“Fucking guy,” Ben muttered.

From the family room, Libby’s voice: “Who is it?”

“It’s nobody,” he said, tossed the tea towel back to the sink, made his way to the front door, taking his time, staring Finn down. But Finn didn’t look at him, bouncing on his toes, looking up and down the street.

Ben got to the aluminum door, unlocked it, clicked it open and put his head through. “What do you want?”

Finn yammered, frantic: “Libby’s here? She’s okay? Where is she?...”

“Yeah, she’s—”

Finn tugged the door open wider, stepped into the foyer. Ben put up his hands to block the way. “Hey, come on, you’re not welcome here...”

“I know I’m not welcome, I know, but I *have* to say something...”

“Just forget it, just get outta here...”

“Ben, seriously,” he said, “I gotta see her.”

“She doesn’t want to see you.”

“She shouldn’t, Ben, she shouldn’t, that’s why I *gotta* see her...” Finn pushed past him, looking to head deeper down the hall.

Ben gripped his arm, tried to hold him back. “It’s going to make things worse.”

“Ben, let me talk to her.” Finn pulled free, boring eyes on Ben’s, not mean but intent.

“Fine, fucking fine,” Ben said, putting his hands up to show he didn’t intend to stop him. “Good luck, go find out what a piece of shit she thinks you are—we *all* are...”

There was another long moment where their gaze stayed connected, a worry passing through Finn’s eyes. Then he was pivoting and striding to the end of the hall, headed for the family room. “Libby?”

From the family room, Libby said, “Get out of here,” voice high and tight, and Finn hadn’t even entered yet.

Ben followed, calling out for Finn to stop, thinking now he should do more to protect Libby. Finn made it to the archway that led to the family room, slowing like he didn’t want to rush Lib.

Ben could hear Libby protesting, “Don’t, just go, please, go away...”

Finn darted toward her, and by the time Ben was at the archway, Finn had already made it to Lib, crouching down at the foot of the couch. Lib had withdrawn all the way to the corner, knees up protectively, arms folded, shrouded in the blanket she’d been napping under. The TV was on, lighting both of them in a pale ghostly flicker.

Finn said in a soft voice: “It’s not what you think...”

“Just get out of here...”

“Libby, I know how it looks, I do, I—”

Libby’s face coiled in a grimace of hurt and shame. “She sent you.”

“No, she didn’t, Lib—I got home, she told me, I came straight here...”

“Just go *back* home.”

“Let me say something.”

“What...?”

Enough was enough, and Ben stepped forward now, arms folded, saying, “Finn, come on, she doesn’t want to talk to you.”

Finn threw up his hands, mouth open but not saying anything. He pinched the bridge of his nose. “I know, I... Lib, I’m sorry, but it’s not what you think.”

“And what do I *think*?” The sadness in her expression contorted now with a sneer of disgust and Ben preferred it over the former.

“Lib,” Finn said, all sincerity and kindness, his hand touching her ankle and Libby flinching away, “I wasn’t setting you up.”

“But you did,” she whispered.

“No, I swear...”

“What do *you* call it then?”

“Everything I did, Lib, everything I said, it was all for real...”

“Real what? You *humiliated* me.” Now the seal was broken and Lib’s reddened face began to stream tears. “You only ever came by the book shop to set me up, make fuh-fun of me...”

“Oh, no way, no, Lib. I don’t ever want to make fun of you...”

“But you weren’t there for real, you were just being mean...”

“No, Lib, I mean, I was there to meet this girl Chels wanted to swing with. As soon as I saw you I was like Yup, she’s *so* hot.”

“That’s so mean—you think that makes it okay, but it makes it wuh-worse...”

“Why?”

“You didn’t *tell* me any of that...”

“No,” Finn agreed, some of the confident hope fading from him. “Yeah, that’s kind of bad. I see it...”

“You only came by and were nice to me because you wanted to have sex with me.”

“That’s true.”

Libby whined: “*See*...?”

Finn had thought that was such a blessing it didn’t occur to him how a girl might not be as up for it as he might consider. He said, “That’s not bad,

Libby. I came by to see if you'd be any fun and I was head over heels for you, just ask Chelsea..."

"She can go to hell."

"I know," he said, brave enough to touch her chin. Lib let him though she turned her face to make him reach for it. "I mean it, Libby, I only had to come by once to see if you'd be a good match for me, I *kept* coming by because I liked to sit and have a coffee with you. I didn't need to do that, I *wanted* to do that."

She made an exasperated sound that came out like a cough. "You were only trying to sof-soften me up so you could take advantage of me."

"I see how you would think that." With her hand in his now, he pressed it to his chest. "On my heart, Lib, all I ever wanted was to hang out with you, get to know you, and, yeah, for sure, I wanted you in my bed. But I never wanted to take advantage of you or humiliate you, I only ever wanted this to be fun. For both of us, but really for you. I like you a lot, Lib."

Lib stole her hand back and tucked it under an arm where he couldn't get it. "Why wouldn't you tell me Ben cheated on me?"

"I don't know. Ben seems like a nice guy, I didn't want him to hurt. He and Chels thought it would be best for us, you and me, to get together on our own. Like it would be good for all four of us."

"Trick me in-into cheating on Ben..."

Finn nodded. "Wow," he sighed, "yeah, you're right, that's pretty shitty."

"It *is*," Libby said, mad and bewildered that he couldn't see it.

Finn said, "Libby, I'm really sorry."

"Get out of here," she sighed.

"Why, Libby?" Finn spoke softly, his voice on the edge of pleading.

They stared into each other, Lib studying this guy who she'd crushed on but didn't really know. When she spoke, her voice was soft but hard with meaning. "You recorded me so they could listen. Chelsea listened. You made me a fool."

The whole argument Libby had hidden her bandaged hand from him in her protective blanket, but Finn saw it now, the bright white peeping out past the tartan fringe. "Aw, Libby," he said and reached for her with both hands, "I can't believe you did that..."

"Don't," she said, tugging the blanket to cover again. "I wish I broke her nose."

“I don’t blame you, Lib, I’m mad, too...”

Libby laughed, made a flabbergasted sound and shook her head. Scooting down to the end of the couch past Finn so she could stand, she gathered her blanket around her, Finn watching. She said, “You’re as bad as her. You were only nice to me because Chelsea made you.”

“No,” he said, his expression wounded.

Libby marched away from him, getting near Ben and whispering, “Tell him to get out of here,” then stomping past into the hall.

Ben called after her, “Where you going, Lib?”

“I’m going to my room,” she hissed and her feet pounded up the stairs to the second floor. The bedroom door slammed.

He looked at Finn sitting in a defeated heap at the foot of the couch, eyes cast down and to the side. “Way to go, dude,” he said, “you really cleared that up...”

FINN PUSHED himself up to stand, but then dropped to sit on the couch. He rubbed his forehead. "Didn't see it going this way."

"Yeah," Ben laughed, "didn't want to, but it totally makes sense. The whole thing was stupid. Stupid and awful."

"You know what I'm saying, right, dude?" His arms dropped heavy in the couch and he looked at Ben for assurance. "I didn't want her to get hurt."

"I sure as shit didn't. This got fucked up so bad."

Ben stayed standing like he was a guest in his own home, Finn looking comfortable in his couch, though. They were both silent a long while, him sagging to lean against the wall.

At last Finn said, "Did she hurt her hand?"

"Broke it."

"Oh, shit, are you serious?"

"The pinky finger bone. In her hand."

"Aww, Libby," Finn groaned and buried his face in his hands, leaning way back in the couch seat and breathing into his palms.

"How's Chelsea?"

Into his hands, Finn said, "Fine. Bitching a hundred miles an hour, but I had to get out of there. I'm so pissed with her right now."

"For what?"

"For making this fucked up."

"She wanted to hurt us, and she hurt us. She got her way."

"I didn't see it."

"Sure."

“I didn’t, Ben,” he said, uncovering his face and sitting upright now.

Ben laughed a breathy chuckle through his nose, came into the room and dropped to sit on the other end of the couch with his arms folded.

“Right. All that shit on the phone.”

“What shit on the phone?”

“Yeah, hot-shot, perving out with my wife over your own dick.”

“What—in the hotel room?”

“Making her show you how much bigger you are than me.”

Finn gave a guilty look, but rolled his eyes like there was an explanation, one that a guy like Ben might not get. He attempted anyway.

“Girls like that kind of thing.”

“No, they don’t...”

“I know what works, Ben, sorry—me saying that to Lib has nothing to do with you. Girls like to hear that stuff, and they like it when you draw that badness out of them, ask them something specific they know they can answer—‘cause they kind of *want* to answer—makes it easy for them to get a little closer to going too far. They know they want to, they just don’t want it to be their own idea. And not the *man’s* idea either, not entirely—you have to swim out to them, splash around a little...”

“Like getting them to show how your dick is longer than their husband’s?”

“I know what works. I didn’t mean anything by it. I wasn’t trying to showboat you.”

“You totally showboated me, Finn.”

Finn hugged his arms, sinking low into the couch. “I guess it was shitty.”

Ben said, “I don’t have a small dick.”

Finn nodded. “Sorry. That was bad. This whole thing didn’t work out very good, did it?”

“You mean how you and me are on the couches?”

Finn smiled and chuckled.

“It’s not funny, Finn. Lib broke her hand, my marriage is going through the wringer right now, and look how upset Libby is.”

“I’m laughing at what you said, not what happened. Your marriage is going through the wringer because you had sex with my wife.”

Finn had a point, but Ben scoffed at him, staring at the side of his head, his jet black hair shooting off in spiky clumps. “Whatever.”

Finn turned his face toward him. "I don't mean any harm, Ben, I just do what Chelsea tells me. You and I are the same."

Ben wanted to argue more, but the steam had run out. He wasn't even sure if he was mad at Finn or not. For the *Hey look how big my dick is* thing for sure, but other than that, maybe there was truth to the setup being Chelsea's responsibility. "How's her nose?"

"Swelling's gone down."

"That's good."

"Said she iced it all day."

They were both silent a long time, watching up at the big screen in the corner, the image paused on some prison documentary, a man in an orange jumpsuit, cuffed, peering out from behind bars.

Finn said, "You hit play?"

"Libby was watching this."

"We can watch something else."

"What, you think you're going to hang out here?"

"I'm not going home right now..."

"You're not staying here."

"I'm waiting for Lib to cool off."

"She's not going to come back down, Finn."

"Yeah, she will."

"Finn," he said, pinching the bridge of his nose to show his patience was being tested, "my wife isn't coming back down, her conversation with you was done."

"She's not done with me."

"She is."

Finn grabbed the pillow Lib had been laying her head on and held it to his stomach, hooked his hands together over it. "You have any beer?"

THEY EACH DRANK two beers and watched the last three innings of the Jays in Boston, the whole time Ben wondering why Finn felt he could stay, and also wondering why he wouldn't make him leave. When the game was over, Ben checked his watch, making sure Finn saw the gesture and recognized it as a signal to get going. Finn stayed where he was.

During the game they'd stayed mostly wordless, offering the occasional lamentation at how lousy the Jays were. Now Finn was watching the post-game breakdown and Ben stared at the side of his head again, seeing his masculinity under the rock-and-roll costuming, wondering what the guy would look like in plain clothes with his bony build, the lean hips, and broad shoulders. He wondered if the guy wore eye makeup or if his eyes were naturally that dark and smoky. Eventually his eyes fell to Finn's lap, and he was left to wonder what Libby had seen bulging against his denim and whether or not what Chelsea said was true. *Ten inches.*

Ben cleared his throat and Finn looked his way. "You really didn't sleep with her, right?"

"I didn't."

"You're not lying?"

Finn shook his head no. He sat straighter now, angled Ben's way. "Dude, after she touched my dick through my pants she practically hyperventilated. She took off for her room and I had to go make sure she was okay. I fucking felt like such a bag of shit for leaving my phone open so you guys could listen."

"I didn't want to listen."

"You listened."

Ben made to protest, but the truth was he didn't want to listen and yet his ear had been glued to the phone the whole time. Despite his own conviction regarding his innocence, what he'd done was wrong.

Finn slapped big tattooed hands on his jutting out knees, then rose to stand, hauling his lean frame out of the couch. Ben rose to follow. They gathered up the beer bottles and took them to the kitchen saying nothing, then Finn walked the hall and Ben was glad to see him leaving. But at the front door he turned and headed up the staircase.

He said, "Hey, whoa, no..."

"I don't want her mad at me, Ben."

"She'll be sleeping—it's almost eleven."

Finn disregarded him and continued up the stairs. Ben caught up to him outside the bedroom door and gripped his shoulder to turn him around, ready for a fight. In Finn's eyes there was a fierce confidence, an assuredness that stopped Ben, made him want to hear what he had to say.

Finn put up his palms, said, "Ben, I'm not leaving here with Libby mad at me."

"She told you what she wanted, Finn, you're not some gift, you know?—she came up here to get away, you have to respect her."

"She changed the venue. It's about control and comfort, Ben. I barged into her space, she moves away to feel in control. She'll accept me in there now."

"No, she won't."

"Bet me."

"I'm not betting that."

Finn nodded, gripped Ben's collar, smiled, said, "Then just watch."

And for whatever reason—curiosity, bewilderment, or plain old submission—he let Finn open the bedroom door. At the surface of his thoughts was the notion he would be proven right, and Lib was about to bust her second nose of the day, but under that was a worry that Finn was correct.

The bedroom was dim, Lib had no lights on, just a nightlight illuminating the floor from the open door to their ensuite bathroom. Into the dark room, Finn said, "Hey, Lib, it's me."

Libby, voice muffled by a sullen and thick mouth, said, "Go away."

"Come on, Finn," Ben said.

"Hey, Lib...? Let me say sorry again. Let me turn on the light..."

Lib said nothing, Finn moved deeper into the room. The alcove of the ensuite opened onto the bedroom by the bed's headboard, a square of summer-night blue framed by parted curtains at the end of the room. Finn made his way to the bedside and put his hand up under the table lamp's shade to click it on. Ben came up behind Finn to see Lib laying on top of the sheets in her sleeping shorts and tee, her back to them, knees drawn up and arms hugged around herself. The aluminum brace that protected her finger glinted in the light.

"Fine, say sorry," she said unenthusiastically.

Finn sat on the bed behind her, talking to her back, saying, "Lib, I know I'm a bad guy. I see it. I see what you see."

"No, you don't."

"I do."

"You made me feel so stupid," she said, her voice gone to a whisper.

"I'm so sorry."

"You made me think... made me think you *liked* me..."

"But I do, I really do, that's what I'm saying. Will you turn around, please?—look in my eyes, you'll see..."

Lib sighed, made a noise in her throat that sounded like No, but then rolled over. She paused, laying on her back with her arms crossed and looking at the ceiling, but at last she met Finn's gaze. "What...?"

Finn said, "I was looking for a relationship with you, I really was, I wasn't trying to trick you or embarrass you—God, def not trying to make fun of you—I was there to have a *relationship* with you."

"*Why?*—I'm married."

"I know, but me and Chels aren't like that."

Lib rolled her eyes and slumped. "Don't say her name."

"I wanted to be your friend. I *was* your friend. Those talks we had when we had coffee...? The shit we talked about up north...? That was real, no trick, I swear..."

"No..."

"That was *real*, Lib, I was for real. I *want* a relationship with you."

"I have a husband."

"I wanted a *sexual* relationship with you."

Libby's sad expression pinched narrow into a troubled look of pondering, like a scientist finding the unexpected through the lens of their microscope.

“I mean it, Lib, that’s what I wanted. I wasn’t tricking you for Chel—” He corrected himself, continuing, “I wasn’t with you for *anyone* else’s manipulation, I was there for you. I thought we’d get to know each other, have fun together, maybe mid-summer you and I could have *more* fun together, you know, be intimate. *Share* with each other...”

That look of puzzlement on Lib’s face changed to surprise, her eyes widening but staring down into the bedding between them like she was all alone and Finn’s voice was on the phone.

Finn continued. “I’m not like what you’re thinking. If it weren’t for Ben and what he wanted, I would have been up front with you.”

Ben spoke up. “Oh, so it’s *my* fault?”

Lib looked his way, Finn too, both of them on the bed and him oddly removed. Finn said, “I’m not blaming you. You had your own deal, and I tried to respect it. You got yourself in trouble. I like you, I like Lib, me and Lib were already getting along, so I went with the program.”

“Right, exactly, *already*—what about *that*, sneaking around bringing her coffee...?”

“I was getting to know her. Nothing would have happened without me letting you know first.”

Ben said, “You say that now.”

Libby chewed her lower lip, studying him. “He asked your permission.”

Ben rolled his eyes. “Yeah, I guess.”

“And you said you wanted me to.”

He shrugged.

Libby turned to Finn and their eyes met. “Did he?”

“He loves you, Lib, he wasn’t mean about it, asking me to trick you. He did something stupid with my wife and asked me to do what I already wanted, but...”

“Not tell me...?”

Finn nodded.

“You *wanted* it, Ben?” She’d asked while still looking in Finn’s eyes, but now her head traveled his way.

He shrugged again, his expression heavy and beaten.

“So you could sleep with Chelsea?”

He shook his head no, doing it in the tiniest indiscernible way, not wanting to answer but compelled by duty to his wife.

She whispered, “Then *why*?”

His shoulders jumped, and he turned it into a shrug, scratching at his arm now.

Finn said, "He loves you. He wanted you to have some fun 'cause he knows you had a crush on me."

Brow furrowed, she said, "I don't have a crush on you."

"I have a crush on *you*."

Lib didn't know what to say to that, knew it should offend her, especially with her husband right there and all, so instead closed her mouth and watched Finn's eyes. Finn extended a hand to her, and she looked at that now, mouth twisting around, deep in thought. Slowly, her hand went into his and he helped her to sit and face him. She looked down into the sheets and brushed her hair out of her eyes, tucking it behind an ear. Her gaze cast sideways toward Ben but their eyes didn't meet. She sucked her lower lip into her mouth and chewed it.

Finn said, "Can you forgive me?"

Lib shook her head.

"You can't?"

"No."

Finn touched her chin with a knuckle and raised her face.

They looked into each other's eyes for a long moment, both of them sitting close on the bed, an unsure awkwardness as they tried to communicate without words. Then the unexpected happened.

Libby's head jerked forward the slightest increment, paused, she bit her lower lip, committed, leaned forward and kissed her lips against Finn's. Finn stayed where he was, his hand coming up so he could cup the point of her elbow, but as soon as the kiss started it was over. Libby darted back to where she'd began, looking frightened. She sucked her lower lip into her mouth again, rubbed her thumb over Finn's lower lip like she left some of her wet on him. Finn held the wrist, stroked his thumb on the back of her hand.

Lib said, "I don't forgive you, Finn, and I don't trust you one bit... I really don't..."

Their two hands combined, fingers weaving together, dropping into the sheets. Still close, so incredibly close, their eyes bored into each other's. Both of them craned their necks forward, hips tilting, faces coming together. Finn's mouth met Lib's and Libby was eager. He could hear her

breath coming through her nose deep and heavy. They kissed a long while this time, and Ben's heart hammered...

FINN TOOK HER OTHER HAND, her injured one, cradling the back and lifting it. Their mouths came away, but they still looked in each other's eyes. He kissed the bandaged palm of her injured hand. Both of them licked their lips, watched each other tentatively but earnestly. Finn began to unwind the bandages. He tossed away a tangled corkscrew of gauze and tensor and slipped the curved aluminum brace that held her hand in place.

Now he kissed her bare palm, watching Libby. Libby was engrossed, her big brown eyes locked on Finn. While he kissed her hand, she moved it to cup his cheek, then caress his neck. Her other hand came up and stroked along his bicep.

Ben shifted sideways nearer the foot of the bed, aiming for the upholstered chair in the corner. When his ankle connected, he sat, never taking his eyes off them.

Finn sat straighter, keeping himself immobile so Libby could study his body. Her small hands explored the bulges of his shoulders, smooshed circles on the hard slab of his chest. Then they slipped back down his arms again, Ben could see she was pushing her fingertips into his muscle then tracing the drawings of the tattoos that covered his arms.

Finn said, "I wanted to fuck you so bad, Lib, when we were on the couch together and watching that horror movie...? I was dying to be with you."

Lib nodded.

"You too?"

Libby pursed her lips and didn't answer.

Finn shook his shaggy hair out, crossed his arms and peeled the T-shirt up over his head, tossing it to the floor. Now he was bare-chested.

Finn had a hard body he kept hidden. It surprised Ben. His shoulder muscles bulged, his chest was a shelf of muscle that curved to a lean torso. There were tattoos across his chest, up the front of his neck, down his sides and his stomach. Sitting hunched forward you could tell how trim he was by the thin folded lines at his navel, just above the button of his jeans.

Now Finn eased back, his dark eyes luring Libby forward, encouraging her to touch him more. And Libby did, watching her hands swoop over the masculine shapes of this guy she had a crush on. A guy so unlike Ben thought she would ever fall for. Not with all those tattoos and the motorcycle... Ultimately, it was obvious...

Lib's hands moved around Finn's chest again, spread out on his shoulders, back down his chest right down the center below his sternum, her nails dragging on his stomach. When they came to the top button of his jeans, Ben lurched forward in his chair, seeking to insinuate himself between them on the bed. Looking to put an end to this. But while his butt lifted off the chair, he was still foot-glued to the spot. Finn put his hands over Libby's to stop her, and Ben sat back down.

Libby looked at Finn, unsure. He nodded, then teased his hands under her elbows and she tried to stop him from touching her. He smiled, and encouraged the smallest smile from her, though it was tight and nervous.

Finn persisted, fingers gathering up the fabric of her T-shirt. He raised it, and Libby bit her lower lip and let him. Her folded arms lifted like wings, then Finn was pulling the cotton up over her head.

There she was, topless, sitting with another man. Her hands were quick to cover her nudity, going over her nipples. She sucked in her stomach and stuck her chest out, but still kept herself concealed. Finn took an index finger to draw circles on the back of each of her hands where her nipples would be, taking his time, making Libby comfortable. He leaned forward, kissed the back of her injured hand, hooked his index finger under her two middle fingers and guided her hand away. Her pink-brown nipple was a hard bud pushed out from her tightened areola. When he leaned forward, Libby's eyes widened like saucers. Finn was still tentative, easing Libby into this, kissing her collar, then down to the topmost part of her breast. Then he was sitting again, guiding the other hand away to reveal the other breast. Libby's fingers curled around her thumbs, making awkward fists,

and she kept trying to bring them up to cover her nudity but was forcing herself to stay bare for Finn.

Finn brushed the back of a knuckle against one of Libby's nipples, and she hissed inward a deep breath. But her nipple responded, hardening further, and Libby arched her back to present her breasts now. Finn did the other one, too, sparking both nipples into succulent points.

The two of them came together, kissing again, hands exploring. Libby's went over Finn's shoulders and chest, and Finn stroked her neck, cupped her collar, down to thumb her nipples and coddle her hanging breasts. It got Libby moaning.

Ben watched as her hands dropped again into Finn's lap. He couldn't see what she did, but knew she was fondling between his legs—looking for that large thing that had excited her in Barrie.

Their lips came apart now with a bright smack and they eased away, looking in each other's eyes. Lib whispered, "Can I see it now?"

Finn nodded, bit his own lip and narrowed those dark black magician's eyes.

Libby made to undo his jeans' button but had trouble because of her sore hand. Finn took over, undoing the button and drawing down his zipper. Libby pulled the flap away, peeked into his jeans but couldn't see anything the way he was sitting. So now Finn had his hands behind him, changing position on the bed, getting beside her so his back was on the pillows. Libby touched Finn's muscles as he rested against the headboard, lifted his hips and shoved his jeans down. The guy didn't wear underwear, and in his lap a big thing jostled. It was a heap of soft flesh that jiggled and bounced against his leg. A long tube—the biggest penis Ben had ever seen—and a huge red-flesh sack stuffed with enormous testicles.

Finn pushed the jeans right down, pulled his feet out. Now he was naked.

They were side-by-side, shoulder to shoulder, both of them turning their faces, kissing, Libby caressing his neck with her uninjured hand. Finn stroked her breasts, and Libby's hand lowered into his lap...

LIB WAS the one who broke the kiss, scooting herself back and looking down between Finn's legs. Ben shifted in his seat, raising his butt up and sitting on the arm of the chair so he could see what she would do.

Libby stared at the huge manhood curled up in Finn's lap. She darted to Finn's eyes, biting on her lip, her cheeks and ears blazing red now. She chanced a look over Ben's way, and though his insides had frozen, and everything about this was wrong, he forced a supportive expression on his stone-chiseled face.

She licked her top lip, put her hand down and gathered up Finn's penis. Ben stiffened, his organs squished by the flexion of his entire body, a lungful of air sealed in the coffin of his ribcage.

Finn's huge soft penis squirmed around in Libby's grip, the thing way bigger than Ben's erection and it was flaccid. It folded and wrinkled, dangled in her grip as she hefted it and tried stroking. She set it down across his leg, cupped his testicles and tested their weight. Finn watched her face the whole time as Libby studied what he had.

Now it began to grow, and Libby scrolled her fingernails along its length, squeezing, tracing the ridge of his cock head with the tip of her index finger, scratching her nails under his scrotum, hefting it and stroking, somehow the whole while acting like she was still bashful. Finn's penis lengthened and thickened, the heavy thing gaining a life of its own, turgid straightness beginning to lift it from his hip bone. It was enormous. It was the one thing Chelsea wasn't lying about. It was the biggest dick he'd ever seen, and his timid wife's eyes were shocked wide.

When it was fully hard, sticking up out of his lap and leaning toward Libby, she sat back on her hip, traced hair behind an ear and looked at it. In a quiet Libby-mouse voice: “Will it hurt?”

Ben reeled; his Libby intended to go through with this all the way. Not just kissing and touching, but wanted another man’s arousal *inside* her body...

Finn said, “I’m going to be so gentle with you, Lib, I’m going to watch out for you. I’ll never hurt you. Do you have any lube?”

She shook her head no. “Ben’s condoms are lubricated.”

“Do you have coconut oil?”

She nodded. “In the kitchen.”

A voice said, “I’ll get it,” and Ben flinched. It was his *own* voice slipping out of him unbidden like some lusty refugee that had hidden in his wheelhouse now speaking up for him.

Libby looked to him, the glossy shine of sex reflecting wet in her eyes. He knew the look. Libby was ‘frisky’ as she liked to call it, but Ben knew that shine was more profound than the happy household shine she showed when with her husband. Libby was burning up inside but was scared. She whispered to him: “Yeah...?”

“Yeah, I’ll get it,” he said without hesitation, wondering how on earth it had come to this. This wasn’t absolution right now—he absolutely wanted to see Finn make love to his wife, knew it right down in his core below all the fleshy social-human parts of him grown soft with morals and sociological discipline; in his heart he wanted to see Lib have sex with a man who aroused her this way, one who looked like he could master his wife and caress all her launch buttons with his fingers and the fat bulb-end of his huge cock...

PART 3
STARLIGHT

BEN DARTED DOWN THE STAIRS, his feet like rapid fire on the steps. He bounded into the kitchen, yanked open the cupboard where he knew he'd find coconut oil. The jar snatched up and cradled in his underarm so he could give it some heat, he raced back up the stairs. He was gone only a minute, but when he returned to the bedroom, he found them laying on their sides on the bed, kissing and exploring, Finn untying Libby's pajama shorts, and Libby clumsily stroking that enormous dick.

He panted: "Hey, okay, I got coconut oil..."

Libby broke her kiss, head turning on the pillow while Finn sucked on her neck. She said, "Can you get me a condom?"

With mechanical stiffness, he nodded, said, "Uh-huh," whisking open the drawer on the night table on his side of the bed.

While he fumbled open the box, Libby asked Finn, "Do we need *bigger* condoms?"

Finn told her it would be okay, adding, "We'll figure it out as we go along."

Libby was still perplexed, her married brain looking to throw up some last-minute obstacles, saying, "Those are normal condoms—they're not going to be too tight?"

"It might be tight," Finn said, his tone soothing and confident while he stroked her cheek. Ben could tell his words excited Libby because her mouth hung open, and her eyes quivered as she stared back into Finn's gaze. "But we're going to take it easy the first time."

Libby said, "If it breaks..."

"I can pull out."

“I’m not on the pill.”

“Do you want to wait? Maybe we can get some condoms later...”

“I don’t want to wait,” she said. “I’m not on the pill but... you can come inside me.” Then adding, “If it’s an emergency...”

Finn smiled at how cute Lib was, how sexually innocent. “If it’s an emergency,” Finn agreed.

Ben tossed a torn-off condom packet onto the bed near his wife’s knees. He asked, “Can I turn on the light?”

“No, Ben,” Libby said.

“I just want to see...”

Finn said, “Can you pass the coconut oil, Ben?”

“Okay,” he said, snatching the jar off the night table and plopping it into Finn’s large held out hand.

Finn screwed off the top, dug out a smudge of coconut oil with two middle fingers. Eyes on Libby’s, he slipped the fingers under the front of her untied pajama shorts. Libby sang a fearful but excited song, her voice wavering as another man put his hand between her legs.

Ben watched the hump of Finn’s hand moving under the cotton, and Libby covered over with her own hand, hers resting atop his that was manipulating between her folds. Libby’s legs began to writhe; she rolled flatter on her back, her heels stroking up and down the mattress, and soon Finn had brought a sticky smacking sound from between his wife’s legs.

Ben grabbed his aching erection through his pants, sat back down on the arm of the chair. Libby bit her lip, watched her husband with a strange expression, fear again, then tucked thumbs into her pajama shorts, arched her back and lifted her butt off the mattress so she could push them down. It was revealed to Ben what Finn’s hand looked like against Libby’s pussy. His hand was big, covering the whole delta between his wife’s legs, all his fingers glistened and the two middle ones disappeared inside her opening.

Libby widened her open legs in the strangest, most vulgar display he’d ever seen from her. Her heels came together to touch and her knees went out like wings. Finn stroked her insides in a smooth and easy-going circle and Libby’s chest heaved up and down. She clutched her own breasts, held onto her nipples and Ben had never seen her like this before. Lib’s little pussy had never been exposed to him this way. And Finn had three fingers in her now; her juices teemed, shining on the insides of her thighs and right over Finn’s tattooed knuckles. Finn fucked her with three fingers and Ben’s

wife let him; not just allowed it, but responded to it, her hips humping against his penetration, her eyes watching Finn's face as he did it, her nipples like two bullets on her pillowy bosom.

Lib asked Finn again, "Is it going to hurt?"

"You're gonna be just fine, Lib," Finn told her in a low laconic drawl.

Lib bit her lip, looking down Finn's bare body, settling on that massive totem sitting upright in his lap. Her hand closed around it mid-shaft, squeezed, slipped northward and polished his cock head with the silvery lubricant pushed out. Her breaths came quicker.

"I want it," she whispered.

Finn unhooked the fingers from inside her, brought them up and rubbed circles where the bulb of her clit would lay. Libby moaned, hands forming fists and pushing down on her hipbones, her pelvis tilting to push her sex against the pressure of Finn's fingers. She mewled the sexiest sound Ben had ever heard—she'd never sounded like that with him. She kept it all hidden.

Finn slowed his teasing, his hand coming away to tear open the condom packet. He sat back in the pillows, chin tucked to his chest, removing the condom. Libby grabbed his cock, her fingers unable to close around it even near the head; she stroked him again, awkward and clumsy but so, *so* into it. She said, "Can I put it on?"

Finn nodded and smiled, rolled the condom down a half-inch then pinched the reservoir tip and held it above the head of his cock. Plopped over the urethra, Libby used two fingers on her injured hand and all the fingers on the other one to unroll the condom over Finn's girth. She unrolled the whole thing, struggling, and it ended just past the halfway mark.

Libby made an exclamation of breathy admiration: "Ho..." Surprised how her husband's size of condom fit another man.

FINN AND LIBBY faced each other on their sides, kissing, moaning, her stroking his condom-covered cock, Finn with his hands between Lib's legs again. Then he was rolling toward her and just as Chelsea had predicted, Libby was keen to get on her back. She rolled over, shoulder blades flat on the bed, heels together, legs opening to accept him, her good hand coming and grazing along Finn's back muscles and guiding him to get between her legs.

Libby cupped Finn's cheeks, looked in his eyes. They both stared into one another in this long heartbeat-moment, two lovers prepared to unite for the first time, both of them naked, both aroused and eager, Finn's huge cock a throbbing monument between their naked bodies. While Libby said she didn't trust Finn, something was communicated between them. A trustful rapprochement. *I know you might hurt my heart and I can't trust I'm not being manipulated but I want that thing between your legs deep inside my pretty little body and I want the pleasure I suspect you'll give me, and maybe I don't trust you but I do trust in this moment that you will be a good and careful lover and you won't hurt me...*

It was wilder than he could have imagined, Libby exposing herself in this way, submitting to Finn's plundering—and letting her lover *see* her so vulnerable. There was still timidity in her, a tentative tremble to her glistening eyes; they darted across Finn's body, up to his face, down to that glistening lubricated missile he would sink inside her. But there was an openness from her Ben had never witnessed himself. Even though Libby kept Finn's gaze—lips parted and staring into his eyes, trying to read everything he communicated—there was a new curious boldness to her. Her

hands stroked up Finn's waist and cupped the curve edges of the muscles that ran in thick straps behind his rib cage. Finn angled his hips, dipping low enough he could bring the corpulent head of his cock between Libby's legs. Libby's breath came quicker in anticipation, knowing she would be penetrated, knowing she would make love to a man who wasn't her husband, and knowing Finn's implement of reproduction was a frighteningly large one. And even though they were already looking in each other's eyes, Finn reminded in a low husky whisper, "Look into my eyes..."

Ben watched the bulb end of Finn's manhood probe and prod at the glistening nest of his wife's slick membranes. Watched that little opening of hers—that she'd never let him look at—as it gulped around the intrusion of a much larger man. Libby drew in a long whisking breath and her nails pushed into Finn's muscle. Finn tilted his chin, looking at her through narrowed eyes and she nodded for him. He eased deeper still, that girth pushing his wife's petals apart. Finn withdrew, Libby relaxed, he pushed in, she hissed and dug nails.

"It's okay?" Finn whispered.

Lib nodded, her eyes a little frightful.

Finn eased back, eased in, not too far, eased back again. They cocked their heads and locked each other's gazes, each of them took turns nodding, communicating only through their eyes, this larger man coaching his new lover to accommodate what she wasn't used to.

Now Ben had to rest a hand over his heart, feeling it beating wild and unleashed in his chest. All the truths were out. Everything was on the table, this didn't *have* to happen. He would do anything to prevent it—but he would do anything to witness it. So he dug fingertips into knees the way his wife did to her lover's back, gritted his teeth, tightened his stomach against the internal distress, and focused instead on the pounding arousal between his own legs. He watched Libby's face, the hardness of her nipples, her sweet hands caressing then alternately digging nails into Finn's back. Mostly he watched another man's huge arousal sink deeper with each thrust into his loving wife.

Soon there was a rippling crackle of the condom as Finn began to roll his hips forward and back, giving Lib about the length her husband had, only much thicker. Finn was only halfway in. Libby liked it, enjoying his girth, accommodating this guy who was stroking her with all her husband had at his most furious pounding depths.

Libby's chest rose and fell, her breaths became hissing gasps. Her hands caressed over his muscle, his shoulders, his back, down his sides, clenching the round humps of his round boy ass. Soon there was a desperate wheeze to Libby's gasping.

Libby whispered something finally, the first one to break the silence between them. The one who wanted something so urgently they couldn't risk mistranslation. "Deeper."

Finn groaned, gave her what she asked for.

Now her voice was a thin, souging whisper: "Ew, oh, ooh, it's good, it's really, really good..."

"Yeah, you like it?"

Lib nodded rapidly, thrusting the crown of her head into the center of the pillow.

Finn rolled his hips forward sucking in his stomach, the muscles rippling there. It pushed his cock deeper, and Libby slapped her thighs closed around his hips. The two of them rolled together, wriggling their hips, trying to make it fit. Ben could see how his wife's pretty pink opening was stretched.

Lib gasped, "Oh, wait..." Her nails dug into Finn's flesh.

Finn paused, tilted his face up to watch her. She made a wincing grimace as though she just suffered a profound cramp in her leg. Only it wasn't a cramp, at least not that kind, and she arched her back, slapping his hips with the pads of her fingers, saying, "Stay there, stay there, stay there, stay there," doing it in a hurried, passionate tone. "Don't move, mm, don't move, ah..."

Finn watched her, but Lib was closed off, eyes shut, neck tendons flexing, baring her teeth, responding to this large feel of a new man. Libby tapped him again, this time on the top curve of his ass muscles, saying, "Deeper..." And when Finn sunk forward, Libby squealed and squawked, locked her knees tighter on him. "Oh, God, oh, don't move, don't move, don't move..."

Lib's hands started to tremble and Finn eased her thigh outward by the knee as if he knew Ben wanted to see between their legs. And there it was, that enormous thing almost buried to the hilt inside his wife. Libby's reaction was profound. Her hands trembled on his back, her thighs began a tremor, and her toes curled; her face went flushed, her mouth stretched open

in a hollow scream, no sound came; her jaw worked up and down, clenching her teeth then yawning... She was coming.

They hadn't even fucked yet. Finn put that thing inside Libby and in half a minute she's under the thumb of a massive orgasm.

Ben's clawed hands tightened to fists, and he drummed them up and down on his knees as his wife's orgasm lingered. Her stomach heaved in and out. A greasy shine wetted Finn's bare shaft; the whole condom was inserted inside Lib, and Ben knew the rest of what Finn had was stretching out his wife's interior in a way that provoked this twisted pretzel of an orgasm.

"Oh, fuck," he hissed as another wave of revulsion washed over him. He thrust the first knuckle of his fist into his mouth and bit down, but still he couldn't take his eyes away.

Libby coughed and gasped, doing it in her sweet little way, her breasts shaking, her eyes closed. She made a loose fist with her good hand and covered her mouth then touched fingers to her throat as her eyes fluttered open, and she looked straight back into her lover's eyes—seeking them out...

NOW SHE HAD that powerful orgasm it was like some of that crusty shell that protected Libby cracked and peeled. She loosened under Finn, smiling now, that awed look of horror stretched to a happier shape. She was bashful still, embarrassed that she had that orgasm. Worried what Finn thought of that, not knowing what a guy would think. But Finn curved his back and kissed at her neck. Her hands spread on his chest, sandwiched between them, then worked up above his shoulders and hooked around his neck as their lips came together.

There he was, that lean lover of Lib's on top of her, his muscle beginning to gleam with a light sweat, all ten inches—if you believed Chelsea—almost fully inside his wife, her one leg spread so her husband could see the penetration, her hands hooked around her lover's neck, and now somehow an even greater sin: they kissed passionately.

Finn's hips began to roll again, and their kissing grew energy. Heads rocking, mouths sucking, when Finn would pull away Ben could see Libby's mouth wet, her lips swollen. Then Finn had his big fingers woven through her little ones, careful of her pinky, putting her arms above her head and Libby allowing it. Allowing her breasts to flop and bounce and roll in circles between them, allowing her legs to remain open so her husband could see.

It was wild—she was only a fraction more removed from Libby toward Chelsea but it was already almost more than he could bear.

The urge to whisk his pants down and masturbate next to them came on like a freight train, but he gritted his teeth against its force knowing he didn't want to be like that. So instead he leaned his butt against the dresser,

tightened forward, his body seized against the hurt, and continued to watch the adventure playing out on his bed.

Finn's intrusion grew more pronounced; the length of his stroke increased as well as the speed of the driving. That long, thick meat-pipe of his reamed Libby in and out, plunging her petals forward, pulling out a thin ring of her pink insides on its withdrawal, then rolling it closed again as he gored her deep.

Libby came again but neither of them stopped to admire it. They rolled right through it, not engaged in some ragged porn sex, but just the way Libby liked it: missionary, arms around, knees up. Finn knew it without being told (unless it came up during their coffee clutches, little Libby admitting to this guy she has a crush on that her favorite style is missionary).

Finn slowed; sometimes he would speed up; sometimes he would stop and let Libby feel him deep, then roll her hips in tiny circles the way she liked. It was back and forth, tit-for-tat, and they looked in each other's eyes way too much. Finn communicated a lot through those dark magic eyes, some sexual telepathy between him and Ben's wife. When it went on for almost twenty minutes—Libby having come (he was pretty sure) twice, maybe three times in that space—even he could tell Libby was becoming uncomfortable. She would make wincing faces, cute little nose tweaks, taps at Finn's hips to indicate he was too deep.

When Finn next locked Lib's eyes, he didn't need a word to communicate what he wanted. And Libby nodded. It was time.

Finn suspended himself like a bow above her, and Libby caressed his chest and looked in his eyes, knees coming up even higher, straightening her legs so her delicate little feet almost pointed toward the ceiling. Finn humped that thing in and out of her; the room had a heavy sex smell now. And in Ben's ears was that crinkling rubber sound as the size-stretched condom was squeezed between his wife's sweet but too-tight membranes, her gasps, the creak of the bed, a low masculine grunt from Finn that came with each thrust.

He knew what would happen, knew he should look away. But he didn't.

Both of them panted. Finn rocked his hips, and they were both nodding, liking what was happening. Finn fell over her; she kissed his mouth and gripped the back of his neck. He pulled his cock out of her with a slick sticky glug, pushed his hips forward so his thing slid across Libby's

quivering stomach. Her hand batted around for it, hooked a loose grip around the end and Finn humped his hips, pushing his huge cock through Libby's small squeezing grip.

Libby watched the condom-covered head pulsing through the ring finger and thumb, watched as Finn grunted and pulsed white jets into the condom's reservoir tip. Lib witnessed the end of another man's condom fill with his seed. She squeezed her grip on the cock head, slipped her hand up, pushed all of Finn's load into the tip and it dangled over the knuckle of her thumb. Then she began to twiddle it with her thumb and index finger, squishing at the hanging off dollop collected at the end of Finn's cock.

AS THE ORGASM began to drain from her, Libby's face became bashful again. There was a wash of shame in her eyes, too. Ben watched as her hands drawled down her body, and she eased herself out from under Finn who rolled to his side next to her. Her hands closed around bed sheets, gathered them, pulled them up to cover herself.

The way they lay was awkward, the bedding twisted, and she had to tug them to cover her breasts, leaving one bare leg sticking out, the inside of her thigh showing a sex-fluid gleam. She sucked on her own lips, pulled them inward and bit on them.

Finn got her to look at him and stroked hair out of her eyes. But Libby looked away, afraid to meet Finn's gaze now.

On her back, blinking, looking at the ceiling, Ben could see her darting glances his way.

"Hey," he mumbled.

She turned her face toward him, eyes wide, lips pulled in between her teeth. In a tuck, he crossed to the bed, pivoted and sat down on the edge, hiding his erection. He sat with her like she'd woken up with the early signs of a cold. He took her hand, cupped their palms together and ran his other hand over the back. There were no words he could come up with; he sat there trying to shape sounds with his mouth wriggling around. But he looked in her eyes, and there was a lifetime with her—they found a connection, and their black pupils poring into one another communicated so much. She pulled from him what she needed to know, he could feel a tension in her beginning to ease. He began to smile, and once it began it was unstoppable. He pulled her hand up to his mouth and kissed the back,

then leaned forward, kissed her mouth. She touched his neck while he sucked on her lips, but they kept their tongues to themselves. Her lips were in swollen shape, engorged by lust for another man and he didn't mind at all. When the kiss broke, he kissed the tip of her nose and her brow. He eased up, still hunched forward, backed his way to the corner of the bed and plopped down in the chair.

Finn's eyes were on Libby's profile as she watched down her body at her husband sitting near the foot of the bed having witnessed something so ludicrous, something never, ever that should happen with Libby. And yet it happened, and for some reason he felt like they were okay.

Finn guided her to face him, the two of them on their sides in the middle of the bed. He talked low, stroked her hair, and they spoke closely. She chuckled, tried to get away, and he stopped her, putting a spread-out hand to cover the center of her back and keep her close and facing. She pretended to struggle, then met his lips for a kiss. She climbed almost over him, cupped her hand to his ear and whispered him a secret.

Finn nodded, looking in her eyes and agreeing with what she communicated. He caressed her back and stroked her side as she sat up. Libby took bedsheets under her arms to cover herself, looked at Ben now. Again nothing was said, just a passing gaze at one another, him trying to be supportive, as crazy as that was. Then she pivoted at the hip, reached for the night table where there was the box of condoms. She snatched the one that had been torn off from the roll, then unwrapped it while Finn's hand beat up and down his cock underneath the sheets. When she turned, studying the condom she'd unrolled a half-turn in preparation, Finn pushed the sheets down and held his still-hard cock upright. Libby moved to put the condom on, and stopped to admire his erect penis for a moment, condom in her injured hand, the tips of her other fingers caressed the glans. She bit her upper lip, and like she couldn't take it anymore, sat straighter, took the condom and plopped it over the knob end. She tried to use two hands but was clumsy with her broken finger, so Finn helped her, going hand-over-hand, rolling the condom down his shaft.

A slick snappy splitting sound accompanied the sight of the condom giving way—there one second, peeled back the next, Finn's cock head still ensconced, the condom's ring circling mid-shaft, but the dark, meaty belly of his fat cock bulging through a slash in the latex.

“Whoops,” Libby whispered, then chuckled. She rolled the broken condom northward and removed it. She turned toward Ben, made a funny, sheepish face then tossed the tattered rubber to the bedroom floor.

Ben was already up, moving to the nightstand and tugging off a condom packet, tearing it open, unrolling the greasy rubber a turn and handing it to Lib with a shaky hand. The whole while he’d prepared a prophylactic for his wife he could see her studying him in her periphery. She must certainly be puzzled to see her husband with his trouser fronts bowed out with an erection and willfully preparing a condom for her to use with another man. She’d peeked at him, mouth hidden, eyes cast over her shoulder, a hand stroking on her own arm. Finn had watched as well, stretched out on the bed, keeping his cock hard with an easy stroking.

She whispered a soft ‘thank you’ to him, and now armed with a fresh and hopefully more durable condom, Lib showed Ben her back again and rolled down the rubber on Finn’s held out torpedo. To Finn, she said, “We’re going to have to get bigger condoms...”

They shared a breathy chuckle while Lib successfully protected Finn’s manhood for re-entry, then Finn was hooking an arm around her middle, pulling her, and Libby instinctively gave him her back. He hugged her against him, his dick between them, Libby drawing up her knees. She gathered up sheets, whisked them over her legs and hips, her eyes giving a timid and brief glance his way. Finn dipped, and Libby looked over her shoulder down at where he would slide inside her under the bedding. When they connected, they both slowed, Libby going still. She pulled her whole lower lip into her mouth, and as Finn pushed deeper, her mouth fell open and she let out a low moan.

“That’s so big, that is so, *so* big...”

“It’s good?”

“It’s good, yeah, it’s really, really good...”

His hips rocked. “Like that?”

“Oh, yeah,” she gasped, head falling forward then snapping back, her shut eyes turned up to the ceiling.

Finn slid deeper, and Libby settled onto the mattress. He put an arm around her and she snuggled it against her chest under the bed sheet.

That was what she’d whispered. She wanted it like spoons. That was her thing, and now she was sharing it with another man. It was what she wanted. She would only ask for it from her husband when she was at her

neediest. And even at her neediest, she was a timid little mouse. But Finn lured her out of her mouse hole, out into the light...

They writhed together under the bedding, hips rolling, Finn pushing in and out of her, Libby's knees opening and closing, lifting higher, her hand stroking over his hip sometimes. She kissed him over her shoulder, but mostly let her face rest in the pillow, eyes closed, mouth open, facing toward her husband while she was fucked like spoons from behind.

AS THEIR PASSION built once more, Libby breathed heavily, gasping almost; she hooked an arm out of the bedding to cup Finn's cheek as they kissed. Their hips rolled and bumped against each other, Finn pushing deep, maybe not too deep this time, feeding off Lib, communicating now with her tongue in his mouth. And as they came closer to orgasm, Finn pulled the covering, his muscular arm straightening and snapping away the sheet like a vampire's cape and revealing how he was fucking Ben's wife. She wiggled against him, her little bottom going in circles, his huge cock up in her pussy.

Without Finn urging her, Libby began to open her own knees, her right leg levitating upward until it pointed to the ceiling. There between her legs, Ben could see her furry little snatch getting pummeled; wide open and bared, her little vulva getting mushed around, that wide, glistening thing pushing in and out of her slim pink glove, the labia flipping up and down snagging on his size.

She began to gasp and pant. Libby came first, shouting out in a hoarse hurrah, her head snapping back as she melted into Finn who folded an arm around her and gripped her neck.

It was Finn's turn now, Ben's wife still riding out the previous orgasm. He pounded himself into her, his big balls bouncing around against the inside of Libby's thigh. And then when it was time—he bucked into her hard. Once, twice, *three* times, each one dragging a moment longer until he pushed himself deep enough to make Lib squawk, then held himself there. His balls rolled around in their sack then drew up close to the shaft, one flexing higher than the other as those orbs pulsed their contents inside Libby.

A horrible thought rolled over the inside of his skull: Finn's size had split this condom like the last one, and another man had just loosed his reproductive product inside his wife. He was at once aghast and goatish. His mouth went dry and his heart pounded throbbing beats in his temples while he imagined all that goo spreading into her pink folds so close to her cervix.

Finn stayed inside her, both of them breathing heavy, panting against each other. He had an arm underneath her, the other one folded over her middle, and Libby gripped his two middle fingers and milked them while she still came. She gasped for breath, and Finn took her mouth with a kiss. Ben watched it all in the dim light from the window. Watched as his wife and her lover were comfortable, Libby held in this other man's arms.

Their breaths deepened, their eyes stayed closed.

It was agonizing seeing them fall asleep together. It was tender and sweet, and part of him adored it. But the *man* part of him didn't want it at all. This was the way it would be, though, and that *bad* man inside him would win out. So he sat there in the chair, his own erection like a cattle prod in his lap, watching this other man holding his wife, watching as that man's huge erection began to wane, still inside Libby, began to deflate, began to pull out of her body. The condom emerged, his long penis bowed almost in half and slipped right out of Libby and lay over the inside of her thigh. Ben's own semen began to leak from him, and without touching himself at all, his stomach muscles tightened... and try as hard as he could, he wasn't able stop it from happening: semen pulsed and spurted from him, drawing a large darkening globe on the front of his fly. It kept coming, and now he was panting, sitting there with his hands clutched on the chair arms, teeth gritting, looking at another man's penis draped over the inside of his wife's leg.

"Oh, my God," he panted, "oh, my God..."

His head fell forward, and he almost collapsed out of the chair with an enormous relief.

While they still slept, he made his way to the bathroom where he cleaned himself, then into the walk-in closet to get on some fresh PJ pants. When he was done, and the light flicked off, he paused at the door. It was sensible to go to the guest-room, or he could go lay on the couch in his office, perhaps one of the couches in the family room.

He wanted to be close. So instead, he eschewed the comforts of being horizontal, put himself back in the upright chair near the foot of their bed and folded his arms around a pillow.

Libby had pulled the sheet up to cover themselves again, but they were both asleep. He watched them together, somehow happy for her. And despite the adrenaline that had raced through him while witnessing the concupiscent events, it had dumped itself out now, and in minutes he was asleep.

IN THE MIDDLE of the night he found himself under a swath of starry blue summer dark, standing on the spot where this had all began: the balcony outside of his office. He gazed out over the treetops toward the lake and watched the dancing moonlit waves.

What he'd witnessed tonight still churned; a vast oceanic current stormed through him, stirred up his sand and silt, uncovered ancient buried treasure and the ghosts of rotting ships. It would take time for the waters to still, for the kicked up flurry to settle anew. Then he could surmise this new landscape.

There was a strange thought within him: what if he'd brought this storm? What if his actions, his reduction of resolve when faced with Chelsea, could be akin to a shaman performing a rain-dance? Sure, it was obvious to any red-blooded male that Chelsea was a beautiful and sexy woman. But he'd always loved Libby. Truly loved her. What if the trigger of his infidelity had *always* been a way to shake sexual chaos in his life? Refusing Chelsea's advances wasn't impossible despite her claims of irresistibility. Did he surrender to sexual anarchy hoping to stir up a dirty sandstorm that would engulf him and Libby? There was no way to know for sure, but there were two truths: one, he loved Lib and would never want to hurt her by cheating, and, two, watching her with Finn was the wildest thing he'd ever seen. Despite the hurt it conjured, so much blatant pleasure kicked up around that hurt in strange harmony.

But maybe that was the shiniest coat of paint he could apply. The truth was he'd cheated on Libby and hurt her.

A soft click behind him had him jumping, and he spun around. Inside his office there was movement in the dark, a figure coming his way. His scalp tingled and blood whooshed. But it was Libby. Blue-gray night time light fell over her soft feminine shapes as she came near his open door. The last person to cross the threshold this way was Chelsea, just three weeks ago. Chelsea brought disaster, what would Lib bring now?...

As she came out into the light with her robe on, he began to formulate defenses for why he'd want to see her with another man, trying to come up with ways to explain how what just happened in their marriage bed was all right... But as a hasty framework for his defensive arguments began to form, she surprised him with an apology...

IN THE STARLIGHT he could see Libby was crying. It shattered him, and as he put out his arms to receive her, she fell into him. He folded her in a hug and kissed her head. Her body was hot, the heat coming through her thick robe, the fluffy terry material smooth against his palms as he rubbed circles on her. He'd done this. It was him. He'd broken the sanctity of their marriage and put Lib in a position where she believed sleeping with Finn would make things equal. And he'd told her he wanted it. Now it was done, and her heart was breaking.

"Lib, don't cry."

"I'm so sorry, Ben."

"It's okay."

"I am, I'm so, so sorry..."

He reassured her. "I wanted it, I wanted it..."

Now she began to sob. She balled a fist under her chin, and tears dripped on his skin. "Not that," she said

"Not what? Not sorry for what?"

"Finn."

"Not sorry about Finn?" He had trouble understanding. The words stumbled from her lips.

"I'm just so sorry."

"You're not sorry for what happened with Finn?"

She sniffled, withdrew from him so they could look at each other. Her brow was low, she said, "Should I?"

"No, Lib... No, I just said I don't want that. I told you to... I don't even know why... I don't—"

“It’s not that.”

“What then?”

Mouth paused open, her wide and innocent eyes trembled. A new wash of sadness swelled, and she fell against him again and hid her face in his neck. “I’m so, so sorry...”

“What is it?” he said, gripping above her elbows, holding her tight.

She said in hesitating chugs: “I ch-huh-cheated on y-you...”

The moment had been tender, and he’d wished to extend to her the greatest comfort he could offer. But now she’d thrown a punch he didn’t see coming. He was flabbergasted, heart pounding. “What do you mean?”

She bawled, “Rah-Ronnie...”

His breath heaved out of him in a greasy wave. “You cheated on me with Ronnie?”

Instead of an answer, she sobbed, shaking in his arms.

He slunk his arms tighter around her. “Are you serious?”

“I’m so bad.”

“You’re not bad at all, Lib. What happened?...”

“In high school, I... I cheated on you...”

“What Chelsea said was true?” His voice had risen high and tense. He wanted to comfort her—not even sure her teenage infidelity affected him. It was so long ago. They’d broken up; they spent a year apart; they were *married* now...

“Kind of,” she said

“What do you mean kind of?” She didn’t answer, crying against his neck in soft chugs. “Lib, come on, look at me...”

He guided her back, but she wouldn’t look at him. Her face ran wet with tears, reddened, scrunched up. He touched her chin, guiding her to look his way.

She snuffled, wiped her nose with the back of her hand, said, “It’s true,” then blubbered more. She looked to fall against him but he braced her.

“Don’t, Libby, come on and tell me...”

“Do I have to?”

“What do you mean *Do you have to*?”

“I don’t want to...”

“What—tell me the details?”

The redness of her face deepened, and she nodded her head, her features tightening further.

“You have to tell me, Lib. Did you have sex with Ronnie?”

“No,” she said, voice so thick it struggled to get out of her mouth.

“You didn’t?”

She shook her head no again.

“Then what’s wrong?”

“Because I know I cheated on you,” she said, voice steadier but so soft it was a whisper.

“What did you guys do?”

“Oh, no, Ben,” she sighed, her body slumping.

She looked to hide away, and he braced her again, holding her out at half an arms length. “Libby, tell me...”

“Fingers,” she mumbled thickly.

“He fingered you?”

The vulgarity of his words hurt her. She cried again, hid her face in her hands. He guided them away, persisting with this. Enough was enough, she had to stop trying to escape.

“Libby, I’m not mad. I’m not mad at all, just tell me...”

HER HEAD ROLLED AROUND on her neck. “Fingers, Ben,” she said, a rising anger in her voice.

Deep down, he figured it wasn’t directed at him; it was rage against herself. Mad at what she’d done so long ago. “It was eight years ago, Lib.”

“I cheated on you,” she said

“That’s all that happened? Ronnie... he did what?... Did he put a finger inside you?”

She nodded.

“Libby, you have to stop crying. It’s okay, listen to me, are you listening?—It is o-kay. Got it?”

She nodded, and the tremble in her breath softened. She sniffed and wiped at her nose again. He said, “That’s all?”

“Me, too,” she said.

“You, too, *what?*”

She made a disgusted sound and slumped again.

“*Me*, too, Ben...”

“What does that mean *Me, too*—you, too, *what?*”

“Me on him,” she said.

“Tell me, Lib. You can use dirty words with me. God, I just watched you...” He couldn’t continue. It was so strange, because while he loved her so much and they had an active sex life, there was a certain primitiveness to their behavior in the bedroom. She never swore around him, and he took it easy around her. They kept their sex a modern-day PG. They had fun, but pushed away eroticism. And despite what he’d watched her do a few hours ago in their bed with another man, they seemed back to square one, stuck in

a stiffness of verbal communication where their dirtiest words were kept back. He was direct: "Libby, did you use your hand on him?"

She nodded.

"You did? Did you give him a hand job?"

She nodded again. Her eyes were wide and fearful and glistening in the nighttime light.

He eyed her steadily. "That's okay."

"It's okay *now*," she said whispered. "It wasn't okay then."

"But what does it matter, Lib? It *is* okay now. I mean it. You got away with it."

That made her lips wriggle; she didn't like what she heard. "I didn't want to get *away* with it, Ben," she said. "I didn't want that. I shouldn't have *ever* done it."

"No, you shouldn't. But look where we are now." He'd intended the fact they were married and living together, but the statement concluded the actual here and now where she'd just had sex with Finn Slade. He was quick to steer away the direction of the talk. "Don't you think we're going to be okay?" He'd felt like they were, but as the question escaped his lips he wished he could snatch it back before she took the opportunity to tell him she didn't. But she nodded.

He repeated: "Do you think we're okay?"

She nodded again more firmly now. He brought her in for a hug.

It felt so good to have his little Libby in his arms; she was soft against him, yielding. "You didn't have sex with him?"

"No, Ben, I swear I didn't. It was... He didn't put his *thing* inside me."

"Do you swear?"

"I swear, Ben, I swear, please, believe me, I know I lied to you, I know..."

"I lied to you, too..."

"I lied because I love you, Ben. Well... hid the truth, I suppose..."

"And that's all that happened? You guys used your hands on each other?" Her chin nodded against his collar. "So it was like Chelsea said? You and Ronnie after the yearbook meeting?"

Libby sniffed, said, "Yeah. He was on the committee because the principal made him. His marks weren't so great, but he had all those sports he played and the guidance counselor said if he did something helpful it would benefit his application."

“He didn’t fit in with you guys.”

“He didn’t do *anything* to help with the stupid yearbook,” she said.

“And then after a meeting?... ”

“I don’t know how it happened, Ben. Ronnie was persistent and he... he talked me into it...”

“Into what?”

“I used my hand on him, and he... he put his...”

“What?... ”

“He put fingers in me.”

“Did you touch his body?”

She said she did, nodding.

“Did you like his body?”

No words this time, but she was still nodding.

“That’s okay. He had lots of muscle.”

“I hated myself.”

“Did he...” He tried to gesture to make his question clear but even doing that might be too vulgar for her and he had to use the words: “Did you make him come?”

Her chin dipped low, and she whispered, “He did.”

“Not like Chelsea said—not on your face?”

“No way, Ben. He did it...”

“Tell me...”

“Just regular.”

“In your hand?”

Nods, “In my hand, and you know, on his lap and his stomach...”

He sighed, a heaviness across his shoulders and yet a paradoxical lightness to his being. Like it was working, Chelsea’s magic wand had waved across them and the spell was taking effect. Honesty was repairing them, making them whole. Lib had burdened a tryst for far longer than him. He chuckled lightly.

“Don’t laugh.”

“I love you, Libby. More than anything.”

“I love you, Ben.”

The lightness was lifting him. “Did he have his shirt off?”

“Yeah.”

“Did he make a muscle for you?”

Libby didn't laugh despite the smirk on his face, instead she looked aside and showed shame. "He did."

"It's okay, Lib. I wanted you to laugh."

"It wasn't funny, Ben."

"It was kind of funny."

"Not what you said. Being with him. Doing the things I did with him. It's not funny."

"I knew it. You had panties with bananas on them."

"I can't believe you remember that."

"Of course I do, Lib. None of it matters, baby. It was so long ago. I love you so much."

"Do you?"

"I do, Lib. I love you more than anything. I don't care what happened then, I only care that you're with me now."

"You're not going to leave me?"

"Are you going to leave *me*?"

"No," she cried.

"I'm not leaving you."

A sigh escaped her, and the circumference of her rib cage decreased in the circle of his arms. He tightened them against her, held her close and felt throbbing love in the circle of their embrace.

But the love began to shake with renewed crying from Lib. Close to his ear, she breathily whispered, "What about... what about what I... mm-did tonight... with Finn...?"

THE HUG he held her in tightened further. “It was...” He struggled to frame it with words; the emotions were large and nebulous.

“Oh, no,” she whined.

“No, Lib, it’s okay,” he soothed. “I don’t know why, but it is.”

“I don’t know why either,” she whispered.

“How was it?... for you...”

She shrugged in his embrace. “I don’t know.”

“You don’t know what I mean?”

“No,” she said, “I know what you mean.”

“So tell me...”

“I’m afraid—I don’t know what you want to hear.”

“Libby, starting now, I want to know the truth. Maybe this will make us better. Can you believe that?”

“Maybe,” she said, stepping back and looking aside.

“Hey,” he said, “don’t be sad.”

“I can’t help it.”

“Are you okay with what happened?”

She frowned, asked, “With you?” There was the slightest sting of venom in her voice. She’d misconstrued what he asked her, thinking now of him and his infidelity. She was still not okay with Chelsea. *She didn’t even know about Neve.*

He said, “With you, Lib, with you.”

“It was okay,” she said, leaving something hanging in the air. “But...”

“But what?”

“You watched me.”

“Yeah, I did.”

Her big eyes came his way. “And you wanted to watch me?”

He nodded. “I did.”

Brow furrowed, she said, “How can’t you hate me?”

He wanted to ask how come she didn’t hate him but didn’t want to bring up Chelsea. And the argument there was: she didn’t *watch* him with Chelsea. Perhaps if she had *watched* him with Chelsea and seen that there was another woman involved, she wouldn’t quite be so okay as she seemed to be right now. Perhaps she would be sitting on a B.C. bound plane trying to figure out how she would break Neve’s nose with her one remaining good hand. So he decided to be forthcoming.

“Can I tell you the truth?”

She nodded.

“Libby, it was awesome, I guess. It was really, really awesome.”

“Seeing me with Finn—how?” she said, puzzled.

“I love you so completely. And seeing you like... *that* makes me happy—and the happiness is enough to push down everything else inside me that hurts. When I watched you I was mad and so, *so* incredibly jealous, but what I was seeing was too beautiful to stop.”

“It’s not with you. I’m with... *him*...”

“I don’t know why I feel like that, Lib. You asked me a year ago how I would feel about this I would’ve lost my shit. I would’ve smashed something on the ground. Watching you tonight made me cherish you more.”

“You’re crazy,” she said wonderingly.

“Don’t call me crazy, Lib.”

“I don’t mean *crazy*,” she said, eyes falling downward.

“I don’t get it either, Lib, but I want you to know that if you had a good time, I’m happy. *That’s* what I want. I liked watching. You look so good...”

“Get out of here,” she whispered. It was the sort of breathy castigation that arrived with a certain playful curiosity. Like she didn’t want to accept the words, but she also wanted to hear more. He gave her more.

“I guess you don’t know how beautiful you are.”

“I don’t.”

“Well, that’s all right, because I do. And Finn sure does too.”

She sighed a slight groaning sound. Like she’d wanted to say something but was biting her tongue. He tried to imagine what it could be. He’d

mentioned Finn. Was it the sound of his name? The mention of her capable and well-equipped lover made her want to growl, and she'd subdued it in front of her husband. What was she about to say?—*he's so hot...*

The notion aroused him. "It's true, Libby. I want to watch you again and again."

She hugged him now, her hands went around his back and her nails bit into him. "You do?"

He whispered, "You can if you want to."

It was almost imperceptible, but he was sure her chin dabbed up and down against his collarbone. "Is that a yes? Do you want to? You don't have to..."

"I don't know..."

"I'm not going to make you, Lib—maybe there was a time when I figured if you slept with Finn it would make me feel better about... *you know...* That seems like ancient history. Seems like it was somebody else's thoughts. Now all I can think about is you."

She squeaked, "Yeah?"

"Yeah."

"I guess that's nice," she said.

"Sure it is," he said. "You make me feel so good. I couldn't imagine you not being around."

"Why would you want to imagine that?"

"I don't want to," he laughed. "I'm not trying to imagine it. I'm just telling you you mean everything to me."

"Okay," she said, pushing herself off him. She stood now looking like a white terry bear with two sexy legs sticking down below. Her arms were folded around her big and shapeless robe plumped around her beautiful body. She really didn't know how good she looked. She wiped at her cheeks, folded her arms again, pretty face turned down and sad.

He said, "Well, here we are."

"Here we are," she repeated.

"I love what happened tonight, Libby. I hope Finn was good to you and I hope you enjoyed it as much as it looked like to me." He expected her to recoil from that dirty suggestion but she didn't. He took it as an approval. Finn *had* done great things to her. Wasn't debatable, anyway. Her reactions—her *orgasms*—had been proof. "If you don't want to do it, that's good. If you want more, I'm here. You can do it."

“You don’t want Chelsea?”

He held her arms. “You’re all I want.”

Her face tightened, and she stared holes into his chest, not seeing him, but looking beyond, maybe into the future and how this would change their lives. She sniffed again, wiped her face one more time. “I’m going back to bed.”

“I’m coming with you.”

At the threshold of the office door, two of them passing through the opening, she said, “Ben...”

“What?... tell me...”

“No...”

“Is there more? Ronnie...?”

“Oh, no, not that...”

“Well, then tell me...”

She turned, and they were very close, him looking down on his beautiful wife’s eyes, shining wet in the blue dark. “I want to be good in bed.”

He said, “You are...”

“Not really...”

“I love being with you.”

“But I want you to... be excited.”

“I’m excited to be with you.”

She sighed, looked down before looking back up with a measure of resolve. “I want to be the kind of girl a guy like you couldn’t keep his hands off no matter *how* he knows he shouldn’t.”

“You want to be like Chelsea.”

“I want you to want me the way you want Chelsea.”

“Lib, I want you *more* than her, don’t be crazy.”

“I’m not crazy, Ben. I won’t call you crazy if you don’t call me crazy.”

“Okay. You’re *wrong* if you think I want Chelsea more than I want you. I’m exactly where I want to be.”

PART 4
LIFT LOCK

WEDNESDAY, JULY 17

A STEELY MONUMENT to morning wood everywhere was what roused him. He woke wincing from the most uncomfortable and turgid erection he could muster. His hand went down, pushed on it and found it almost immobile. When his eyes opened, he was laying in his bed with his wife facing him. Libby slept peacefully. Exhausted, probably. Years long strife released, a secret burden she had borne let go. And hours of deep, penetrative—and from what he gathered—very rewarding sex. Her brow held no trouble. Finn's magic oversized equipment had pushed his wife into some state of ataraxia. Eyes gently closed, no R.E.M. movement, Libby in the deepest of good-sex sleeps, her brow smooth and fine, the eyebrows raised slightly. Her pouting lips even poutier, looking softly engorged after a night of kissing with another man. And that other man was behind her.

Libby and Finn lay like spoons, and Ben's wife was Finn's little spoon right now. She was on her side, a gentle curve to her spine, and the man that had made love to her in astounding ways last night kept tight against her. The bedsheets were gathered, but Libby's shoulder was bare. Finn's arm draped over her, his fist gathered at her chest. Where the white sheet crossed his wife's bosom, the top crescent of a nipple was revealed. Libby's hand was at her chest, too, loosely gathered fist around Finn's large thumb. Libby had well-formed little fingers, cute little digits he loved. They curved around this other man's masculine big-boned hand. There were little designs below each of Finn's knuckles, and a tattooed face on the back of his hand; some dark-eyed musician, a rock star, Ben thought maybe that guy from T. Rex.

It was a sweet sight and yet devastating. What she had done with Finn last night she had never done with her husband. She had never opened herself up to him that way. And there was never a time when Ben had taken Libby that way. Nor could he. The things Finn had done to her were out of Ben's capabilities. When he bored his eyes into Libby's, there was no dark sexual intensity, only love and a lifetime together. A soft caring love not duplicated when she looked into Finn's eyes. No, Finn's black-rimmed necromancer's eyes did different things to Libby. Things he probably wouldn't understand, but boy did he want to. If he could just get past that surface hurting. It protected Libby's outer core like a force-field, but he wanted to push through, get inside this awful hurting barrier and put his arms around the woman he loved. It might take time.

He slipped from the bed, easing his butt out first, getting his feet on the floor and standing without disturbing either of them. Wonder of all wonders, he had an appointment today he had to keep. If he wanted to make 60K flipping this boat over, he would have to drive to Peterborough today to meet with the real sailor who would venture forth with his small yacht and put it in safe hands. And get him the rest of his money. The man he pretended to meet when Dorchester was playing.

At the foot of the bed he studied them a little longer. Looking at his sweet wife cuddling up against this man who had rocked her world last night. This caring man who'd probably been the most noble amongst the three conspirators despite having the most nefarious task—seducing sweet Libby into opening her legs, coaxing and goading Ben's wife into accepting his large member inside her body. Like Chelsea had said, it took a lot of work to get there but now it was done.

Every urge to stay was clawing at him, urging him back into his bed. Wake up with them, get them to do it again, get it out of their system, be here with her, don't leave them alone together...

But then he would have images of the night he'd spent with Chelsea and Neve, the things he had done with those girls. And if restoration was what he really wanted, he knew what he had to do. He would have to trust Libby. While it was crazy to leave your wife in bed with a man you hardly knew, Finn proved himself to have Libby's best interests at heart. For whatever reason, he felt she was in good hands. So he slipped into the bathroom, doused himself under a quick soapy shower and silently dressed in the walk-in closet.

Once attired, he slipped into the bedroom again and faced that paradoxical hurt. Part of him wished they'd been awake, the other part knew he deserved to experience a day away from Libby when she was in the arms of this man. His knuckles aimed to rap on the wall but he stopped. What was he gonna do—knock and rouse them, ask them if they needed anything, let them know he would be out most of the day? *Just let them be. Let Libby find out who she is...* Who knows where this may lead?

Could lead to divorce court. You could come home and find out how she packed a bag and her and Finn were off to Mexico on that big burly motorcycle of his, Libby clung to his back as the wind whipped her silky hair; her hand would drift down and she would rest it on the large bulge between Finn's legs, cheek pressed to his back, counting down the minutes till they pulled into a motel...

Now he smiled, because he loved her. Her revelation last night set the wheels of their mining cart back on the track and they were ready to enter the tunnel again looking for ore...

Out of the bedroom, he slipped into his office. Going through his drawers, he found what he was looking for. He'd sold six luxury Mercedes V12s in the winter he shipped to Laos. The folder where the documents had been stored was red colored manila. Paperwork gathered and bound with elastics, put back in the drawer, he took the manila folder and with a pair of scissors cut it in the shape of a heart. It was small, the whole thing the size of his spread out hand. With a Sharpie, he scrawled a missive from his own heart meant for the woman he loved.

Slipping back into the bedroom, he watched them sleep together for another moment, eased back the sheet, revealed the hand that wasn't gripping Finn's thumb curled on the bed. He could see she was naked, could see her fluffy little woman-part between her closed legs. And then an awful gut punch: Finn sported morning wood as well. Only his monster grew outward between Libby's thighs, the big swollen army helmet poked out just below Libby's mound.

He grimaced, tightened his stomach, felt an unnatural swelling in his own underwear. He rolled the red construction paper a little tighter, slipped it in her loosely closed fist, careful of her finger, bent down and kissed her thumb.

Now he was walking backward, again watching them, neither of them rousing, sleeping peacefully. When Libby woke, she would find her lover's

huge organ erect for her. They would probably make love first thing. But he hoped before Finn slid his manhood inside his wife, Libby would open her hand, unfurl his paper heart and read that she was truly the light of his life.

SURE, he told Libby he didn't really *like* Dorchester. Truth was, to him, Dorchester was kind of a nerdy band. One that Libby would listen to, his innocent girl (or at least he thought—maybe she'd gone home and cranked Tom's Everglades and pogo-danced around her room after she'd jerked off and been finger-blasted by muscular bad boy Ronnie). Dorchester was a safe band picked by good girls, and they didn't exude that nefarious rockstar image. They were *real* musicians. And, yeah, perhaps he coincided them with that evening he got sick from eating vomited fish on rice. But all the way to Peterborough, almost two hours on the 401, he blasted the Circus Siblings album. The one released in their first year of college. Just at the end of the year, when he and Libby had reunited. When they'd come back together. What an awesome time. He spent a year apart from her, got to know some other girls, got more experience under his belt and realized the only thing that would fill his heart was his Libby Sanders. So with Dorchester cranked on ten, happy tears in his eyes, he forged through the bumper-to-bumper city traffic, letting the big V8 out once they rolled past Pickering, blasting all the way up north on the 115 to the city of Peterborough.

The young man he would meet today claimed to be a boat expert. He was staying with a friend in a houseboat on the Otonabee River. Ben parked his truck at a Harvey's then strolled Peterborough's boardwalk, emerging in a wide open bend in the river where a houseboat was moored outside of a Holiday Inn with an outdoor restaurant. He was walking backwards as he approached the houseboat, looking at a grassy field in the crook of the river's elbow. Just a month ago, this was where Finn would have been,

Cooter performing on the grassy stretch out by the spurting civic fountain. While Finn was tending to the band with the dirty name, Ben Todd was back in T.O. banging Chelsea and Neve.

With his hands in his pockets, he advanced on the walk, coming up alongside the big old houseboat. Knuckles rapping on the fiberglass barrier around the boat's swimming dock, he shouted out, "Permission to come aboard..."

THE CONTRACT PAPERWORK for the yacht piloting took about two-and-a-half hours to complete. They'd hung out in the boat's kitchenette, Ben, Gerd the sailor, a young man from up north, and the owner of the houseboat, a shaggy-haired, bearded guy called Karl. The place stunk like weed. It was littered with maps and empty beer bottles and adventure paperbacks. Both the guys wore Birkenstocks. But sitting with them and talking, he found Gerd was trustworthy—a disciplined Dutch-Canadian kid who knew his stuff (and he'd already been checked out by a private investigator Ben hired to make sure the kid was on the up-and-up).

When the paperwork was done, he was starving. The three of them disembarked the houseboat and ate in the outdoor restaurant while a blues band played. He flip-flopped while he ate. *Should I stay or should I go?* He drank two beers with his meal. Every once in a while he would almost jump out of his seat, looking to gather his things and tell Gerd and Karl he had to get going. But he forced a calm on himself.

Just stay... Just stay...

It was tough, but he made it through the meal without losing his shit. After the meal was cleaned away, he paid for the whole thing on his company credit card and bid hasty goodbyes with hard handshakes, curt head nods, feeling all his resolve crumbling away...

Soon as he was behind the wheel of his pickup again, his foot got stone-heavy on the pedal and he did almost a buck-fifty the whole way from Peterborough down to the 401, desperate to get home, desperate to be with his wife...

IT WAS ALMOST four o'clock when he got home. Pulling into the driveway he flinched seeing Finn's bike still there. When he'd left this morning, he'd walked the bike away from his bumper so he could back out. He'd left it to the side, the front wheel touching the grassy garden on the edge of their walkway. But now the bike was up sideways at the front, almost at the house. It had been used today. Ben pictured Libby hunched over Finn's back as they raced around town, Libby getting a thrill, getting excited, getting her heart racing...

At least they'd left room for him to park—it was good to be welcome in your own home.

Out of the truck, he stood in the driveway and looked up at the dark windows of his house. The neighborhood was alive with the sound of yelling summer voices, kids playing, and the distant cheers of a volleyball game at the beach. But who knew what he would find once he entered. He was sure it would be incongruous with the sweetness of the outside world right now.

He opened his front door and entered without saying anything, wanting to catch them in the act.

The house smelled different. A dank humidity he assumed must be sex funk. Sure enough, when he ventured deeper into the belly of his home, he found the first evidence.

In the family room, by the couch, a used condom lay on the floor—tied off, but filled with a big load. He studied the latex snake. Fully rolled out, the outside was surely slick with his wife's interior. He poked at it with his toe and made it squirm. Then he saw another one. Another used condom lay

under the coffee table. This one not tied off. Maybe hastily pulled free. And then, to support this theory: drying marks on the coffee table that had to be semen.

He sat down heavily on the couch, head oscillating from the condom under the table to the condom on his right-hand side. His gaze lingered on the semen splashes.

Then, on the TV screen, an even bigger violation. The Netflix menu showed a prompt. *Continue watching episode seven...?* He and Libby had only re-watched up to episode six. Libby had watched Game Of Thrones with another man. *A million things to watch, she has to pick Game Of Thrones?...*

He chuckled that this was what bothered him. But it did. Dirty dishes littered the coffee table, too, bestriding the semen marks. There was pizza crust. *They went out to get pizza or something?*

In the kitchen, he found takeout bags from Casa Mia. A cardboard box with one remaining slice of pizza, a plastic container whose label told him it had contained pasta e fagioli, and another labeled tiramisu. His stomach turned over again. Carb foods. They had to replenish the glycogen they'd exhausted from their fuck muscles. Poor kids.

He curled his hands over the cold edge of the sink and hissed inward with startling pain. He gritted his teeth to fight against it. *This was you. This was your doing...*

Deep down, part of him wanted this. Hard as it was to believe, and hard as it was to take, this right here was where he wanted to be right now.

Unbuttoning his shirt, he lumbered to the hall, mounted the steps to the second floor. There was the sound of movement in the bedroom, muffled voices talking. They were awake. They were in bed again. In his bedroom.

What he found was unexpected...

BEDROOM DOOR OPENED SILENTLY, he stood in the alcove where the walk-in closet and bathroom faced into the main area of the bedroom. He stood near the headboard, next to the nightstand, looking toward the footboard. Finn was in his bed, and he was shirtless. His back and head were propped up on the pillows, and his knees drawn up and spread wide. The sheet was across his waist and under the sheet was a bobbing ghost. Finn was saying, “That’s good, yeah, like that,” offering encouragement. And the person under the bed sheet—by the process of elimination—had to be Libby. She was using her mouth on Finn.

He slumped against the wall, tugged at the crotch of his pants, pain and sudden surprising lust lurching out from his darkest waters like the Swamp Thing.

Finn turned his chin up and he and Ben looked at each other almost upside down. Finn mouthed a silent *Hey* and gave him a two-finger wag hello.

Hey, he mouthed back.

Libby continued to bob, the globe shape of her skull moving up and down. And it was clear how long Finn was, seeing the distance she was from his crotch. Lib was on her knees and elbows between Finn’s legs using her mouth; there were wet sounds, sucking lips, a soft humming in her throat.

Finn reached down now and stroked his hand in circles over the back of Libby’s cotton head. “That’s good, Lib,” he said, “you’re so good...” After a pause, he added, “Ben’s here now...”

Libby continued, pausing only a moment. Then there were more slick mouth sounds, and she pulled her mouth off Finn's cock. He could tell by her movements she was kissing the underside of it. She said, "Where?"

Finn said, "In the room."

Ben saw Libby's crouched posture slump. Her head hung low and turned to the side, her ear resting on the inside of Finn's thigh. It was a long quiet moment, and then from under the covers, she said, "Hi, Ben."

"Hi, Libby," he said.

"Keep going," Finn said.

From under the covers: "I can't..."

All three of them were quiet, and Ben felt a pervasive sense of intrusion here, and the last thing he wanted was to be unwelcome. "You guys have been busy," he said.

That slumping wife-shape between Finn's legs slumped further. She made a groaning sound. "Sorry, Ben, I should've cleaned up..."

It's not what he meant. "It's all right, I don't mean..."

"No," she said, her voice muffled between Finn's legs, "It's not okay. I'm sorry..."

"I'll get it later," he said. "You called in sick today?"

"Yeah. I broke my hand."

"Okay."

She was quiet still, just a sheet-shrouded heap between Finn's open legs. When she was silent for too long, he worried that she didn't want him there. Worried that despite spending the entire day with Finn, eating and fucking and sucking and having a good time, now her husband was home, and the fun was over. He didn't want to be *that* guy. So he brightened, put on his best face for her, and tried again. "So what's going on here?" he asked, voice light, lifted with humor, and he eased off the wall where he'd been leaning, came around the side of the bed, stood at the foot. He admired the narrow of his wife's waist, the swell of her round butt, Finn's knees poking up on either side of her. Finn lay content in the pillows.

When Libby said nothing, Finn took a hand out from behind his head, caressed Libby's shoulder again. He said, "Libby's learning to suck cock."

Libby made a groaning sound. Finn smiled. "She's doing good. She's a little shy..."

Ben's stomach twisted, but he said, "She *is* shy."

"She doesn't want anyone to watch."

From under the sheets, Libby said, "I let you watch a little."

Finn smiled now, his eyes flashing up to meet Ben's, like the two of them were in on this and it was a big fun joke. That's the way it should be, something Ben should aspire to, but it still stabbed him in the heart to see Libby this way. Finn said, "Let's show Ben."

"No," Libby said, but then laughed a little.

"C'mon, come over, Ben," Finn said and patted his hand next to on the bed. "Lib's going to show you."

"No, I'm not," she laughed. "Get out of here."

"Don't be shy," he said. Then: "Come on, Ben."

Now despite the twisting in his heart, he did actually feel good enough he could laugh. He came around the other side of the bed and as he passed along, he ran his hand over the shape of his wife. And he taunted her with this: "Are you not wearing anything?"

"No," she said poutingly.

He sat down on Libby's side of the bed, knees bent over the side but putting his back to rest in the pillows. Now he had the same view that Finn did, Libby curled up between his legs and hiding from them.

Finn said, "Are you going to show him?"

"No," she said, chuckling in a way that sounded like progress was being made in her encouragement.

Finn nudged Ben's thigh with the back of his wrist, saying, "She'll show you. Ask her..."

Ben said, "Libby...?"

"I'm not going to," she said.

"Please, would you?... Show me..."

Finn's hand caressed her head again. "Ben missed it. Show him..."

She made a growling exasperated sound and her hips swayed from side to side. "Okay," she said, "but the way before..."

Finn laughed and said, "Yeah, we'll show him..."

"Show me what?"

Libby's fingers peeked out from under the sheet, and she pushed it up and peered at him from under the shroud. She looked sheepish and shy and bashful and so incredibly sexy he couldn't stand it. His stomach tightened, and he put his hand over it. Libby was heartbreakingly beautiful. He could tell from what she revealed that she *was* naked under there. No glasses, no makeup, just her sweet beautiful mousey self. Her hair hung sex-damp

around her angel face and he couldn't help beaming at this beautiful sight. Under her chin, Finn's enormous penis pointed downward into her armpit, and Libby's other hand curled over its root. She said, "How was Peterborough?"

"Would you show me, please?..."

She let out a voluminous sigh. "Okay, okay..."

Now it was like she was preparing herself. She peeled the sheet back so it rested over the crown of her head. She moved Finn's cock so it lay up on his belly, an extra-large glistening flesh-club laying against all that hard, tattooed muscle. She kissed Finn's stomach, hands coming up and smoothing around his waist. He had zero fat, and Libby liked the feel of him under her hands. Her fingertips stroked lines up and down the raised cable running the underside of his long cock. The thing extended up past his navel and Libby had her eyes turned down to it admiringly. She pouted her lips, kissed his shaft. But as soon as she began to work her mouth against the skin of Finn's manhood, Ben saw that shyness returning. The corners of her mouth turned up in a cute little smile; his poor Lib knowing she was supposed to be sexy, but on the verge of bursting out in nervous giggles now. She put a hand up beside her face, used crawling fingers to get the sheet to cover a bit more. Then with pinching thumb and forefinger, she brought down the hem of the sheet over her brow so it covered her eyes and nose, just her mouth visible. With the fingers of the other hand, she tilted Finn's cock upward toward her on a forty-five degree angle and ran her tongue on the underside of him.

Finn said, "Show Ben..."

LIBBY LET Finn's cock rest in her hand and giggled, tilted her chin toward Ben though she couldn't see where he was. With a smile that showed her teeth, she said, "He calls me his sexy Zorro."

Both of them bursted out laughing, Libby bouncing up and down on Finn's hard stomach. The laugh became a groan, and she raised the penis again, gliding her stuck-out tongue along the underside as it pointed toward the ceiling. It was so long Lib had to get up on her elbows, wiggling her body closer. She kissed the underside of his cock head, darted her tongue out, hesitated before putting him in her mouth. She sighed to herself, "I can't believe I'm doing this..."

Finn encouraged her. "You're awesome, Lib, totally awesome, go ahead..."

She tried to put her mouth over him, but the angle wasn't right; she made a clumsy motion with her mouth, mushed his cock head against her lips, spreading them over her teeth and realizing she couldn't get him inside. "He's so long," she sighed, shimmying back, tilting Finn's cock past ninety degrees and pointing more downward.

Ben watched as she sunk the enormous flared shape of his cock head into her mouth. He groaned a little, squeezed his thighs together, his hand coming down to grip hard on his belt buckle.

"That's it, Libby," Finn urged in a calm and kind manner. "That feels so good..."

Libby's cute little hand began to stroke up and down his shaft, moving in good time with the bobbing of her mouth. But Finn was large and long, her angle somewhat awkward. Her blow job looked clumsy, but he couldn't

believe he was watching her do it. He sighed, a strong feeling of longing stretching out his heartstrings. An urge to cry and laugh and jump forward and kiss her forehead took hold of him. He stayed where he was, saying instead, "You're so beautiful, Libby."

She snorted light laughter through her nose, and a smile grew on her face. She had to pull Finn from out of her mouth.

Now she just used her hand, squeezing him, stroking him, his long cock pressed along the side of her face, the tip up past the shroud of her bed sheet. She said, "I'm not very good at it."

"You're good, Lib, don't say that," Finn said, cupping his hand to her cheek. "You do it really well, you make me feel so good."

"Do I?"

"I swear."

She stroked him more eagerly, her bright white teeth biting down on her plump lower lip and still smiling. She said, "You're just really big."

"Keep going," he said, adding: "Can you do the thing?"

"You want that?"

Ben flinched again, worried what the 'thing' might be.

Now Finn swiveled at the hips, reached to the night table and brought back Libby's glasses. She tilted her chin up and he slid them over top of the sheet. The clear arms went above her ears, and Libby laughed.

Ben said, "Sexy ghost?"

"No," she said, dipping her head forward and shaking the glasses off her head. She tilted her chin up again, her hand stroking Finn. "Librarian ghost."

Ben said, "That was my second guess."

Finn said, "You're a blast."

Ben said, "Show me, Lib. Show me more..."

She shimmied herself into a more comfortable angle, got Finn's cock pointed almost straight up, and she hovered over top of it. Her mouth slipped over his glans, his cock gripped with two hands now, Lib sitting on her heels. She bobbed her head up and down, taking him a few inches into her mouth, both her small hands doing the rest. Her spit rolled down his shaft, collected in her slippery hands and got her stroking him quicker. Finn groaned appreciatively, said, "That's it, that's it, that's it... so good..."

It emboldened Libby, and Ben heard her breath coming quicker now, and deeper too. Like she was *into* it. Into giving Finn head. Just as she had

said: she wanted to be good in bed. And now she had someone she was comfortable practicing with. A good partner, an encouraging one, and one that turned her crank better than he did.

“Keep going,” he said, “keep going...”

Ben watched with quickening heart rate as Libby pleased Finn with her mouth. That shrouded sheet-shape slipping up and down, and eventually her right hand coming off his shaft, and she slowly pulled back the veil of the bedsheet and showed them her face. She wouldn’t open her eyes, wouldn’t look at them, kept them closed, two long-lash half moons over a perfect mouth stretched wide by another man’s big cock.

“Wow, holy wow,” he said, “oh, Lib...”

Finn said, “You’re driving Ben crazy, Lib, he can barely take it...”

Libby made an affirmative sound in her throat, kept her steady pace, mouth slipping up and down. Both hands were back on Finn, squeezing and stroking, while her mouth did all the wet work.

“Shit,” Finn said, “wow, that’s so good...”

“You’re so hot, Lib,” Ben said.

“Wait, wait,” Finn said, “easy...”

Libby slowed, eyelashes fluttering. She looked at Finn now with worried brows, her mouth pulling free of his cock and then wiping her lips with the back of her hand. She hid the lower half of her face with her palm. “What’s wrong?” she said behind the hand.

Finn said, “You’re going to make me come.”

“Oh,” she laughed. “Really?”

“Totally, I was so close.”

“Really?” she asked, this time higher.

Finn smiled. “You ready for that?” Ben assumed for semen to go in her mouth. A longtime Libby no-no.

She shook her head. Then she said, “Um, maybe...”

“Awesome, Lib, go for it...”

Lib smiled bashfully. “Really, you want me to?” She made a grimace like she wasn’t sure about doing it, but was excited that her confident lover wanted it.

Finn elbowed Ben’s thigh now, said, “Yeah, but do it for Ben.”

Though her cheeks already blushed, Ben swore the red deepened, and she glanced his way, their eyes met, then she hid her face and groaned, “Oh, no way...”

Finn gripped her arms and hoicked her up his body, Lib's elbow digging into Ben's waist, and Finn's cock going sideways sandwiched between him and Lib coming near touching Ben's hip.

"You're such a little cutie," Finn said in a lazy growl.

"No, I'm not," she laughed, hiding away from both of them now.

Finn said, "Show me your face, Lib, show me that face..."

She groaned, sighed, lifted so they both could see her. She wouldn't meet either of their eyes, but she smiled at least.

Finn sighed happily. "Such a cute little mouse, wiggle your nose for me."

She laughed and hid away again.

"Come on, do it again," he said in a drawn out amiable encouraging.

Libby lifted her face again, closed her eyes and sighed. She truly *was* a cutie. Clear and perfect skin, high eyebrows that could make her seem like a drawing of an innocent chipmunk—accentuated by some chubby cheeks that also made her kid-like sometimes. Lib rolled her eyes, closed them again, and wiggled her little button nose for them. It broke Ben's heart to see her this way, but every crack in his pumper was sealed by the warm gooey love inside.

Now she'd performed, she collapsed on Finn's chest, giggling to herself and rolling her forehead against Finn's hard body. Finn laughed with her, hugging her, rocking her, bumping against Ben, saying, "So adorable, Lib, I just want to stay in bed with you all week..."

"Mm," she moaned, "that would be nice..."

"Hey," Finn whispered, getting Lib to look up at him. "I want you to suck Ben's cock."

She met his eyes for a few heartbeats. "Okay," she whispered.

FINN SCOOTCHED TIGHTER against Ben's hip, Ben naked from the waist down, his pants and undies on the floor next to the bed. Their thighs pressed tight together, forming a sticky seal, their cocks level with each other, Finn's looking enormous, a fist-length longer, and so much thicker in Libby's hand.

Libby's oral pleasure grew clumsy, her good hand forming a circle with thumb and finger around the base of her husband's smaller cock, the tip of him pushing out against her cheek, head turned awkwardly, eyes careened to the right to admire the large and magnificent sexual totem in her other hand. She used the injured one on Finn, thumb and first two fingers stroking an inch long metronomic sweep from the pee hole down his frenulum and back. Wiggling her fingers, her yellowing pinky extended straight out and held away. There was purple bruising above her wrist bone but any discomfort she may feel didn't stop her from obeying her lover. "That's it, Lib, you got me so fucking hard for you right now..."

Libby grunted in her throat and exhaled briskly through her nose, the knob and of Ben's cock still plucking out her cheek. She rocked her head a little on him, remembering she was supposed to be doing that, her eyes however remained glued to Finn's more impressive manhood.

"That's it, nice and hard, Lib, keep going, don't forget Ben..."

Libby began to bob on him again, and Finn reminded her: "Look at my cock, Lib... look at mine while you suck your husband's..." Libby grew awkward again, rolling her head sideways in a contracted crescent, cheek poked out by his swollen out glans. "Good, good, look how big and hard you make me," Finn sighed, guiding her hand away, cupping her wrist to

make sure she wasn't hurt. "Keep going with Ben," he said, sat up and scooted down the bed.

Libby rested her sore hand against the inside of his thigh, started working her head up and down in straight lines, bobbing on him with improved ability, probably measuring the depth to which she could take her husband—almost all the way, very, very deep—and how much she admired that thing she'd just held. It only made Ben harder for some reason. He cupped the back of her head, said, "You're doing so good..."

Finn said, "She's a good girl, isn't she?" and placed a hand in the center of Lib's back, rubbing a small circle. He got low to her ear, said, "You're such a good cock-sucker..."

Libby blurted an awful squawking complaint, but it only made her bob faster.

"Look at her go," Finn said, stroking her back again, his face low, next to hers while she sucked. He said, "I'm going to fuck you while you blow him..."

Libby stiffened, tightening the grip she held around the base of his cock, the muscles of her back flexing; she went still, then gave a muffled *Uh-huh*.

"Open your leg wider, Ben," Finn said.

Ben put his knee out like a wing, drew his heel up, and Finn guided Libby to open her legs wider. She was on her elbows and knees, and he guided her ankle to lift one knee high until it almost touched her elbow. Then he stroked at her exposed sex, and Libby coughed a surprised but appreciative sound around her husband's erection. His heart hammered in his seized-tight rib cage. His eyes were wild, and they focused on his erection and the way her slippery lips wriggled around it. Her cheeks were rosy, eyes wide, pupils big, hair hanging limp. He could never imagine in his life that he would ever see the girl he loved like this, so wanton, so wild.

Now Lib's attention was drawn away, her mouth getting clumsy, trying to see over her shoulder. Finn had a finger inside her pussy and he was beating against it. There was a sticky wet sound, and Ben watched down his wife's body as Finn slipped the finger out from inside her, ran it in a shimmering line and plunged deep between her butt cheeks. Libby jolted between his legs, her thighs wanting to close, but Finn keeping her leg out and knee up high. He stroked at her thigh, whispered, "That's a good girl..."

Lib pulled his cock out of her mouth, her teeth grazing against the underside. Spit flowed from her lower lip and wound a glazed line in the

tangle of his pubic hair. She stroked him clumsily, her injured hand coming up and pulling hair out of her face as she turned a cheek over her shoulder. “Oh, my God,” she whispered, “I can’t believe this...”

Finn continued to finger her, getting her mouth to hang open and her eyes to draw shut. Libby liked it—this other man doing to her the most unthinkable thing. It would’ve taken Ben a month to prepare to ask her for this. And in that time of preparation he would have been mentally defeated, knowing he was going into a battle he would lose. Libby wouldn’t even hear of it. *Ben, no, I can’t do that, oh, my goodness...*

But here she was, his penis in her mouth at her lover’s command, her knee out, hungry sex presented, Finn’s finger buried deep in her most off-limits place...

WHILE LIBBY RENEWED the movement of her mouth on him—gripping his base, sucking and bobbing—he watched down her bare body as Finn stretched to the nightstand, his penis long enough to touch the bedding as he bent. Then he was tearing the condom packet open, on his knees behind Libby, rolling one of Ben’s condoms down his cock until it petered out. Finn moved closer, leaning forward, hand coming out to rest between Libby and his knee, fingers slipping underneath Ben’s leg.

Finn wagged his cock back and forth over Libby’s entry, nestling the plump end into her folded pouch of wet membranes. With the other hand out between Libby and Ben’s other leg, he pushed himself inside her.

Lib’s mouth paused on Ben while she accepted his entry. Finn pushed deep, pulled out, pushed deep. Ben’s cock popped out of his wife’s mouth. Her cheek collapsed in his lap, her nose pushed into the cup of his navel. She held her injured hand up where it wouldn’t be bothered, her other hand squashed between her breasts and his crotch, her nails scraping his scrotum.

Finn fucked her with a building pace, not going deep, just giving it to her in a good steady feeding. In and out, the muscles of his hips and stomach flexing and bulging as he reamed Libby’s tight insides.

“Libby, you’re so tight,” Finn said. Libby gasped against Ben’s stomach and squeezed his erection.

As Finn fucked her, Lib’s eyes closed, and her cheek slid on his belly, using her fingers to aim his cock back into her mouth. Her tongue slipped out and tickled around his shaft, she kissed the tip of him, but she didn’t know what she was doing—Finn had complete control of her.

Finn arched his back, palmed her butt cheek, pushed her hips toward the bed and pounded her harder. She cried out against Ben's stomach, the cry thinning to a warbled groan, bouncing with the pounding invasion between her legs. Ben bounced on the bed, his wife heaving up and down in his lap, the softness of her breasts squishing against his balls, his wife's fingers dragging on his scrotum. She blurted grunts against his stomach, a trail of drool spreading in a glistening crescent.

Libby came again. She squawked and moaned, mouth open but drawn in a mournful cry. The corners of her mouth tugged down, she let out a wail of a woman in the aftermath of a tragic accident. Only it was bewildering unlawful pleasure that had seized her. The moan was regret. Regret that she could receive so much from a man who wasn't her husband. It was awesome. Awesome in the sense of something so grand that he could barely describe its outer edges. It was huge, and it sat in his lap in the shape of his wife—but it was so much bigger, a swirling orb around him. It was love and lust; it was a lifetime with her that was celebrating the joy she was delivered regardless from where it came. It was knowing deep down what was happening to Libby. Knowing that he would be there for her, to guide her through this experience.

He stroked her hair while she came, her body still being rocked between his legs with Finn's thrusts. When Libby's eyes fluttered open, Finn pulled out quick, grabbed his dangling cock, tugging off the reluctant condom that seized on his girth for dear life, and it came away with a frightening snap. He tossed it aside, took Libby's shoulder and guided her to roll over. Ben slipped out from under her and she rested her head in the pillows. Finn got over her, hand spread out next to her head, his other hand stroking himself furiously.

And if Ben thought this was where Libby had reached her maximum, where she would kick out, scramble off the bed and wave her hands at them pronouncing, "*That's it, no, no, I can't,*" he was wrong.

Libby just said, "Not my face," then slapped two hands up to cover her mouth and nose, her middle fingers open in a Vulcan Live Long And Prosper, her big brown eyes peeking out from the V. She watched Finn stroke, and Finn said to him, "Let's go, Ben..."

Now Ben was joining in on his knees on Libby's other side. Her eyes peeped his way, looked at his hand on his much smaller instrument, jacking up and down. Two men, only one of them her husband, jerking their dicks

hard and fast preparing to show her their seed spread out on her naked skin. Libby's breasts were heaving, her eyes watching eagerly. She amended: "Not my hair, either," and grabbed at the sides of her hair, pulling and tugging it out of the way. She covered her face again, and this time her eyes. Finn pushed her uninjured hand away, saying, "Watch, watch, Libby..."

Lib reached to the side and plucked at the bedsheets, bringing over a twisted section of sheet wound like carnival bunting. She draped it over her neck like a winter scarf, but her chin came down, and she watched two men prepare to cover her with their seed.

Both he and Finn began growling, both of them getting close, and it was Finn who fired off first. A short quick spurt darted over her neck somewhere, and Libby hunched her shoulders up, elbows planted in the bed but her hands up, wrists bent, hands dangling like a begging puppy. She watched then as he jerked with short pausing motion, and semen began to squirt from him. It spurted over her breasts, one big hot blast, and Libby darted her elbows in and it pushed her breasts up and together, presenting for them a place to aim. Finn touched down on her nipple with the point of his cock and continued to let go. Stream after stream, his dick jumping up once, sending a heavy pulse right over Libby, tickling Ben's leg hair. Finn grunted, "Sorry, sorry, Ben, friendly fire, friendly fire, dude..."

Libby giggled, drew in a long breath and held it. And Ben was going off now, too. His cock not only smaller, his load arriving with much less force than Libby's big dick lover. *Of all the times not to blast off like he knew he could...* The first two darts came out quick and hot across her opposite nipple, and the remaining jets dabbed out and dribbled over his knuckle...

THE SIGHT below him in his marital bed was discomfiting. It was everything he'd ever wanted to see and yet it disgusted him. Lib had been in his life forever. She'd been sexual yet demure; a woman who had needs but kept them sane, kept them in the context of her rationality. They'd played as kids, gone to high school together and later college. There were field trips, ski getaways, later there was true love, losing her virginity which he was honored to claim... Miles of roads traveled. Never could he imagine he would see her this way.

The twisted hank of bedding still draped her neck. Her elbows still pressed against her sides, her big breasts pillowed forward. Her nipples were hard. Her cheeks blazed red. All over her chest and shoulders were the pearly islands of the most disgusting archipelago. Two men had jerked off on her. Libby. Libby Sanders. Libby *Todd*. It was unreal...

And before his eyes this wanton hussy who'd performed egregious acts in this bed with him and with another man suddenly transformed; her Mr. Hyde melting into the more palatable Dr. Jekyll. She bared her clamped teeth, her lips peeling back in a grimace. Eyes squinted now, her chin pushed up and her mouth turned down in an upside down bow. Every cord and tendon rose against the skin of her neck as normalcy flooded her sweet brain and she grew repulsed by the feel of the semen as it chilled on her skin and began to trickle in watery rivulets. Her hands clutched bed sheet tight until they trembled.

In a controlled but urgent tone, she communicated what she needed: "Towel, towel, towel, please, towel, please, please, please..."

While he liked the dirty Libby, it relieved him to have this one back.

STILL ON HER BACK, Libby scrubbed at her neck with the clean towel he'd brought her. She rubbed vigorously, winding a hand up the back of her neck, pulling her hair to rest on the pillow above her head. She scrubbed her shoulders, sat up now, folding a forearm across her breasts, injured hand bent out to protect it. With her chin tucked into her collar, she looked from shoulder to shoulder. She said, "Did I get it all?"

Finn flopped down onto the bed, exhausted, Libby with her back to him. He gleamed with sweat, and his dick lay up on his stomach.

"Did I?"

"I think it's good," Ben said.

She covered her breasts now with the towel, pinched it against herself, ran her good hand through her hair. "Please tell me I didn't get it in my hair."

"I don't think we did," he said.

Behind her, Finn smoothed a hand over the center of her curved back, saying, "I think we had good aim, Lib. Just jump in the shower..."

She gripped the hanging locks of her heavy hair. She gave Ben a funny comical grimace. "I really should. I haven't had a shower since..." she rolled her eyes up, "oh, wow, yesterday morning." Finn laughed, and Ben could hear his fingers drumming on Libby's back.

"That's kinda gross. Sorry, guys," she said, peering over her shoulder to see Finn. She dragged sheets between her legs to cover her sex. There she was, covered again. But at least warm and amiable while in congress with two men who had their dicks out.

Now Ben eased back to lie on the bed, pulling part of Libby's sheet between his legs to cover his own arousal—to protect it from Libby's newfound size scrutiny. He said, "You okay?"

She nodded, and there was a smaller measure of old Libby creeping back into her. He rested his hand over her knee covered by the sheet. He said, "Was that okay?—what we did?"

She nodded again.

Finn groaned and stretched one arm, the hand on Libby's back coming up to squeeze at her shoulder. She looked over at him and he said, "Was it good?"

"Yeah," she said, voice light and almost laughing. "It was good. Like, when you guys were doing it, I really wanted it."

Ben interjected, "And now you feel funny, though," just to prove that he knew Libby best.

She groaned, her face taking an embarrassed pinch, and with sheets gathered around her, she collapsed between them, facing Ben. He turned on his side, looked in her eyes. There was something there, and it wasn't terrible. Definitely friendship. Love, too, but he would probably have to bore in deep to really see it. He'd fucked them up. He'd fucked them up really bad. This wonderful woman had wandered into his dark forest. She'd come in to get him, left a faint trail of breadcrumbs enough there was a good chance she could help them both find their way out again. He cupped his hand to her neck. He said, "It's good, Libby. It's really good."

Her eyes darted back and forth over his and she opened her mouth to say something but changed her mind. She put her hand over his for a moment and he worried she would remove it. They weren't restored. There was a tear between them, and he would be foolish not to recognize it. His apologies weren't done. Sure, she cheated first. But somehow it was different... The rules weren't so clear. Somehow, what she'd done with Ronnie didn't anger him. It was sad that she kept it so close to her chest for so long and let it injure her heart. Honesty really was the best policy, at least when you were dealing with someone you cared about.

He said, "I love you."

There was a delay before she responded, and he worried he wouldn't get one. But she bit her upper lip, her eyes moving down before they moved back up again. "I love you, too."

He said, "Did you get my heart?"

Her features scrunched with puppy dog affection. She whispered, "I got it. I saved it."

"I mean it."

"You're my brightest light, Ben. You always have been." Now she touched the tip of his nose and smiled.

He said, "We're in this together."

She gave him one brief nod, craned her neck forward, kissed his mouth. His heart ballooned in his chest and he gripped the back of her neck to hold her for the longest kiss he could endure. She pushed him away, giggling.

"I need a shower, don't kiss me..."

"You're not dirty."

"I am," she said, turning up her nose. She sat up, running fingers through her dirty hair. "I'm going to have a shower," she said.

Without hesitation, Finn sat up, put his feet on the floor. "I'm coming with you."

"Okay," she laughed. It was amazing how quickly she agreed. The last time he'd had a shower with her they were in college. She had been too shy for there to be a repeat. They'd skinny-dipped a few times when they'd gone camping, but it had been nighttime.

He sat up as well, then considered there was no room for three people in the shower. And it was clear Finn was the one his wife wanted for company. So he made like he wasn't even thinking of joining them, fluffing up the pillows and getting comfortable. Libby climbed over him, kissed his shoulder as she passed, still with sheets and towels gathered around her nudity. She stood at the side of the bed and waited for Finn to come around, Finn buck naked, enormous dong still semi-hard and pointing outward like it was dowsing for water, bobbing back and forth between his legs. Libby watched it.

Finn reached a hand to her, and she took it. He said, "How's your water pressure?"

Ben said, "It's good," and Libby agreed.

Finn and Libby passed from his sight going beyond the walk-in closet and into the bathroom. The bathroom was behind him, and he sat there in the pillows listening. This was the sensible thing. If it was Libby who wanted Ben to experiment with other girls, he would feel weird with Libby's energy coming into the shower with him and Neve and Chelsea. Not that he didn't love her, just that he was different around her. And it hit

him: that's *exactly* what it was. Libby loved him, but he affected her demeanor. She wanted to behave a certain way when he was around. She was different when he was gone. Made him wonder what sex was like between Finn and Libby during the day. It looked like they'd banged in every room. That wasn't like Libby at all, but when she was with Finn, she was a different person. It hurt that he didn't know that one, but he knew he wanted to become acquainted.

The bathroom door had been left open, and he could hear the clear sound of a man urinating into the toilet. Then Libby giggling, and Finn chuckling. Finn said, "Be careful, you have to aim it..."

"I'm trying—"

"Keep it steady..."

"It wiggles..."

Ben clutched his stomach now with a clear image of playful Libby standing with uninjured hand holding Finn's enormous dangling penis and getting to see what it would be like to be a man and pee into a toilet while standing up.

Quick spurts and jags of urine gushed and Libby laughed.

"Shake it," Finn said. Libby giggled, Finn chuckled, then blurted, "Too much, too much." More laughing. The toilet flushed.

Now the water hissed on, and Ben rolled to his side, facing the room, ears tuned to what might be happening just past the walls beyond the closet. Shower glass slid, Finn and Libby talked about if the water was hot enough, Finn complemented the water pressure. There was more low talk, and then the door slid open and closed again and he knew both of them had stepped into the stall.

It took great effort, but he remained in bed. He couldn't stop the thoughts from coming: the two of them in the shower together, naked, Libby wouldn't have her towel and blankets anymore, she would be completely bare with this other man. She'd held his penis while he peed, they'd been intimate a half-dozen times, Finn'd just jerked off on her chest. There was something huge and close building between Finn and Libby and it twisted at him. But he knew it was good somehow. So he forced himself to breathe slow and deep, the whole while listening with apprehension for the sound of Libby's moan...

THEY WERE in the shower a long time, but he didn't think they had sex. When they came out, they still had that buoyant energy. A playfulness between them, a relaxing of Libby's armor. They came out giggling, not exhausted and panting. Like they'd been in there washing each other's backs.

Their bare feet bumped and squeaked around the tiled floor of the bathroom, then they brushed their teeth. He wondered whose toothbrush Finn used. Libby excused herself, and Finn's shadow loomed in the hall as the bathroom door closed. Now there was the sound of Libby tinkling in the toilet behind the closed door. Finn groaned, stretching, coming back into the bedroom. His penis had deflated to its flaccid size, and it bounced and jumped and swung between his legs, bigger than Ben's erection. Finn went to the bedroom window and parted the curtains, looked out onto the street below. It was becoming evening, but still light out. Finn yawned, said, "You hungry?"

"Yeah. Did you guys leave enough hot water for me?"

"Shit, dude. I don't know. I hope so."

"I hope so, too," he muttered, still laying on his side.

The bathroom door opened, and Libby came out, passing by the bed now with a towel on her head, wearing her bathrobe tied at the waist. Finn turned from the window, his dick bouncing on his thigh, and brightened seeing Lib.

"Come here, squirt," he said, dropping himself onto the chair from where Ben had watched them fuck last night. His dick bounced on the seat

and dangled over the edge, and Libby came right to him sat on one of his thighs, facing Ben.

Ben gathered sheets between his legs, put his feet on the floor and sat on the side of the bed.

Libby looked to him, smiling happily, then back to Finn. She giggled and put her arm around Finn's neck to steady her balance. She said, "Friendly fire."

Finn laughed, said, "That's what it's called."

"You're funny," she said.

"It has a name," he said, holding back laughter to prove sincerity.

"It happens so much."

"It can happen," he said.

Libby studied Finn's expression, assessing his veracity, and it struck Ben she was curious. And his stomach dropped at the thought Lib might be curious about having two men in bed at the same time, *none* of them being her husband. And why wouldn't she be curious? Hadn't the lure of being with Chelsea *and* another woman been the final bewitchment that had him cheating on Lib, once he'd overcome the intimidation? Being with those two sex-goddesses had blown him away. If Lib had somehow *allowed* him that tryst (and he hadn't also endured a feeling of shame and guilt), how much *more* would he have enjoyed it? That Lib would entertain the idea of a threesome with two men was almost too much to bear. His ears rang suddenly, and he felt like he would swoon. His hands gripped the edge of the bed.

Lib twisted her mouth from side to side, squinting at Finn who met her gaze, smiling. She dropped it. "What do you want to do now?"

Finn said, "I know two sex cats who need to replenish. Sorry, three. *Three* sex cats..." He glanced at Ben, including him, but returning to look up at Lib. He slipped his hand inside the front of her robe and lay it on her tummy; Lib jerked and sucked in her stomach. "Somebody was telling me earlier she could eat *two* hamburgers she was so hungry." Lib giggled and rested her hand on his wrist.

"You burned a lot of calories," Ben said.

Libby agreed. "We did."

Ben asked, "How many times did you..." then changed his mind, not liking the submissive puppy-dog sound of his question. "Never mind."

Libby turned to face Finn again. "You want to go out to eat?"

“I do for sure...”

Ben said, “What about Chelsea?”

Libby frowned. “Who cares?”

Finn says, “She’s been texting.”

All three of them were quiet for a few uncomfortable beats, no one knowing what to say about Finn’s wife.

Finn cleared the silence. “Let’s go out and grab dinner.”

“Where?” Libby asked, resting her forearm on his shoulder.

Finn kissed her wrist, then held out a level palm encouraging Libby to place her injured hand in it. He kissed the swollen finger. “You have to dress that again.”

“Will you do it for me?”

“Sure.”

Now Lib turned up her nose. “But I don’t wanna wear my splint,” she said, holding out her hand and studying her injury.

“Promise you’ll be careful, and you don’t have to.”

“I’ll be careful,” she said girlishly.

“Then you don’t have to,” Finn growled and pulled her into a tight hug. Libby’s legs kicked up, and she yelped. Finn buried his face in her collar and bit her neck like a rabid dog. Libby cackled. Her robe lifted and Ben got a peek up the inside of her bare thigh and a flash of her pubes. The display got him aroused again. A jealousy washed up his back, but his heartbeat came on strong, and his cock stiffened.

When the hug loosened, Lib stayed melted across Finn’s chest, him cradling her. She crossed her bare legs, revealing Finn’s dangling dick underneath her. The sight of his wife in luxury with another man, however sweet and innocent she may be, provoked a wicked arousal in him. He said, “Do we have to go out?”

Finn said, “We’ve been cooped up in this house for so long.”

Ben said, “I know. I walked into your sex smell when I came home.”

Libby made a funny scowl, almost as if his comment hurt her, then looking at him and measuring his anger. He showed none. Her face softened. She said, “Let’s get out of the house.”

“We’ll go down to the boardwalk—hey, let’s go grab some burgers... Lib wants a burger...”

“I’m *so* hungry,” Libby said, leaning her body against Finn’s shoulder. Finn’s hand still tucked in the open flap of her robe, slipped to her ribs. He

tickled her a little, and she giggled, squirmed on his lap using her elbow to scoot his hand out from under her robe and then bringing the lapels closed and crossed over.

Ben said, “I have to get in the shower before we go out,” and rose off the bed, pulling sheets and keeping his arousal hidden. Neither Finn nor Lib were watching him, anyway.

Lib said to Finn, “Pick me out something to wear. Come to my closet and dress me...”

Ben winced, but continued to the bathroom. As he closed the door, Finn and Lib came to the alcove, Finn saying, “Shit, I only got the same clothes I came in...”

They slipped into the small closet together. Lib said, “They’re not dirty, you’ve hardly been wearing them...”

PART 5
CHURCH

AFTER TIDYING THE SEX-MESS, the three of them walked south down Sarah Ashbridge and crossed Boardwalk Avenue, winding then through the paved pathway that split a green space and emerged at the waterfront boardwalk. There were lots of couples out strolling, families on bicycles, groups sitting in small clumps on the long sandy beach, some muscular guys with a German Shepherd throwing a frisbee around. Finn wore the same clothes he'd arrived in, Ben had changed into comfortable shorts and T-shirt. But Libby, Libby was something else...

Finn had selected her wardrobe. A tank top and no bra. Her canvas Keds and her shortest skirt. When Finn'd presented it, Libby'd said, "No way—I only wear these with tights." Finn had said, "Today you're not." And that was it. Libby complied.

So she walked between them wearing the sexiest, most revealing outfit she'd ever worn. *And* she was in public.

A frisbee sailed silently, levitating like a U.F.O. at head height, passing them, arcing and landing with a soft clomp in the center of the wooded boardwalk. Finn stooped to snatch it in one quick and surprisingly graceful motion, spun, tossed the frisbee at even chest-height. It sailed with perfect precision.

"Thanks, dude," one of the muscular guys said as he caught it, then turning and throwing it to his friend, the German Shepherd launching in happy chase.

Finn faced both of them now, and clapped his hands, waved his fingers, saying, "Lib, c'mere."

Lib trotted two quick steps to come to him, and he put his arms around her. He whispered in her ear, and she swatted at his arm. "Get out of here," she said. He gave her a steady, insistent eye. Lib rolled her eyes. "You're crazy," she said. She squeezed out of his embrace, walked ahead of them. Ben joined Finn, and they walked side-by-side with Libby advancing a few paces ahead.

Ben started to say something about the yacht and the pilot he'd met this morning, looking to make conversation, but Finn held up a finger, nodded his chin toward Libby ahead of them. "Watch," he said.

Libby's head darted left and right, spying who was around. Her gait picked up a skip, bouncing on her toes, her butt swaying from side to side. She got one more stride farther ahead of them, and Ben watched her graceful hands come down, unsure and undecided, then going for it...

Those cute fingers curled under the hem of her swishing skirt and quickly flapped up the backside, showing off the pink triangle of her cotton panties stretched over her perfect round ass.

"Holy shit," Ben said.

"Oh, my God," Finn said, "that ass..."

Libby's skirt fell to cover, and she skipped off, laughing...

AT THE FIFTIES-THEMED BURGER-CHURCH, Libby said she wanted a sundae. Finn asked if she wanted a burger and she said, “Just curly fries and a banana split.” Ben said he’d get a cheeseburger and Libby asked if she could have a bite of his.

Lib stood between him and Finn, unable to stop a cute hip-swishing in-place mambo dance she did along with Perez Prado leading his orchestra through Cherry Pink And Apple Blossom White coming from an ancient Rock-Ola jukebox playing actual real-live vinyl platters. There was a sleepy, static half-smile on her face that hurt him to see, yet brought one of his own.

While they shuffled along the lunch counter waiting for their order to come up, he nudged the back of her knee and made her dip; she laughed, turned and batted his arm, looked in his eyes, folded against him, hugging that arm now. His heart swelled. But when they had their trays of food and headed out to the patio, Lib chose to sit next to Finn, and he ended up opposite them.

The patio was a white-picket-fenced square out front of the low, flat-roof burger joint painted up in the pastel colors of the 1950s. There was a rectangle of shade under its cantilevered roof, but they sat out in the late afternoon sun at one of the six round tables shielded by umbrellas. Ben had his back to the beach and boardwalk, facing a few couples who occupied some other tables. Finn snugged his chair up so he was hip-to-hip with Libby and she liked it.

Lib snatched up her stainless spoon right away and bent over her sundae, a picture-perfect banana split served in a glass dessert boat. Three

scoops of ice cream—one vanilla, one chocolate, one strawberry—sat in the gutted belly of a banana draped with spray whipped cream bunting and dotted with fat red cherries. One spoonful into her mouth and she slumped in her chair, closed eyes turned up to the sun and moaning with deep pleasure like she'd just had an orgasm. Poor Lib had all the glycogen fucked right out of her muscles, leaving her a happy, gooey slug. Ben and Finn sat in front of their untouched burgers studying this accidentally sexy display by the cutest girl that had possibly ever existed—and one oblivious to the effect she had on the two horny men accompanying her.

After two mouthfuls of vanilla ice cream, Lib's fingers plucked a curly fry and pushed it into her shining mouth as a chaser. She caught them watching.

She mumbled a fry-garbled *What...?*

Finn leaned close, his muscular shoulder touching her slim one. "Did you wash your hands, young lady?"

Lib frowned a moment, offended, brought up her paper napkin and wiped at her lips. Finn smiled wide, leaned closer and whispered in her ear. That look of chagrin on Lib's face got smeared away by a sly look. Her eyes widened, and the napkin slipped down to reveal a glossy smile.

"I gotta go wash my hands," she whispered, rose, and skipped off inside the restaurant.

"That's a good girl," Finn said after her, turned in his chair and watching her bare legs work below her swishing, too-short skirt. When he returned to face Ben, he sighed, "Fuck, she's so damn cute, I don't know how you stand it."

Ben drew a deep breath, mind blank in a hazy, choked-off gauze. Finn took a big bite of his burger and Ben absently followed suit. While they chewed, he watched Lib's new lover. The muscles of his jaw and neck flexed and rippled, a jagged shark fin of black hair bounced on his brow, more clumps sticking up in ragged jabs, hair shaved above his ears on one side. Bright blobs of light winked off the studs along his auricle and two hoops in one ear. This was what Lib thought was sexy. The guy *was* sexy—Ben didn't disagree—it was just that it hadn't seemed so blatant before. But that was back when he'd thought a guy like Finn wouldn't appeal to Lib. Lib was such a mouse, such a cutesy good-girl, it hadn't occurred to him there would be a real attraction. In fact, he recalled mild surprise that *Chelsea* was with Finn. He'd suspected a solid-ten like Chels would be with

some alpha male finance guy. But perhaps that was just part of his own covetous perspective—it was *Ben* who wanted to be an alpha male finance guy. It was weird to think even if he could attain his fantasy role as confident man-of-the-city, a man like Finn could come along and walk away with your girl. Finn had a lot to offer. The guy was fun, he made lots of money, he hobnobbed with famous bands, he rode a bad-ass motorcycle, and he had an anaconda in his three-hundred dollar jeans.

When he finished chewing, Ben asked, “She really washing her hands?”

Finn laughed. “She better be, that dirty girl,” turning in his seat again but not seeing Lib. On Finn’s neck a tattooed Eye of Horus watched Ben, never blinking. Finn took a gleeful sip from his Coke float, enjoying his day and the things he could get another man’s wife to do for him.

The thought of Lib’s sexual acquiescence to another man aroused him, and the wondering of what Lib did in the bathroom had his cock stiffening in his shorts. “Is she taking off her panties?”

Finn bounced his eyebrows and took another long draw from the stainless steel straw slimed with ice cream sludge. Behind him, Libby pushed open the glass door, passed through the shade and into the bright sun. Ben’s cock almost grew full-hard thinking there was nothing under his demure wife’s short skirt as the sun beat on her bare legs.

Before sitting, Libby presented her hands to Finn, fingers spread out wide. Finn smelled them like a supervising father, saying, “Mm, cherry soap.” As Lib tucked her skirt to sit, Finn halted her. “And the other thing...?”

Libby shrugged playfully, but Finn still held out a hand preventing her from sitting. “Ben and I want to know for sure.”

Libby bit her smiling lower lip, eyes scanning the other seated patrons, and beach pedestrians beyond the patio’s perimeter. Lib’s hands held the front of her skirt and Ben watched the tendons flexing in anticipation. Then she popped the front of the skirt up quick. In a flash-second Ben and Finn saw her fuzzy triangle before she giggled and plopped down in her seat.

“What a good girl,” Finn told her, adjusting the crotch of his jeans...

BEN HAD THOUGHT the two of them needed a break after a full day of fucking, that they were all coming out to get something to eat, the three of them as friends, but now it seemed that this whole thing was an extension of Finn's sexual domination over Libby. Finn barely touched his burger, and now Ben's own appetite had quelled as well, an erotic ballooning below pushing away any hunger. Lib was unaware, happily resuming the enjoyment of her sundae, antsy in her chair with her legs together, and, knowing her, hyper-aware of her nakedness. Both Ben and Finn watched her while she was oblivious, Finn's face turned her way, and Ben looking up and down Libby and trying to peep through the glass table top between the plastic trays and the wooden toolbox loaded with ketchup, vinegar, salt and pepper to see the skin of her legs. Finn's tattooed hand came into view, curling just above Libby's knee. Libby smiled with the spoon poked in her mouth, side-eyeing her confident lover.

Lib wiggled in her chair, doing a dance, then scooped up more ice cream, strawberry this time, drizzling a line of chocolate sauce back to the creamy, sugary heap on the dessert boat. When she put it in her mouth Finn's hand slipped higher to the hem of her skirt. Lib's eyes shot wide, and she struggled not to burst out laughing with her mouth full. Her pretty lips were ringed with chocolate and she wiped at them with her napkin.

Ben nudged her tray aside and saw Finn's hand half under her skirt, cupped over her inner thigh. Lib had let her legs drift apart to allow him. Finn watched behind her now, studied the other diners to make sure they were unobserved, looking in the windows to check the tables inside the

restaurant. Ben helped, peering over his shoulders on either side to make sure no one was approaching from the boardwalk.

When his gaze returned, Lib's eyes were closed, her face calm with pleasure, pushing another spoonful into her mouth, spoon held between her teeth. She moaned. Below the table, Finn's hand was fully under her skirt, his fingers surely stroking at her pussy. The ice cream melted in her mouth, Lib not swallowing, expression lost, eyes closed. She moaned again, and her head nodded.

Finn said, "That must be the best ice cream ever. Is it the best ever?"

Lib chuckled weakly, gasped, "Ah, oh, it's really good..."

Finn slunk closer till they were touching, his hand and wrist hidden behind her skirt. Libby's legs opened and closed and she moaned louder.

Finn said, "Maybe *I* should've ordered the ice cream."

"It's, mm, so good, oh, it's the best ice cream ever, oh..." Lib slumped forward, elbows planted on the table, grabbed her hanging hair. "Oh, wow, I can't believe how good it is..." She humped Finn's hand while he smiled and studied her ecstatic profile.

He whispered, "Sit back, Lib."

She made a recalcitrant groan, mouth turning down, but she complied. Reclining now, she sucked her lower lip, eyes turned to regard Finn, wanting to know what he intended next.

Finn's hand removed from her skirt, and as he pushed aside her tray so Ben could have a clear view between his wife's legs, the first three fingers gleamed wet up past mid-knuckle. Libby was spilling over with excitement. Now Ben growled with appreciation, as much a sexual pawn to Finn's mastery as his wife.

"Tilt that umbrella, Ben," Finn told him, looking up and squinting. "Let's get some sun."

Ben stooped, his erection tenting out his shorts; with shaking hands he adjusted the angle of the large umbrella so the sun fell into Libby's lap. Libby looked wild and excited.

As Ben sat again, Finn checked for onlookers before folding back Libby's skirt, revealing her pussy. "Part your legs," he whispered. Libby did, her eyes closing again.

They were in full public, and Libby, who was shy being seen by her husband semi-clothed in her house, obeyed another man's request to reveal

the most sacred and intimate part of her where the world might see. Ben's heart pounded and the tip of his dick tickled with leaking lubricant.

THROUGH THE GLASS he could see Lib's pussy in full glorious bright-day sun. Her labia were full and eager, plucked out of tight folds and looking for hard meat. The beaded dew of her own excitement winked in the tangled nest of her golden-chestnut sex-fuzz. Ben groaned now, too.

Finn said near her ear: "Feel that sun on your pussy?"

"Ah, yeah," Lib gasped, eyes still closed.

"Nice and hot?"

"It feels good."

Finn returned his hand to her thigh, and his thumb stroked at one of her blushed and full lips. "Get some Vitamin D into that pretty little twist."

Libby panted now. "I need Vitamin C..."

Ben frowned and his stomach tightened at what she might mean. Finn smiled.

Libby's eyes fluttered, and she looked ashamed. But it slipped away as she smiled, too.

Finn ventured: "Vitamin cock?"

She giggled and tried to push down her skirt but Finn tugged it upward again.

Finn said, "Tell me you want my cock."

"I do," she said, and without checking to see if anyone watched, Lib's hand wandered to Finn's lap squeezing under his arm. Her injured hand closed around a large denim bulge and her small thumb stroked.

"Tell me..."

"I want this *big* cock so bad right now..."

"You gonna open your legs for me—let me get it up inside you?"

“Here?...”

“Not here,” Ben said worriedly.

“Not here,” Finn said, eyes never coming off Lib. “Your patio. Ever fuck in the hot sun?”

“No.”

“Never got buck naked with Ben and just go at it under that dying star?”

She bit her lip and shook her head no, turning her face, opening her eyes and staring into Finn’s eyes like he’d hypnotized her.

“Never felt the sun on you when you come?”

Lib still shook her head, almost swallowing her lips now.

“You’re so fucking wet...”

“Oh, ha, mm, I know... stop...”

“Stop my hand?”

“No,” she whined, brow pinched.

Finn smiled, loving this. “Stop saying you’re wet?”

“I don’t know,” she said, giggling bashfully and closing her eyes. “I might come...”

“Then you *don’t* want me to stop...”

Unh-unh, she grunted, breathing heavy and shaking her head, her shampooed hair swishing on her shoulders. Her legs widened, the sight of her getting fingered available for any passer-by to discover. Ben whisked around to double-check, then hunched forward again, his stomach cramping, balls aching.

Finn whispered to Lib, “You want to get fucked, don’t you?”

She nodded.

Finn glanced at the melting sundae on the table in front of Lib. “I could put that banana in you.”

“Oh, no wa-hay,” she laughed.

“It’s not big enough, right?”

“Unh-unh,” she laughed and groaned, a hand disappearing under the table, pushing her skirt down to better cover what Finn did to her. He’d got her squirming now.

“Libby needs a big, *big* banana,” he whispered.

She chuckled, “I need the biggest banana...” Her finger and thumb squeezed Finn’s bulge.

“You like that, huh?”

“Yeah, mm...”

“You want to get out of here?”

“I do.”

“You want me to fuck you?”

“I do, I do so, so bad...”

Finn studied her still, in complete control, his shoulder muscle twitching as his fingers worked Lib. “How do you want it?”

“Oh, no,” Lib whined, sneering, “oh, I’m gonna come...”

“Tell me how you want it while you come...”

“Oh, ha, oh, mm, oh, God,” she babbled breathily while she wriggled in her seat, her legs out wide, skirt folded in her lap, her pussy bared with Finn’s fingers in it for her husband to see.

Finn urged: “Tell me...”

“Bare,” she whispered, forearm on the table edge, hand opening then closing to a fist, opening again, hovering and shaking over her paper placemat spotted with chocolate sauce.

“Bare?”

Her head rocked back and forth. “No condom, huh, ha, oh, do you *need* one?...”

“Nope. I’m so clean...”

Her head fell back. “Oh, God, really?”

“Yeah. I can fuck you bare. You want my bare dick?”

“Oh, God, I do so bad, I want it...”

Finn checked over his shoulder, whispered, “Come for me, do it, but be quiet, Lib, there’re people watching...”

“Oh, mm, ohh,” she whined, her brows tented and troubled. Her mouth dropped open, and she hitched inward breath as she came, but managed not to utter an embarrassing cry. Her whole body trembled. She chuffed air, nostrils flaring and closing, her chest shaking. She let out a squeak that had a man looking their way. Ben made brief eye contact, and the man looked away. Lib’s thighs shook and trembled, her nipples made like rocks under her cotton shirt. Her hand clutched Finn’s cock through his pants, then her strength dissolved and her fingers went weak and supple. Her breath chugged, chest heaving. When her eyes fluttered, she looked around now sheepishly, smiled a little. Two bright red saucers shone on the points of her cheeks, and her button nose had blushed pink.

“Ho-ho-ho-ho,” she stuttered, legs closing as Finn’s shining hand came out of her lap. Lib pushed her skirt down and she sat up, looking like she

reclaimed her dignity and tried to appear as if nothing had transpired, but her eyes were so glassy Ben was sure if he asked her what year it was it might take her a couple guesses before she narrowed in.

Ben's cock pulsed and shook in his pants and it was for sure the closest he'd ever come in his whole life to having an orgasm without touching himself. A dark round stain grew wider in the cotton as he felt it still streaming from him.

Finn gathered Libby's paper napkin and wiped her wet off his hand all the way past his knuckles and to his wrist. The moment had grown long and isolated—like even though they'd worried about potential discovery it still had just been the three of them alone in the world, cut off from reality. But there was the echo of a rumble in Ben's ears, and though it was gone now, some psychic voice from a well told him the sound had importance, but he didn't figure it out until Finn tossed the napkin to his tray, looking over Ben's shoulder and saying, "Ah, shoot, guys, Chelsea's here..."

FIRST THING CHELSEA did dismounting her burly motorcycle was doff her helmet and show the three of them her hands as if to say she meant no harm. Helmet plopped on her saddle, she came to join them, strutting braless in a tight white tank top and her long, long legs getting the attention of a group of passing dads with visors and milkshakes.

Libby stiffened and sat straighter, eyes darting to Ben, showing him fear, looking for her husband to help her out of this since he'd been so good yesterday morning.

Ben wheeled back around as Chelsea's boots clomped behind him, looking to Finn and saying, "What the fuck?"

Libby scowled at Finn like he betrayed her. When Finn gripped her forearm, Lib didn't pull away, watching him with hurt eyes now. Finn said, "She just wants to talk. Hear her out, okay?"

Finn stood and scooted over to Ben's side, Ben noting the huge hump in his jeans with a dark circle of pre-come just like he had, only Finn's off at his hip. Libby caught his eye.

"We should go," she whispered, but it was too late. Chelsea was in the patio's pen, sealing them off, coming in soft and soothing, palms still held up. Libby crossed her arms and raised her shoulders.

Chelsea dipped to kiss Finn, and Ben saw Finn's hand slip around to squeeze her ass cheek. Then Chelsea said, "It's okay, Lib, I come in peace," as she tapped Finn's former chair out with her toe then dropped to sit. She hiked the chair close to Lib and now his wife was closed in between the table, the fence, and her tormentor.

Libby said to Finn, "Did you call her?"

Chelsea said, "Text, Lib. But I mean it, let's call a truce. Talk to me, okay?"

"I don't want to."

Chelsea nodded, brow lowering like this was going to be harder than she thought. She said, "I'm sorry, Libby, I mean it."

"Good."

"I've been at home thinking about what Ben said. Why *would* I believe Ronnie?"

Libby rolled her eyes but Ben winced. It was at least partly true what Ronnie told her, and though he'd defended his wife's honor, she wasn't as chaste as she might seem. And there was a condescension to Chelsea's re-appraisal—of course she shouldn't have believed yearbook-nerd Libby Sanders could ever get with Ronnie the Muscle-Stud.

Right before his eyes, Ben watched his wife transform. That bristling arm-folded woman who'd punched Chelsea yesterday morning melted into a whimpering puddle. Her face reddened, her eyes shone wet, a tear rolled, and her shoulders shook with silent sobs.

It surprised Chelsea. "Hey," she said with unexpected warmth, putting a tentative hand on Libby's shoulder as if to soothe her. It somehow worked, and Lib sniffed, shook her head, dabbed at her eyes to remove tears. She looked at Chelsea now with a raised chin and stoic expression.

"Okay," Chelsea said, still palming Lib's shoulder, "I *am* sorry. I do crazy things sometimes and this is one of those times. I shouldn't have done what I did. I don't expect you to forgive me—"

"I don't—"

"—but I want you to know I regret it."

Libby's tightness faltered and Ben thought she might cry again, but Lib held it in check.

Chelsea still regarded Lib close, and Lib raised her chin again. Chelsea said, "Maybe we're all in a place right now we don't mind being. What do you say we fix some bridges...? Burning them's never good."

Libby shrugged, cocked her head.

Chelsea said, "I don't want to be an enemy. We don't have to be friends, but we don't have to *hate* each other."

Libby said, "I don't hate you," but it was so quiet Chelsea didn't hear—Ben only caught it because he was used to reading Lib's lips.

This time Libby amended it, saying, "I never hated you."

Chelsea gave a small warm smile and tweaked her own nose. “You sure about that?” When her hand came away Ben could only measure the smallest swelling on the bridge, and there might have been a yellowy crescent under one eye, though it had been well-concealed by makeup.

Libby pursed her lips and looked down.

Chelsea said, “Hey, you think we can get past this?”

Libby drew a deep breath, held it, exhaled slow but didn’t answer. Ben’s pulse was in his eardrums wondering if Lib would come clean. And a selfish cloak slipped around his shoulders. Chelsea’s words still bounced in his brain-pan, the phrase ‘burning bridges,’ and the notion that he did like crossing back and forth on that bridge and he did want to be in the folds of the Slades’ vampire cape where it was dark but warm and the fabric tickled across your skin like fine silk. Visions of him and Chelsea flashed, but of utmost prominence, a veritable towering peak in comparison, was the lust he had for witnessing Finn’s sexual mastery over his most precious innocent mouse. And then like a true betrayer, he said, “Libby has something to say, too.” Once out, there was no retreat, no sucking the words back—what was said could not be un-heard. So despite Lib’s sudden look of horror shot his way, he showed her his strongest, most supportive face, and hoped she remembered his words on the balcony about both of them cherishing the truth from that point on. He even gave her a gentle head nod.

Her eyes locked on his with static fury, but it softened as she slowly understood that he was right, that she had lied and that the lies created this problem to begin with. And like water over a rock, that fury went wet and weak and her tears returned. Lib folded over, her head hung, and a tear fell to her lap.

Chelsea was surprised, saying, “Hey, what’s up, what is it?”

“Ronnie kept trying... huh, ha, and one mm-day...”

Chelsea frowned and looked Ben’s way; he nodded to her, too. She said, “Libby, Ronnie did *what*...?”

Head down, arms folded tight, she said, “He was always teasing m-me, he was always being, duh-dirty, *so* dirty and, and...”

Chelsea’s calm expression began to tighten with anger, but she was all ears. Her hand moved to Libby’s back and stayed there. It gave Lib the strength to meet her gaze—but it quickly fell again.

Chelsea said, “What happened?”

“He showed me his thuh-thing, and then he made me show him mine...”

“He did what?”

“I didn’t want to cross you, I swear,” she said, looking up quick, pleading with Chelsea, her eyes scared. “I ruh-respected you...”

“What did Ronnie do?”

Libby looked his way, frightened, jaw trembling. He didn’t want her to have to repeat it, given the trouble he had getting her to admit it to him. The details were difficult for Lib. He said to Chelsea, “They just used their hands on each other.”

Chelsea frowned at him. “You knew this?”

He said, “She told me last night.”

“I’m sorry,” Libby said.

Chelsea looked at Lib now, still scowling. “Did that piece of shit make you do something you didn’t want to do?”

“He didn’t make me do it, he didn’t force me or anything at all. I just d-did it.”

“How many times?”

Libby’s eyes rolled around. She said, “Th-three days in a row. And on, mm, on the f-fourth day I didn’t come to school, I t-told my mom I was sick, and I suh-stayed at home.” She covered her face and cried.

Wait, three times...?

“Are you sure he didn’t force you?” Chelsea looked angry.

“He didn’t. I was, mm, I was c-curious, but I knew... I *shouldn’t*...”

WHILE LIBBY CRIED into her hands, Chelsea's features sunk and she looked distant, like lost in thought. She touched two fingertips under each of her eyes and then examined how they came away wet. She blinked and there was a twinkle of light as her lashes shed a tear that fell to her shirt. She sniffed and wriggled her nose. "Sorry, Libby, guys'll do that. Guys are fucked up."

Yeah, guys are fucked up, girls aren't.

Libby said into her hands: "If you wanted revenge on someone you should have got hi-him."

"Oh, I got him a while ago. I got him good. Look him up, you won't find him, not even on Facebook." Now she smiled in a way that gave Ben a chill considering Ronnie's fate.

Libby uncovered her face and wiped her eyes with the shoulder strap of her shirt. Chelsea made a weird smile; the corner of her mouth tucked back and formed a deep pocket. It was chagrin and shame. In a reluctant draggy motion, her hand came up and rested on Libby's back again. She swept a slow circle, then committed, surrendered, and caressed Libby.

Libby said, "All I ever wanted was for you to like me."

Chelsea squeezed the back of Lib's neck then held her against her chest and rocked her. She said, "All this time I wanted to crush you and I should have supported you."

"I d-didn't dis-disrespect y-you," Lib said, barely holding on.

"Come here," Chelsea said matronly, lifting her chin to provide space for Lib to rest a cheek against her collar. Chelsea hugged an arm around Lib. "Ah, shit," she sighed.

Lib gave a muffled, “What...?”

“Mm, nothing. I wish you did break my nose. I deserve it.”

“I didn’t want to hit you,” Libby squeaked.

“Yeah, you did. Don’t take it back, Lib, it was the greatest thing you’ve ever done in your whole life.”

Libby chuckled through her nose and lay her cheek back down. It surprised Ben how content she looked.

Chelsea caught him watching. “What are *you* looking at?”

He regarded her and grunted. “A crazy person.”

“Hey, fuck you for cheating on your wife.”

Ben growled and rubbed his forehead. Libby made a grunt of complaint and pulled away from Chelsea, her face looking haggard now and insulted.

Chelsea put up her hands in surrender and was quick to apologize, trying to prove to them she would be the new de-clawed Chelsea. “Sorry, sorry, sorry, guys, I’m sorry, I shouldn’t have said that. We won’t talk about it anymore...”

Libby crossed her arms over her chest and looked sullen, on the verge of crying.

Chelsea said, “Despite doing what I did, I *know* it was already ancient history. Let’s make it *officially* ancient history.” Chelsea smiled graciously, but when Lib didn’t return it, the smile faded. Chelsea said, “Unless Ronnie took *advantage* of you. You hear me? Ronnie’s out in B.C.—Ben and I know a girl out there with four brothers’ll take him for a walk in the woods.”

Lib shook her head. “He didn’t *make* me.”

“I bet he kind of did,” Chelsea said, “but we’ll let him go.”

“Ancient history,” Libby said, staring at the swampy remains of her banana split.

Chelsea said, “That would be great if you really mean it.”

“It’s ancient history,” Libby whispered so low, Chelsea had her repeat it.

“Look, Libby, I know I started something mean, and, yeah, it was supposed to hurt you, but it’s been working out. Would you say it’s been working out?”

Lib said no.

“You don’t think so? Finn had the best day. He texted me that. Said you were better than he could ever imagine.”

Lib's chin was tucked down, her expression swollen with surly plumpness, lips pooched out. But her eyes darted sideways to Chelsea. "Better how?"

Finn spoke up. "Libby and me had a day we'll remember forever. Ben, too." He sat stretched back in his chair, large bony hands clasped over his hard stomach, smiling and watching. Now he looked to Ben. "You had a good day, right?"

Ben got drawn into those black-eye tractor beams and nodded his agreement, feeling it should be more reluctant and he should back up his wife's chagrin, but also seeing ahead in Finn's eyes a sparkling turquoise future-lagoon he wanted to dive into, refresh himself and bathe.

Chelsea's eyes didn't leave Libby's profile. "I'm sorry I started this the way I did. But now it's rolling I don't want it to stop. Do you want it to stop?"

Libby's expression softened, and she stared down at her tray. Ben thought she might not answer, but at last her mouth moved. "What *is* it?..."

This made Chelsea smile. Like she'd found a toe-hold and knew she could scale Libby's fortress wall. "What would you like it to be?"

Libby shrugged her shoulders high, held them there a moment before they sagged. Now she tapped the glass edge of the table with her index fingers, then began to slide them back and forth in an act of contemplation.

"We can make it whatever you want it to be," Chelsea said in a low, soothing tone. Libby shrugged again. But now Chelsea dipped, kissed the point of Libby's bare shoulder. Lib's eyes widened, her pupils rolled up then down, taking in the crown of Chelsea's honey-caramel mane, then biting her lower lip as Chelsea resumed her seated position, looking at Lib with caring eyes and stroking her neck.

Lib looked from Chelsea to Finn, to Ben, back to Finn. Everyone watched her. Finn said, "Our little chipmunk wants to go home and do it bareback."

Libby's chest expanded as she drew in a deep breath and sucked her lower lip into her mouth. Her eyes dropped to her lap.

Chelsea smiled with an open mouth, her expression wide with prospective joy. "You do? You didn't do it already?—oh, my God, that's great. Libby, please, can I come? I just want to watch, I won't say anything."

Lib gave her head a rapid shake, said, "No, I'm sorry."

Chelsea took it well, nodding. "Okay. I get it..."

"Sorry..."

"It's okay. Another time? How about that?"

Libby nodded. "Maybe..."

"We're done for the day. You go home with Ben. You know our number. Libby, I swear, you and I got off on the wrong foot. That's me. You've been nothing but nice until I made you pop off. You knocked some sense in me. Starting right now, you and I could be friends."

Lib stared at the table, then nodded. Very quiet: "That's all I ever wanted."

Chelsea gave the back of Lib's neck a stroking caress, then said, "All right, Finn, let's get out of here. We'll leave them be."

Finn eased forward, eyes on Libby. "Sure. Give me a minute with my Libby..."

OUTSIDE THE RESTAURANT, Finn held Libby and talked close in her ear, the two of them standing beside Chelsea's motorcycle. Chelsea, arms crossed, sauntered Ben's way and stood next to him. Both of them watched Finn and Libby sharing secrets. Chelsea kicked at rocks with the toe of her cowboy boot, but Ben's eyes wouldn't leave Finn and Libby. *The way Finn's hand stroked on Lib's arm was driving him wild...*

"We can save it," Chelsea said. "It's not too late."

He turned to face her. "Too late for what?"

"I'm not kidding about being sorry. I get something stuck in my head and I'm going to see it through. Even when all the red lights are flashing at me and people are trying to tell me better, I still like to win."

"You didn't win."

"I'm glad I didn't win, Ben. That's what I'm saying. It's not too late for us to save this thing."

"What *is* this thing?"

Chelsea showed him her profile, eyes regarding her husband and Libby—she nudged her chin toward them. "That," she said. "It's what we all want."

"How am I ever going to trust you?"

"Don't. Don't ever trust me," she said then laughed. "But I mean it, somewhere along the way this started to feel good."

"Along the way? Along the way it was terrible."

"For you, maybe. But I was *trying* to make it terrible."

"Congratulations on your success."

“I’m good at what I do,” she said, clearing her throat, leaning to the side, balancing on one cowboy boot and spitting into a planter. “Sorry,” she said. “But now *imagine* if instead of me trying to make it terrible, I tried to make it hot and awesome as fuck.”

“So you want to salvage... what?”

“Don’t you want to keep this going? I know you were curious...”

“I like to see Libby happy.”

“Finn does, too. Now me. Libby wants it, Finn wants it, I want it, and I’m pretty sure *you* want it. Are you in?”

While everything in him screamed out the answer *No way, get out of my life*, he nodded.

“Is that a yes?” Chelsea tilted forward, smiling, trying to catch his eye.

He couldn’t help a small smile. “Yeah.”

She held out her palm for a low-five, said, “My man.”

He reluctantly slapped her five.

Finn sat on the bike’s saddle, looking into Lib’s eyes and holding both her hands. Libby was nodding, then he pulled her into an embrace, Lib’s whole scantily clad body sagging against him. Finn stood with her, lowered his lips and they kissed.

Chelsea said, “All right, Benjamin. Looks like I got to go. Maybe we’ll have a good summer after all.”

Finn was guiding Libby to walk toward her husband now, and she came to Ben with her arms folded. As Chelsea passed Libby, she ran her fingernails over Libby’s shoulder. Libby flinched, but didn’t move away. They passed, and Ben held out his arms for his wife. She came to him and he held her. With her face in his chest, he watched over her hair as Chelsea donned her helmet, and Finn started up her bike. Chelsea got on the back and put her arms around her husband. They both gave a two-finger salute, then pulled away into traffic in first gear, just a few minutes from home.

Ben held his wife close and ran his hands on her back. “You want to take a walk?”

Libby nodded against his chest.

PART 6
PROSPECT

AFTER THEY WALKED the boardwalk together, almost wordless the whole way, going right out to the Ashbridge's Bay Yacht Club and then back, they came home and Libby went straight to the couch. She lay on her side with her head on a pillow. He stood at the archway and said, "Can I get you anything?"

She told him no, eyes open but not looking at anything.

"You want tea or something to eat?"

She shook her head no. She said, "You want to sit with me?"

His heart jumped for joy. He didn't even answer, came and took his spot on the couch at her feet.

She said, "You want to watch the rest of the season?"

"I'd love to..."

DURING THE SECOND last episode of Game Of Thrones, he gathered Lib's feet and put them in his lap. He rubbed her soles and squeezed on her toes. She responded, nuzzling herself into the comfort of the couch and flexing her feet at the pleasure he delivered. Before the last episode started, he asked her again if she wanted anything.

"Maybe a little something."

"You want some tea? Popcorn?"

"Not hungry now," she said. "Maybe some tea..."

"Do you need anything else? You need an aspirin?"

She frowned a little, tucked her chin down to look at him.

He said, "Are you sore... down low?"

"No..."

"Chelsea said you might be. Because, you know, Finn's penis..."

At the mention of Chelsea, Lib didn't flinch. Even bringing up Finn's penis didn't make her recoil. It was progress. This was the direction of a conversation that would usually chase Libby away or make her stand her ground and ask Ben to correct his language or not even say those kinds of things. She kept his gaze but her expression was hard to read.

She sighed, said, "I just feel tired. I feel like I've been exercising."

He smirked. "I guess you have been."

She chuckled a little, and it surprised him. That was a dirty joke. Again, usually the kind of thing she would ignore, dismiss, have go over her head (or pretend went over her head)... But she laughed. He said, "You think that's funny?"

"No," she said, mirth restrained in her voice, a slight smile on her lips.

He said, “You’re not sore, you know, down there?...” He nudged his chin to her hips.

“No...”

“It didn’t hurt at all?”

“No. Well, a little the first time.”

“He feels good?”

She paused before answering, then nodded.

“I’m glad.”

More questions formed on his tongue but he struggled to let them unfurl. What he wanted to know was how he compared to Finn as a lover. How fulfilling was it with Finn in contrast? Was his big penis really so much better? But while he mimed forming words, Libby watched him. She had something to say on her own, and it stunned him...

LIB SMILED, said, "We're going to be okay, Ben."

His chin nodded up, astounded. "Are we?" He was stone serious and eager for relief.

"Definitely," she said and held out her palms.

He grabbed the undersides of her wrists, pulled her close and sitting and hugged her. "I love you so much."

Libby said, "I love you, too. I'm sorry..."

"Not as sorry as I am..."

"I'm pretty sorry, Ben, I mean it..."

"We don't have to compete for sorry, how about we compete for who can love each other better...?"

"I like that," she said.

He held their embrace for a long while, hands palming Lib's narrow back, her hands stroking on his.

After he let her go, she smiled but looked down. "When we broke up before college, I let it happen because even though you didn't know what I did with Ronnie, I felt like maybe you did. Subconsciously. And I felt like I didn't deserve you. I made myself suffer when we were apart—I didn't ever dare hope we'd get back together. End of first year, when we started dating again, I swore I'd make it right, and I swore I'd never be bad again."

"I love that you'll talk to me about this now."

"I wish I could before."

"You could have, Lib. I wish we could be more open, talk about these things. Even the dirty things. I don't want to live a lie anymore."

"I'm not living a lie..."

“We’re both liars.”

“I just keep things to myself...”

He chuckled, pinched the bridge of his nose to suppress a mild anger that rose. “Lib, first you said to Chelsea nothing happened, then something did. You swore to me it was Ronnie and you with your hands. Then it was three times it happened with you and Ronnie. You lied through your teeth that nothing happened with Finn in Barrie because you didn’t know I could hear you, and you kissed him and touched his dick and you swore up and down that—”

“But—”

“Lib, no, I’m not chasing you. I love you. I don’t know why you lie so much—”

“I don’t—”

“Lib, you lie a lot. I don’t know why. I think it’s about you and maybe shame you might feel, maybe you’re lying to yourself more than me, but I want you to know I love you no matter what.”

Libby’s face pinched mean and sad at the same time, her eyes lowered and she twiddled her thumbs in her lap like a scolded child.

He said, “Don’t tell me what happened between you and Ronnie. You can keep that for yourself. If you had his penis in your vagina, it wouldn’t be any different to me now than the things you felt comfortable to tell me. I mean it. One thing, Lib...”

It took a moment, but her eyes came up to meet his. “What...?”

“You and Ronnie, was it consensual?”

Lib’s eyes wandered around the room, left, right, up over his head. At last she nodded.

He said, “The only thing I’ll ever care about is that bad things don’t happen to you.” He put his arms around her again and hugged her close, her cheek on his chest.

“Ronny was a bully, but I only regretted what I did with him because I was in love with you.”

“That’s all I need to know.”

“Can I ask you something?”

This excited him and he couldn’t stop a smile. “Yeah, absolutely, Lib. What do you want to know?”

Her eyes met his, brows tented, mouth small and tight. She said, “You told me you wanted this, wanted me to have sex with Finn.”

“Yeah?...”

“The way it happened—was that the way you wanted it?”

“What do you mean?”

She looked aside. “Like, did you just want us to have sex? Or, like, what about me and him in the shower and everything, and us being alone all day?”

“I don’t know what I want from it. I don’t know why I even like it. But I do. But only because I love you so much. Does that make sense?”

“No.”

“It doesn’t?”

She shook her head. “It’s okay, though. I want to figure it out.”

“Do you think we’ll do more? Do you think you’ll be with Finn again?”

She shrugged, bit the inside of her cheek.

It unnerved him she would pinpoint the casual, fun things she’d done with Finn and it had him thinking of what he’d missed while away arranging his yacht’s piloting. “What did you guys do today?”

“Had fun.”

“How many times did you have sex?”

Lib made her usual look of concern, a flash of avoidance in her eyes, but she caught him looking and knew he recognized it. She took a long inhale, then sighed. “Uh, in bed when we woke up, uh, then we went downstairs, we had some eggs. We had sex in the kitchen. Later in the family room, too. We messed around on the couch, but not, you know, inside me. He just used his fingers.”

He nodded, allaying a swelling lust rising within him thinking of his Lib being sexually playful with another man. “When did you go out?”

“Lunchtime. We rode into the Beaches and went to Casa Mia, but we pretty much came straight back.”

“Then you ate?”

“Then we ate, and we messed around some more. I used my hand.”

The stained table occurred to him. “Did he come on the table?”

Her mouth skewed sideways. “Sorry.”

“You didn’t clean up right away?”

“We fell asleep. And I was... I wanted to see how far his stuff comes out.” It was a shock to her she’d said it, he could tell. She watched him with anxious horror, worried how he’d react.

While his heart pounded, all he said was: “His sperm?”

She nodded, looked down. “His comes out far like you.”

Kind of a compliment, he guessed. He said, “I wasn’t so impressive when we did it on your chest.”

Lib pulled in air hard and fast like she was about to jump in a cold lake. Her cheeks went red, and she made to flop back on the couch but he grabbed her shirt and pulled her back. She squirmed to get away, but he kissed her and she made nervous chuckles around their tongues.

When he released their kiss, he said, “You told me you wanted to be good in bed. Or maybe *bad*...”

She nodded agreement, pouted mouth shoved to one side.

“That was pretty bad,” he said, nodding with a sly smile, letting her know he meant the *naughty* meaning.

She smiled too, then covered her mouth with her hands.

He poked her middle, and she jumped. She asked him, “Do big balls have more sperm?”

It flabbergasted him, but he tried not to show it. Her question twisted his stomach and hurt his balls all at the same time. He said, “I don’t know.”

“Maybe they do. It makes sense,” she said sleepily, then yawned.

He yawned as well. “Don’t make me yawn.”

“It’s such a long day...”

“I like talking with you,” he said, “talking for real like this.”

She agreed and lay back on the pillow, propped another one under her so she was sitting more upright, her legs still across his lap. They stared at each other warmly for a long while, mouths occasionally stretching with a smile then relaxing again.

Now she asked him, “Have *you* ever seen a penis like Finn’s?”

HE JOLTED. “Me—why would I be looking at penises?”

“In, like, a locker room or somewhere. One of your friends’...”

“Oh. No...”

“So his is, what?—I guess *exceptionally* big...?”

“It is.”

“Okay,” she said, looking down and nodding.

“Why what are you thinking?”

“It’s nine inches long, did you know that?”

“Not ten? Who said nine?”

“I did... I measured it.”

His own penis swelled suddenly, getting a rusty spike of detail he hadn’t expected. “Really? It’s only nine?”

She looked up. “What do you mean *only*?”

“Chelsea said it was ten.”

“It was nine and a bit, and he was pretty hard. I don’t think he could have got much harder.”

His heart pounded thinking of little Libby Sanders so bad. “You really liked his dick.”

She shrugged and looked away.

“What did you think when you had us both in bed, one dick in each hand? Do you like his better?”

She got bashful, red returning to her cheeks. “Don’t ask me that.”

“Why—‘cause you like his better?”

Now she frowned. “I like yours better because it’s yours, Ben.”

“But when you have sex?”

“He’s really big.”

“And you like big?”

Her features pinched. “I don’t... *not* like it.”

“Tell me, Lib.”

“I *like* it,” she said, a measure of exasperation in her voice.

“Was that so hard?”

“No.”

He slid her ankles toward his knees not wanting her to know in this moment that merely discussing her with Finn and his large cock had him rock hard.

She watched his profile, and he looked her way. She said, “How big is yours?”

He said, “What made you want to measure Finn?”

She raised her brows. “We were playing around. I was saying how much bigger, I mean, how big his penis was, and I got it in my head that I wanted to put a ruler on it. He said I could.”

“That’s all right.”

“I know. Most guys are six inches, right?”

“I think smaller.”

“Smaller than six?”

“It’s like five and a bit is the real average.”

She nodded. “Wow. Are you bigger than that?”

“What do you think?”

“I think you are,” she said, smiling.

“You’re right. Can I ask you something?”

“Maybe...”

“How big was Ronnie?”

The happiness waned, and her mouth quirked aside, but she answered him. “Closer to you.”

“Closer to me than Finn?”

“Yeah.”

“So he was big?”

“He wasn’t small.”

Ben nodded a while, chin just going up and down and processing this new information. “Okay. You’re saying he was bigger than me?”

“Kind of.”

“You thought of that even back then?”

“I guess. Not in a bad way. Just curious.”

If Lib was to be believed, and the only three penises she'd experienced in her life was his, Finn's, and Ronnie's, he'd just mathematically deduced himself to being the smallest penis his wife had interacted with. He wasn't even small. But somehow being shunted aside by larger lovers in his wife's repertoire was insanely thrilling and heartbreaking all at the same time. His pulse raced, and his cock—the one Lib wasn't impressed by but loved out of fondness, familiarity, and marital duty—was a steel rod right now.

Since he'd gone away in a reverie and Lib seemed stupefied in a growing sleepiness, she un-paused the show and let it resume. The talk was over and that was for the best. While he'd enjoyed her frankness, cherished it, really, it had pumped up his heart muscle into a frenzy and conjured strange lurid feelings inside he hadn't anticipated. He wanted perspective on them before tossing their weight and mess into his wife's lap.

He settled back on the seat and resumed rubbing his favorite little feet in the world...

THOUGH HE DIDN'T SUSPECT she would, Libby responded to his intimate nudging in bed. They'd watched the last episode of Game Of Thrones, and he'd rubbed her feet. She'd had tea. They skipped dinner. They went to bed early. She had been in the mood at the burger joint, but that was quashed when Chelsea arrived. Some of the fantasy dissolved, and the ugly truth Chelsea brought was revealed, shining bright lights on what Lib'd been doing in the shadows with Finn. Ben figured she wouldn't want sex tonight. Though she said Finn didn't make her sore, he imagined she *would* be tender. He was prepared to sleep at her side, just happy to be with her, but couldn't resist the urge to slip his hand over the narrow of her waist. Libby didn't pull away, didn't slap her cheating husband's hand. No, why would she? She bore a burden that might've weighed the same as his, and bore it for much longer. He'd cheated; she'd cheated. While he didn't blame her at all, she carried guilt. The things that had been done behind each other's backs maybe could have restored them after all.

So when she didn't resist, his fingers curled over the crest, the tips slipping under the hem of her T-shirt, finding the softness of her tummy where it sunk to her belly button. Oh, boy, and now she was sending him signals of her own... She pushed her rump a little closer, and they cinched their bodies together. He hugged her tight, and his cock grew to full hardness in an alarming amount of time. Libby felt it, and her hand came down to touch his hip. It set off electric tingles in his stomach.

She slipped her hand between them and found his hardness over his pajama pants. She stroked him, and he bit on her shoulder. They slipped their pajama pants down, and Libby guided him into her opening. A *bold*

move for Libby. But she was more sexually secure. He would receive the gift of her confidence.

Slowly, he sunk himself inside her, but couldn't push away the thought he was shorter by almost three inches. Finn had probed deeper inside her, would have provoked greater sexual heights from Lib just by the depth. Then there was the taboo: Finn was another woman's husband, he was hot, somehow dangerous, somehow friendly... Ben didn't have that. Ben was just her life partner, her stable companion who shared his life with her and she with him. That was a-okay, because even if he wasn't getting deeper, wasn't pushing out her walls in the same way, Libby responded. She gasped, breathed heavy through pouted lips. He stroked her throat and made love to her. They worked together, doing it like spoons, something last week Libby who would've thought was an *outrageous* sex position that only wild sex freaks performed, and yet five days later now and it was a kind and sweet way for a husband and wife to share their love.

As he watched her face rim-lit by blue moonlight, he recalled all the awesome scenes he'd witnessed in the last twenty-four hours. The way Libby responded to the prowess of another man. The way Libby received a larger sex organ, the way she obviously enjoyed it. And though he'd intended to impress her, conjure his inner Finn tonight and make love to her, pressing all her buttons until they both cried out in orgasm, his came out hard and fast and unstoppable.

"Shoot, wait," he said, but it was too late...

Libby wasn't listening, anyway. Rocking and rolling her butt up against his hipbones, eager for cock, and that eagerness setting off Ben's orgasm like lighting a bottle rocket. He came inside her, full and hard, and she mewled at the wet feel of him pulsing. He grabbed a breast over her T-shirt cotton and squeezed. He pushed himself deep and held, still pushing out semen inside her. She panted in his arms, eyes open and looking at the ceiling.

"Wow," he said. "I love you so much."

"I love you, too, Ben," she said, hand coming up to brush the hair out of her face. Her head sank in the pillows; he kissed her shoulder; he fell asleep with his penis inside her.

MUCH LATER, he was woken by two small feminine hands patting at his chest. He snorted, drew back, eyes unfocused and dazed, hand holding Libby's wrist.

A whisper: "Sorry, sorry, Ben..."

He murmured, "What... what's going on?" His voice was just sleepy air.

"Can we call him?"

Bewilderment raised his brow, eyes staying sleepy, and he didn't understand what was being said at all. "What...?"

"Can we call him?"

"Call who?..."

Libby whispered, "Can we call Finn?"

"What...?"

"Please," she said, patting his chest, "sorry, let's call him..."

His head lolled on the pillow, mind still reeling in the clutch of a deep sleep. "What do you mean Let's call him?"

"He can come over," she said.

"Come over here?..."

"I'm sorry, Ben," she said again. "Can we just call him?"

He struggled up on one elbow, rubbing at the top of his head, hair going off in clumps, and looked over his shoulder, saw the clock on the nightstand. "It's 2:15, Libby..."

"It doesn't matter, I know it won't matter... Finn won't mind..."

It hurt. Like her husband wasn't enough. But something about *that* grabbed at his lapels and shook him. *You hear that? How hot is that?...* It

was kinda hot, and he didn't know why. He scratched at his neck. "Yeah, okay."

"Can we really?" Moonlight glinted off her teeth. She was smiling.

"I like that you're asking me for permission."

"I'm asking for permission, Ben," she said in an excited whisper.

"Well," he said, a stern father deciding, "okay. You know you go to work in the morning, you can't take four days off work like that, they need you down there."

"I know," she said, and he hated to be the one to bring her the disappointment of reality.

"Okay," he said, "okay," trying to change gears and get into this. He could already feel a puzzling arousal between his legs. He turned to the nightstand and picked up his phone. "What if Chelsea yells at us?" he asked, swiping open his contacts and dialing the Slade house, anyway. "Like she wants her beauty sleep... She might be mad at us..."

Libby said nothing and watched him, waiting. His balls rolled around in their bag as the wonder came to him: she lay next to her husband thinking of another man, probably got herself all hot and horny. Horny enough she was bold and woke her husband with a request to invite over her lover. His cock stiffened at the idea. *If he slipped his hand down the front of her panties, how wet would it come away...?*

When he heard ringing, he passed the phone to her. She took it, eyes widening in the dim light. He said, "You ask him."

Lib didn't back down. "Okay," she said, and now she was smiling.

Phone pressed to her ear, she listened to the ringing. It rang three more times, and Ben was sure it would not be answered. Libby turned her eyes up to him and said, "Can I get a new phone?"

"You want a smartphone?"

"I do," she said.

"I'll get you—"

The ringing stopped as someone picked the call up, and he shut his mouth. Libby held up a finger.

Her voice was quiet like she didn't want to disturb them, saying into the phone now, "Hey... it's Libby..."

A voice on the other side spoke but he couldn't make out the words. It was Chelsea, or at least a woman's voice.

Libby said, "No... I was just wondering....Yeah....No, I know....What are you guys doing?....Oh... That's too bad....When does he get back?....Oh, okay..."

Libby sank as she listened to Chelsea's thin virtual voice coming from one street over. Her shoulders sloped forward and down, and her head began to hang. Chelsea was asking a lot of questions now, and Libby was giving yes or no answers.

"Uh-huh, okay....Sorry I called so late....Okay..." She hung up.

Ben asked what happened.

"He's not even home."

"He's not?"

"No, he's out in Hamilton. There's a custom installation for some big show, and..." She passed back his phone then threw up her hands. The details weren't important, only that she was let down.

"Sorry, Lib," he said. They were both quiet, Lib's sunken silhouette next to him on the bed. She had a sexual need, and now it would go unfulfilled. It quickened his breath. "You want to try again?"

She mumbled, "Try what?"

"Sex."

"No," she said, "that's okay."

That hurt. Hurt in a weird and exciting way. He returned his phone to the nightstand. Lib flopped down on the pillow, and Ben lay to face her, both of them getting close until their noses touched. "He'll be back," he said.

"I know," she said, voice heavy with disappointment.

While Lib was disappointed, Ben trembled with excitement that this whole affair was back on track...

THE RINGING of a phone pulled him up out of a deep sleep.

It was 2:40. He thrashed around, swiping his phone from the nightstand and gripping it in a choke. When he remembered how it worked, he answered.

Chelsea said, “You too chicken to answer your door in the middle of the night?”

“What...?”

“I’ve been knocking—how deep do you guys sleep?”

“Knocking where?”

“Your door, Benjamin,” she sighed. “Let me in.”

“My front door?”

“Yes, your front door—you think I’m in your attic?... Wake up, already, come and let me in...”

“Yeah, huh? Yeah, uh, s’long day, I guess—”

“Knock, knock, Ben, get down here, it’s cold and I’m wearing shorts.”

“Yeah, yeah,” he stammered and hung up.

Libby was up now, too, sitting next to him rubbing a knuckle into an eye. “What... what’s going on?”

“It was Chelsea. She’s at our front door...”

Libby’s rubbing hand flopped down into the bedding. “Is Finn here?” There was bright hopefulness in her voice.

“I don’t think so. I think she’s on her own,” he said, backing out from under the warmth of the covers.

“Oh... What does she want?”

“I don’t know, she didn’t say—she’s been knocking on the door...”

“What time is it?”

“We drifted off, I think we called her maybe half an hour ago...”

“And Finn’s not here?”

“I gotta go, Libby, she’s waiting, I don’t want her to be mad...”

“Okay,” Libby said now, a little more fearful. She gathered bedding into her lap where she sat crossed-legged.

Ben told Libby to hold on again, got out of the bedroom, slipped to the top of the stairs. It was a moonlit night, and he could see the shadow of a figure across the glass inset of the front door. He hustled down the stairs, flicked on the hallway and porch light. A warbled image of Chelsea in a leather jacket stood out there. She waved one simple swipe at him, and he thought she might be smiling. He unlocked the door and opened it, letting in cool nighttime air. She stepped in past him. He said, “What’s going on?”

“You guys sure are sound sleepers...”

“It’s almost three in the morning...”

“Hey,” she snapped, wheeling around. “You called *me*,” she said, “You woke *me* up, or don’t you remember?”

“All right, sorry...” It relieved him she still smiled. Under her leather jacket she wore a white tank top. She wore cowboy boots again but with cotton pajama shorts, long, lean, tanned legs bare below.

She asked: “Where’s Libby?”

“In bed.”

“Get her down here.”

“Why?”

“Just get her down here,” she said, “Ben, come on...”

“Is Finn here?”

“I told you Finn’s in Hamilton,” Chelsea said, then leaned her body on the staircase railing. She slapped her open palm on the banister—banging the underside of her silver rings. She called out, “Libby, Libby, Libby, come on, get down here...”

She spun then and faced him. “I told you this would get good.”

“You also said not to trust you.”

“You shouldn’t. But I’m here for good reason.”

“What’s that?”

There was the soft padding of bare feet at the top of the stairs. They looked up and saw Libby from the hips down, her bare legs under the hem of her cotton sleeping shorts.

Lib asked, "What is it?"

"Lib, come on and get down here," Chelsea said, putting her hands on her hips and coming to the bottom of the stairs, ducking down a little so she could peer up at Libby.

Libby said, "What are you doing here?"

"Finn sent me, okay? Now, would you come down here...?"

Libby's bare legs began to work down the steps, tentative and slow but eager to find out what Finn wanted. Chelsea held out a hand for her, waiting at the bottom step. Libby put hers out to be held. Chelsea guided her to stand in the foyer, saying, "Ben, turn out that porch light, what's the matter with you?"

"What...?" he complained, but did what he was told, leaning and flicking off the light.

"And the hall light, too, don't you have anything a little more ambient?" Chelsea squinted at the ceiling light.

He flicked off the hall light, immersing them in darkness, but tucked a hand under the shade of the lamp on the hallway dresser. He twisted on a dim amber-shaded glow.

Libby whispered, "What's going on?" She'd gathered her hands together between her breasts. She wasn't wearing a bra.

Chelsea said, "I told you, Finn sent me."

"Sent you for what?"

"Lib, after you talked to me, I gave him a call. He was heartbroken he wasn't here. I mean it, Lib, totally heartbroken. And here's the bad part: he's gone till Friday. He won't be home till Friday afternoon."

"That's okay," Lib said, voice timid and childish.

"Yeah, well, Finn wishes he was here. So you're going to come over on Friday when he gets home."

"Okay," Lib said, still puzzled that Chelsea was here.

"Libby, Libby, Libby," Chelsea purred, studying her. She caressed the sides of Libby's face, ran fingers through her hair down to where it touched her collar. "The things Finn's going to do to you..."

Ben could see Libby's knees dip at that lusty warning.

Lib sighed, "Oh, yeah...?"

"Oh, yes, indeed. He was telling me. I'll leave it as a surprise, except for one thing..."

"What's that?"

Chelsea patted her palm on the dresser's top now, rings banging on the wood again. She said, "Put your hands on up here."

"Why?"

"You want to find out?"

Libby nodded.

Chelsea said, "Then put your hands up here..."

LIBBY COMPLIED, turning sideways to Chelsea and putting the flats of her hands on the top of the mahogany hall dresser. There was a mirror hung above, and her eyes darted in it, seeking Ben's. They looked at each other with tentative wonder. *What was this all about?*...

"What are you going to do?" Libby asked.

Chelsea massaged Libby's back, squeezing her shoulders, up around her neck, and sweeping down the center to the small of her back. She said, "Finn said you had the cutest ass he'd ever seen."

"He did?" Libby's voice had gone high and breathy.

Chelsea lowered her eyes, watched her fingers pluck up the hem of Libby's cotton T-shirt, exposing the small of her back and the elastic waist of her teddy bear sleeping shorts. "He did..." She tucked two fingers down the back of Libby shorts, worked them back and forth, loosening them, and peeling them down Libby's bare ass. She pushed the shorts until they went below mid-thigh and then fell to the floor.

"Wow, Finn wasn't joking. Can't believe you keep this thing hidden away..." She dragged fingernails over the soft round curves of Libby's ass cheeks, drew lines and circles there, saying, "God, Libby, Finn wasn't kidding, it's like a ripe peach." She gave it light pats now, first one cheek then the other. "He said you had the cutest ass he's ever seen. Shit, Libby, look at this, you got a better ass than I do..."

Libby couldn't answer, her lips parted and pouted, she panted through her mouth. Her breaths were low but quickening, hearing how much Finn appreciated her rump.

“Ben,” Chelsea said, “look at this ass your wife’s got.” Now she clutched a handful of ass flesh and shook it. Libby’s butt yielded to Chelsea’s grip, her ass round and taut.

Chelsea leaned closer to Libby now, tried to make eye contact, but Libby’s eyes were closed. She said, “Finn told me he wants this ass on Friday.”

Libby nodded.

Chelsea said, “You know what I mean?”

Libby said, “I think so...”

“Yeah, he wants to fuck you from behind, Libby, are you getting a better picture now?”

Libby frowned, eyes still closed. “No...”

Chelsea drew a diamond shape just below Libby’s tailbone where the split of her ass began. She swiped that index finger down like Libby’s ass crack was a card reader. The finger disappeared between the halved globe of Libby’s perfect butt. Libby’s nails pressed into the mahogany, and her toes curled up on the hallway floor. Chelsea rotated her hand, and Ben could tell she was trying to poke her finger in Libby’s anus.

Chelsea said, “Understand now?”

“Oh, no...”

“Oh, yes,” Chelsea said. “He told me he wanted your tight little butthole so bad, he couldn’t stop thinking about it.”

“Are you serious?”

“This is going to be the hardest two-and-a-half days for my husband. You’re his new favorite fuck toy, Libby. He’s got it bad for you. You make Finn’s big dick so damn H-A-R-D...”

“Oh, wow,” Libby said, Chelsea’s hand easing up Libby’s back again the finger coming out from between her cheeks. Ben watched it disappear into the open-mouth of her leather jacket’s pocket.

Chelsea said, “But you know Finn’s got a huge dick...”

“I do...”

“So long, isn’t it?”

“So long,” Libby sighed. “And so thick...”

“He wants you to enjoy it...”

“I will...”

“Ben ever put himself up in your little butthole?”

Libby shook her head no and bit on her lower lip.

“That’s why I’m here.”

“Why?...”

CHELSEA WITHDREW from her pocket something that glinted between her parted fingers. Just past her pinky, a short, bright pink feathery fox tail dangled. “Open your eyes,” she said.

Libby’s eyes fluttered, and she dipped her chin to see what Chelsea presented. Ben could see it from Libby’s other side: a cylindrical object, metallic, sparkling bright gold. A four-inch long bulb shaped like a three-dimensional ace of spades. The point was blunt, rounded.

Chelsea said to Libby, “You know what this is?”

Libby said she didn’t.

Chelsea said, “It’s going to make sure that you’re ready for my husband on Friday.”

“Okay...”

“It’s going to make the next few days almost *unbearable* in anticipation, waiting for him to take your ass.”

“What is it?”

“Open your mouth.”

“Why?”

Chelsea ran the nose of the object along Libby’s throat, pushing the point of her chin upward. As she pressed it to Libby’s lower lip, Libby let her mouth open and Chelsea inserted it. “Hold still,” Chelsea said, “I want to get that good and warm.”

Her other hand went into the opposite jacket pocket and brought out a travel size antibiotic hand cleaner. A small squirt-top dispenser of clear gel. Only it wasn’t hand cleaner at all—it should’ve been obvious to him. It was lubricant. Ben could read the brand name on the side: Anal-Ease.

“It’s a butt plug,” he said.

Libby’s cheek turned toward him, and while the sight was comical, no laugh wanted to emerge from him. His cock pulsed and throbbed in his underwear. The feathered tail of the butt plug dangled below Libby’s chin, her mouth puckered around the bulbous end like a fish. Her eyes were wide, and he couldn’t help the phrase *Got a real live one here* from passing through his mind. Chelsea and Finn did indeed have a real live one on their hook.

“That’s good,” Chelsea said now, withdrawing the butt plug from Libby’s mouth like she’d been taking a child’s temperature. It shone with Libby’s spit, and his wife wiped at her chin with the back of her wrist. Her eyes turned down to watch Chelsea and what she did now. Chelsea held out the butt plug in an even horizontal line, drew a squiggly line of lubricant along it. She said, “Little help, Ben...?”

He closed the distance from the other side. Now Lib had Chelsea and Ben on either side of her. Chelsea presented the butt plug before Libby’s eyes, glistening with the clear gel that would ease its entry inside her. Chelsea said, “Finn’s got a huge dick, but he’s going to take that little ass of yours. We all want it, so why don’t we make it as painless as possible, right? You’re going to wear this in your ass for Finn.”

Libby nodded.

“You’re going to wear it to work, you don’t have to sleep with it, but I want this thing inside you making room for my husband.”

Libby nodded again.

“Up on your tippy-toes, Lib.”

Libby closed her eyes again, and Ben dipped his chin down to watch her little toes spread for purchase on the floor, feet arching, heels lifting, calf muscles flexing. It pushed her ass up higher. Chelsea spanked it, watched it shake, passed the butt plug into her right hand then clutched the closest ass cheek with the other.

“Ben...” she said, and he knew what to do.

He placed his hand on the soft round shape of his wife’s bottom, lifted and spread the other ass cheek. He leaned to the side so he could watch. Chelsea pressed the nose an inch or two above Libby’s anus, then ran the slippery tip down in a straight line until it pushed against his wife’s tiny pink aperture. Libby made a warbling, uncomfortable sound and her ankle clicked as she pushed higher on her toes.

“That’s it, Libby, here we go,” Chelsea said, and eased the butt plug inward a half inch at a time, waiting for Libby to accommodate it. The thing sank deeper and deeper, the size of it elbowing out her sphincter as its girth increased, and Libby’s buttohole swallowed up the bulbous plug end. Now just the flat round stem of it showed, the dangling pink tail hanging between her thighs.

“That’s going to make it so much easier, Lib. I swear to God, wear this thing for two days and you’ll be dying to get ass fucked.”

Libby panted, her head nodding forward and back.

“All right, that’s it,” Chelsea said, and spanked, squeezed, and hefted Libby’s ass cheeks. Libby hissed and mumbled, her face squinted shut. Ben watched her beautiful features twist in the hallway mirror, his cock at full hardness in his pajama pants.

Chelsea was looking at him now. He mumbled, “What...?”

“Finn wants her on Friday,” Chelsea said, “so I was hoping you could keep your greasy little hands off her until then. At least keep your dick out of her...”

He stared at her, hearing the words but not comprehending. Slowly, he began to nod.

“Good,” Chelsea said, “I gotta get back in bed, I got a shitload to do today. Good night, Lib...” She got close to her and kissed her cheek. “We’ll take good care of you,” she said, studying Libby’s closed off face and caressing the top curve of her ear with a thumb.

Libby’s eyes fluttered, and she sucked her lips between her teeth. Chelsea smiled, eased off the dresser and moved away from them backward, admiring her own devious handiwork. “Night, Ben,” she said then, and waved over her shoulder as she pushed open the front door and disappeared into the moonlight dark.

Soon there was the guttural rumble of her motorcycle and he wondered how he’d slept through her arrival at all. But then again, the events of the last few days had worn him out. The bike’s blatting grew thin and distant, and finally Lib turned around and leaned her back against the dresser. Her eyes were open but narrow and sleepy. Her pants looped her ankles still, her fuzzy muff nestled between her closed thighs.

“How does it feel?” he asked her, the moment so weird he didn’t know what else to say.

Libby's mouth opened as if she would answer, and it was like the ridiculousness of the situation just hit her, too. She closed her mouth, opened it again, closed it. She shook her head, and a smile began to pull upward on the corners of her pretty mouth. She said, "It feels like Chelsea Cunningham just put a huge butt plug in my bottom," and then burst out laughing.

Ben watched her almost fold in two, but being careful because of the large shape that had been pushed inside her. Her knees came together, and he thought she was trying to stop herself from peeing as she laughed so hard she couldn't breathe. Then he folded over with her, joining in the hilarity, and put his arm around her back. They laughed until they couldn't, then they laughed some more. He held her close to him.

When it was finally done, Libby touched his shoulder, and he regarded her.

She said very quietly, "Maybe you *could* do something for me..."

BEN LOOMED over top of Libby who looked at him fearfully. The fear was greater in him: he worried she'd changed her mind.

"You really want me to?"

It was the wrong thing to say, a look of reneging flashing across her eyes before she turned her head away, blonde hair swishing on the silk of the pillow sheet. "Ben..."

"No, Libby, no," he said, gripping her shoulders tight then softening, stroking her arms. "I want to. I want to so bad..."

"Are you sure?"

"Never been more sure of anything in my life except that day I said I do."

She giggled a little, got bashful, hid her face away, but a warmth went through him seeing the good humor; it was going to happen.

He kissed her neck, kissed her collar. Then she tightened. Her arms closed around him and she made a grunting, muffled complaining sound. The word wasn't formed, but it sounded like *Don't...*

He kissed at her collar, tugged the neck hole of her T-shirt to get at that hidden part of her chest. It got her sighing, some of the stiffness releasing. Her hands drew circles on his back, fingertips pressing in, wanting to keep his face up where she could see it.

So he gave her his kiss. Put his mouth over hers, digging a shoulder into the bed above her shoulder while his hands worked underneath him. He slipped fingers under the waistband of her shorts, started pushing them down. And Libby committed. She helped him. Together, they worked her shorts down her thighs, both of them bumping knees and elbows and

forearms as they kissed mouths and took her shorts off. His hand came up the inside of her thigh and her breath trembled into his mouth. They froze, looking at each other, mouths hanging open, lips swollen. All the focus was on what his hands did. His fingertips zapped every sensation back to him, and the feel of his fingers shot back the same to Libby. Two people experiencing a pinpoint focus of pleasure in two different ways. The closer his hand came between her thighs, both of them out on either side of his hips, the warmer she felt. That fuzzy patch of pubic hair began to tickle the backside of his thumb. He massaged his palm now against her sex. He could feel the squish of her moist membranes, the tickle of her unshaved pussy between his fingers. His middle finger dipped down, seeking that odd device the mean, beautiful girl from high school put inside his wife. He could feel where the metal pushed into Libby. Could feel how her little sphincter hugged up against the hardness. She let out a tremulous moan as he explored the circumference of the foreign object preparing her anus for Finn's entry.

His fingertips came up now, teased at her opening, her tightly packed folds slippery amongst all the brush of her pubic hair. Lib swiveled her hips, pushing her pussy out, eager to feel his touch. Their eyes connected, but Libby was more unseeing than him. Looking into his eyes but looking *through* him. Maybe focusing on some fantastical scenario playing out in her mind. Like it was Finn with her now, Finn over top of her, dominating her, preparing to put his mouth between her legs...

NOW BEN KISSED her collar again, his hand still twiddling between her legs. He kissed her shirt over top of her soft breasts flattened on her chest. He found the hard buds of her nipples and plucked them with his teeth, kissed lower down the center of her stomach. He watched up her body, and when she looked down, dipping her chin, their eyes met.

She showed him a frightful, shocked expression. "Oh, no, Ben..."

He kissed her bellybutton where it peeked just below the hem of her T-shirt.

She giggled, said, "Agh, Ben, no..."

He kissed the swell of her soft stomach underneath her navel...

She darted a look down again and made a squealing sound. "Wait, wait, wait, don't..."

"Come on, Lib..."

"Ben, don't look at me," she said after a long moment vacillating.

He tucked his chin down so he wouldn't look at her, kissed her stomach, then kissed two inches lower. Libby made a more pleased sound now, and the sheets whisked over top of him in a shroud. "Hey!"

"Stay under there," she instructed.

"It's hot..."

"Don't come out," she said then gave a soft laugh.

Whatever worked for her, he would do it. In this cotton-shrouded Dutch oven he smelled the powerful scent of her sex. She'd had her little pocket pounded by her big dick lover multiple times today. He'd had her as well. Without a condom, sliding up inside her, loosing the contents of his testicles. But there were no smells of condoms, she showered after Finn,

though at the Burger Church he'd fingered her with her juices spurting. Finn had been washed from her. So it was just him and the cute little box of the woman he fell in love with and married.

His eyes grew adjusted in the dark of his tent, and he made out the dark triangle between her legs. Saw the split between, saw the tight folds of her labia. Libby had a small opening, she was tight, membranes thin, pink, and tightly packed. He could count on one hand the times he'd seen it, but here she was letting him get his eyes and nose and mouth closer than he'd ever gotten before. Her scent was wonderful, the tickle of her pubic hair against the philtrum above his top lip sent chills of pleasure through his belly. He touched her with the tip of his tongue, felt a stinging tang and wondered if it was from the big-dick abuse her sex had taken today. It had been stretched and beaten and pounded.

Libby hissed above, and he heard a creeping, *squeezing* sound on either side of him—Libby grabbing sheets and clenching them *tight* in her fists. She let out a sigh, and it was pinched thin by a whine. He tongued her again, swiping north to south, then south to north, spreading her furrowed flesh, tasting the innermost part of her seam. It got Libby's thighs opening and closing, her heels stroking on the sheets outside of his thighs. He dipped his chin lower, put his mouth over that woman part of her, suckled on it, brought the gathered flesh to a pucker and pushed his tongue into the seam. Libby mewled. It was heaven under the sheets. This was Libby in a way he never hoped to experience. Sure, she was timid still, but her inhibitions were weak and soggy like dampened paper. The more Finn pushed at her, the more her confines would come away. He *wanted* that. Maybe it would never be him that could do it for her, but being under this tent right now with his tongue inside her was such a powerful, *beautiful* experience. He never truly ached for it before, it was the kind of thing he would push away. It would be tortuous to ache for something he knew would never happen. But now that it *was* happening, his floodgates opened, and all that interior desire gushed forward.

He'd *wanted* this. He'd *always* wanted this. Always wanted Libby in that way... She was so sweet and so perfect, she was everything to him—he could overlook some things that fell short. Because on every other mark she shot well past. But if she were to be *this* kind of girl with him, he would worship her.

His mouth made love to that elastic wet part of her, pushing with his tongue circling, licking, lapping, prodding and probing. Libby responded, hissing and moaning, thighs closing on him, opening again, her hips rolling from side to side. When he pushed with the point of his tongue, she curled her pelvis forward to receive it. As he got her breathing heavy, his hand worked its way so his fingers closed around the cylindrical base of the butt plug. Now he worked her with his tongue while wiggling and rolling the thing that Chelsea had put inside her.

He had Libby singing now. Full-voice whining and crying. She gasped, her hands beat at the sheets, and her pelvis beat her sopping pussy against his mouth. He lapped at her faster and harder until his cheeks and brow slicked with his saliva and her excitement.

When she came, she let out a long and low moan that went in undulating waves until it thinned and left her panting for breath. When he didn't stop, when he kissed and suckled right through her orgasm, her thighs closed hard around his head and the muscles in her legs trembled. The sheets pulled and tugged around him, and he was sure that she had them clutched in her curled toes. He drew her orgasm out longer. She let him know the pleasure it brought.

But when it was done, it was done.

Libby's body melted in the sheets and her legs fell open. Her stomach rolled up and down, and he lay the side of his face against it, her soaking pubic hair tickling and scratching at his chin.

"Oh, God," she panted, "oh, my God, oh, Ben..."

It was the most incredible thing they'd done together. At least sexually. It had been so intimate. Another man had provoked it in Libby, but it was him who enjoyed it. He didn't even care if while he was just a ghost between her legs with a slippery tongue poking into her she imagined her sexy lover with his sinewy, no body fat hard body, and tattoos and thigh-slapping horse-cock...

He laughed, and it brought her stomach bouncing as she joined in. Her chuckles were light and breathy, no voice, just whisking air. He pushed himself off, threw himself down next to her making her bounce on the bed. "Oh, my God," he sighed.

"Oh, wow," Libby said.

"That was crazy."

"*Crazy-crazy,*" she said between lurching breaths.

This time when he regarded her, she didn't look away, and it got his heart pounding...

THERE WAS some truth he wanted. He said, "Finn turns your crank, doesn't he?"

Lib's head rolled his way. She regarded him, wordless, light catching in the wet of her eye, her front teeth rubbing on her lower lip.

"I want to hear that you do."

"Okay," she whispered.

"He does?"

"Yeah."

"I know he does."

"He does."

"Tell me..."

"Finn turns my crank," she said, then in a sweet and caring gesture, as if she understood how the truth might hurt, sweetheart Libby caressed his cheek. It was her injured hand, and the swollen pinky was hot on his skin. He kissed her thumb.

"How did it feel to punch Chelsea Cunningham right in the nose?"

She snuffled laughter. "Pretty awesome."

Both of them laughed and looked in each other's eyes. "I can't believe you did that, Libby."

"She messed with my man."

"Is it weird that makes me love you *so hard*?"

"No," she said and giggled.

"Is it weird that I *don't* want to punch Finn in the nose?"

"Don't punch him in the nose," she said in a worried whine.

"I'm not going to, that's what I'm saying."

“Are we doing the right thing?”

“It feels good. It never felt like there was a wall between us, but since Chelsea and Finn, I have this weird feeling like there *had* been one or something, like there’s a line of rubble between us where it stood, and now it’s gone I see *all* of you now.”

“I see all of you,” she said.

“I don’t like who I am.”

“Both of us can always do better.”

“I want to do this. Whatever it is with you and Finn and Chelsea, I want it.”

“I want it to be fun,” she said in a serious tone, her thumb caressing under his eye. It thrilled him to hear her say it. He lay between her legs, and a year ago this position and this conversation would have been impossible. Her pubic hair tickled at his neck, and right now laying with her like this was heaven.

He moaned and luxuriated, took advantage of his wife’s current permission. What if tomorrow she said this exploration was over and she wanted to return to the way they were? One visit from her folks and she might button her shirt right up to the neck and put an end to all the dirty shenanigans. He rubbed his neck against the slick heat of his Libby’s pussy.

But she caught him, got bashful. Her legs closed on his shoulders, and she chided, “Hey, hey, come up here, you...”

He raised and groaned complaint, let Libby’s hands guide him to lay so they faced. But he was happy face to face, as happy as mouth to mound. “So you *want* more?”

When she shrugged and gave him a bashful face, he said, “There’s a thing up your bum tells me you’re getting more whether or not you want it.”

She snuffled more airy laughter, whispered, “I want it.”

“You do, don’t you, you naughty little mouse? Wiggle your nose.”

She did it for him then kissed his chin and a tidal wave of love had him inhaling a deep breath.

“How good is Finn in bed?”

The question widened her eyes, and she bit her lips between her teeth. But she answered. “He’s really good at it.”

“You like his big dick?”

“I like it.”

“Do you like it a lot?”

She nodded, biting on her lower lip till she smiled wide then hid her face from him.

“He make my little Lib frisky?”

“Yeah,” she whispered.

He pulled her into his arms and bit at her neck. “I love it, Lib.”

“Ben...?”

“Yeah, babe?”

She watched his eyes, mouth open with a tentative confession. She said, “He makes me *horny*.”

“Oh, Libby, why does that drive me so *wild*?” He growled and hugged her again. “I want him to turn you into a bad girl.”

“I *want* to be a bad girl,” she whispered, then retreated with a giggle. He snatched her back.

Seeing her so light and carefree, aroused, satiated yet still hungry, made his stomach tighten. She *was* horny, and it wasn’t her husband she wanted. She had a very specific taste. Libby liked charming, easy-going bad boys with tattoos and big dicks, one who could do very dirty things to her.

“Why weren’t you like this with me before?”

“Because you *know* me. And... I *love* you. Being like this... it’s *embarrassing*...”

“I love it.”

Her mouth shrank small. “I didn’t know.”

“You were happy to never know?”

“I kind of knew.”

He supposed that meant Ronnie. Lib’s other bad boy. In high school Ronnie had no tattoos but was the kind of dude Ben was sure had them all over by now. “With Ronnie?”

Her eyes went watery.

“You swear you never had sex with Ronnie?”

She nodded, her lips sucking in, eyes fearful. Now he was thinking there *was* more to discover about Libby and Ronnie. But what did she have to hide? Her husband supported her... Ronnie was a bad boy, too. One with a good body. And a dick bigger than her boyfriend’s. A manipulator who Lib said goaded her into bad behavior. A clearer picture formed, and he loved it, wanted to frame it. He could see a wide-screen view of his timid wife’s sexuality...

It made him laugh, rub his hands all over her, getting her squirming and giggling. His hands gripped her forearms, and he guided her wrists above her head, her pillowy breasts swaying between their bodies, “Are you a little fishy?”

“What?—no-ho,” she laughed and squirmed, nipples hardening further.

“Looks like Finn’s got this little fishy back on his hook...”

“I think I’m gonna jump right in his boat,” she said, wrestled out of his grip, threw her arms around him, almost rolling on top of him, kissing his mouth, chin, and neck while he fiddled and tugged the pink fox tail dangling below her perfect ass...

The point of his erection had poked out the fly of his pajama fronts and he could feel its wet end slipping high on the inside of his wife’s thigh. He pulled her upward, twisting his hips to hoist her on top of him. It was perfect—the point of his cock now prodded her wet folds.

“Whoa, hey,” she laughed and squirmed.

“Let me fuck you,” he said and kissed her cheek.

Lib swung off him, saying, “No way-hey,” and laughing. Now she was in the crook of his arm, looking in his eyes with an expression of mirth. “You get that thing away from me, Ben...”

“C’mom, Lib, all this dirty talk...”

HIS PLEADING PRODUCED A SMILE, and now her eyes lowered between his legs and they both regarded his naked arousal parting the fly, rock hard and angled up, its lone eye regarding them back. “You heard Chelsea,” she sighed, tugged his fly to close over his erection though it was a struggle and left his PJs crumpled and tented over a wild hard-on. “But, maybe...”

“Yeah, maybe what...?” The excitement got his voice breathy, and he cleared his throat.

“What I did today... when you got back from Peterborough...?”

“Whoa... your mouth...?”

She made a bashful expression and whisked her face away. Over her shoulder, like she was talking to the window, she said, “You can’t watch me. And you can’t finish in my mouth...”

“Whatever you want me to do, Libby,” he whispered, caressing her bare shoulder.

When she returned, he could see a blush on her cheeks. “But first...”

It got him smiling seeing her warming up like this, doing it in her own sweet Libby way—bashful, sexy, curious, on a cliff’s edge of wild wanton badness...

His smile encouraged her. She said, “I want you to do it again...”

“Do what?”

“What you did with *your* tongue...”

This scenario had been too wild to imagine, but now here it was, live and in color. He said, “Where...? Say it right...”

Libby made a snarling face, went bashful again and hid away—but she wormed up to whisper in his ear behind a cupped hand: “Put your tongue in my pussy like a good husband...”

Though he’d never dreamed of this, there was an open field of wonderment spread out ahead of him: the realization this was the empty piece of his life. Libby made him complete, but she herself was closed, a bud of a flower, and he wanted her petals unfurled. If it was Finn’s sunlight she faced, all that mattered were here roots entangled in her husband’s loving mineral-rich soil. Maybe Lib was nyctinastic, only opening to the light before closing again when it was dark. If true, Ben had a narrow window in Lib’s Finn-heated libido to get the nastiness he craved from her.

“Tell me again what you wanted from Finn,” he whispered.

She giggled and squirmed and his grip tightened on her arms. “What do you mean?”

“You want me to do that thing...?—I want to hear it again...”

Her expression calmed. “Tell me what you want to hear...”

“When he fingered you in the sunlight at Burger-Church, you told him what you wanted.”

She gave him a single nod. Understood. She complied. Up close to his ear again and behind the protection of her cupped hand, she whispered: “I want his big bare dick inside me.”

“Oh, God, baby,” he sighed, brain reeling, holding her tight while she gnawed her lower lip and studied her husband. *Probably wondering how on earth the man who married her would allow a tryst with the worst kind of male trouble...*

He recovered, chuckled, said, “He wants to put it in your bottom.”

She smiled. “I’ll let him, but I want it in my other spot.”

“You do?”

“So bad, Ben.” She smiled wider, eyes on his, wagging her hips and getting both their bodies rocking side to side.

He said, “No condom?”

She sucked her lips a second, got close to whisper: “No, I want to feel his skin inside me, feel his...” She moved back, a look of concern on her expression.

“Go ahead, say it...”

She returned to whisper, “Feel the head inside me...”

“God, Libby, you’re going to kill me...”

She laughed and drummed her fingers on his chest. “Don’t you die on me, I need you around...”

“This is crazy,” he sighed.

She said, “When *we* have sex I can feel your... head.”

“And you want to feel his?”

She nodded, doing the lip-chewing thing again.

He got serious now. “He’s going to come inside you.”

“He is.”

“Really...?”

She said, “I want it.”

His voice had gone breathy again: “You want him to come in you?”

“Uh-huh,” she hummed, humping her hips against him in small steady movements.

His stomach tightened, and though it was only a few days waiting to have his wife again, the prospect seemed so far away. He groaned, “Let me put it in you...”

“No way, you’re not allowed.”

He complained, and hugged, then asked, “Is it o-*kay* if he comes inside you?”

“On Friday.”

“Okay. Be careful.”

“I know.”

He kissed her lips, and she was receptive. Her naked body against him, her hot wet crotch dampening his PJ leg; he wondered how long her horniness would last.

“Lib, aren’t you going to ask if *I’m* okay with it?”

“Oh,” she said, averting her eyes down.

“It’s okay.”

“I thought I had permission. Do I?” Her eyes came up again.

“I guess. It’s a weird one. I don’t want to say yes, but I’m not saying no.”

“I’m not bad am I?”

He shook his head no. He’d come inside Chelsea. He’d come inside Neve—her ass, at least, but he’d been in her pussy and ready to shoot off with no condom. It hadn’t fazed *him* in the slightest. The girls encouraged him. Finn never mentioned he was cross. Maybe the gang in the Slades’ sex circle all came in each other’s girls. Just the thought of it made his stomach

tremble. The idea of all that biological fluid inside his wife, launched from another man's balls, so rich with purpose, so heavy with utility, and put up inside at his wife's request...

"You're the best. You do what you want and let me deal with it... I trust you..."

Now he rolled her over to lay her on the bed and kissed between her breasts. Lib sighed and raised her knees, prepared to have her husband eat her out again. She pulled the sheets up to cover him as he kissed around her navel. She stopped him.

"Ben...?"

He looked up as her hands cupped his neck. "I'll never betray you, baby... not again, okay?..."

He kissed her through a smile, his eyes on her until she got so quirky she covered him under the sheet. His kisses went down to her fuzzy patch and his tongue slipped pleasure all over her hot and sticky lips until she squirmed and panted. His cock throbbed and pounded between his legs, hot on the inside of his thighs. When he was done here, if Lib still rode the Finn sex-wave she was on, she told him it would be his turn...

Somehow, Chelsea had waved a wand and made him and his wife whole again.

There was a horror movie fear lurking behind a battered tombstone in a stormy graveyard. Just like the toddler Gage resurrected in the Pet Sematary, or the son in the Monkey's Paw, what if the relationship brought back to life wouldn't be the same? What he and Lib had now might look like it had before, but soon it would show gruesome telltales, awful and devious dissimilarities of the most nefarious kind...

Be careful what you wish for...

He shut his eyes and enjoyed the *now*. The *now* was his wife's pussy in a way he loved but had been forbidden by shame. When he made her come, and he knew he would, he was going to put his penis in her mouth. Tomorrow was another day...

AFTERWORD

Ben, Libby, Finn, and Chelsea will all return for a new adventure in a mini-series called *Scream Queens*...

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